

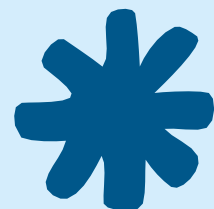
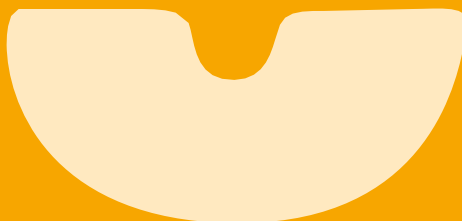


Youth Justice Board
Bwrdd Cyfiawnder Ieuencid

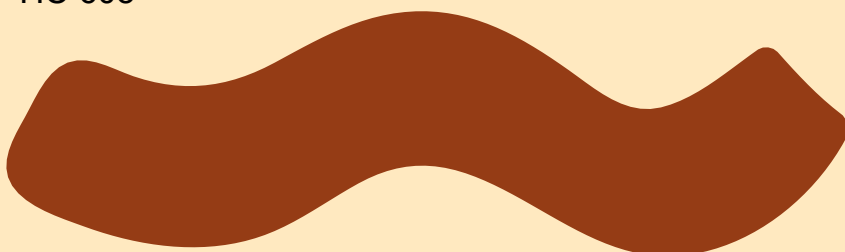
Annual Report and Accounts

2025/26

The Youth Justice Board for England and Wales



HC 605





Youth Justice Board
Bwrdd Cyfiawnder Ieuencid

The Youth Justice Board for England and Wales

**Annual Report and Accounts
For the period 1 April 2025 to 31 March 2026**

Report presented to Parliament pursuant to Schedule 2, paragraph 8 (2) of the Crime and Disorder Act 1998

Accounts presented to Parliament pursuant to Schedule 2, paragraph 9 (4) of the Crime and Disorder Act 1998

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Foreword



The year 2025/26 was one of both achievement and change for the youth justice system. It also marked the beginning of the most significant period of policy reform and organisational change in youth justice for a generation

At the Youth Justice Board (YJB), our purpose remains clear: to promote a youth justice system that treats children as children, protects the public, supports victims, and helps children to build safer, more positive futures. We do this by bringing together evidence, insight, oversight and leadership to support those working across youth justice services, local authorities, policing, education, health, the secure estate and wider partners.

None of this would be possible without our people. Throughout a year marked by organisational uncertainty and significant discussions about the future of youth justice, YJB colleagues demonstrated exceptional commitment, professionalism and resilience. This was reflected in our 2025 Civil Service People Survey results, where we achieved a 90% response rate and an employee engagement score of 69%, exceeding the Civil Service benchmark and improving significantly on the previous year. These results are testament to the dedication of our staff and the strength of the culture they have built together.

Our work continues to be guided by the Child First evidence-base, which remains fundamental to how we understand children, support practitioners and advise government on how best to prevent offending by children. During the year we strengthened that evidence-base through a range of publications and events, including our report on applying the evidence-base in youth justice services, the Annual Child First Day, research into prevention and diversion, learning from the 2024 disturbances, our work on ethnic disproportionality, and the publication of evidence and insights on harmful sexual behaviour, violence and misogyny. We also welcomed Phil Bowen as Interim Chair in February 2026, whose experience will add stability and continuity as we navigate the YJB's reforms.

The latest youth justice statistics provide reasons for cautious optimism. The number of children entering the youth justice system for the first time fell to 8,100, the lowest level ever recorded. The number of children in custody reduced to 418, a 3% decrease on the previous year and around 60% lower than a decade ago. Arrests of children also continued to fall, decreasing by 2% over the year, with children now accounting for only 8% of all arrests.

These figures matter because evidence consistently shows that avoiding unnecessary contact with the criminal justice system and reducing the use of custody improves outcomes for children while supporting safer communities and reducing victims. They reflect the determination and skill of practitioners across the country who work every day to prevent offending, reduce reoffending and support rehabilitation.

However, the headlines tell only part of the story.

The youth justice system continues to face complex and evolving challenges. While overall levels of offending remain significantly lower than in previous decades, the nature of some offending is changing. We have now seen a concerning three-year increase in sexual offences committed by children, with cases rising by 6% to approximately 1,500. We have not simply observed this trend; we have acted. During the year the YJB commissioned research into online harms and published a major evidence and insights pack examining harmful sexual behaviour, violence and misogyny among children, helping practitioners and policy makers understand emerging risks and the interventions most likely to be effective. While this report looks at the past year, we will continue to develop the evidence-base so we have greater clarity on what works to prevent children offending and reoffending.

Addressing disproportionality remains another critical priority. We welcomed an 11% reduction in the number of Black children in custody during the year, reflecting sustained effort across the sector. Nevertheless, Black children remain significantly over-represented within the system, and the proportion of children in custody from mixed ethnic backgrounds has doubled over the past decade. Such disparities are not inevitable and demand continued attention, challenge and action. Our published work on racial disproportionality, our work to support the London Accommodation and West Midlands Ethnic Disparity pathfinders, and the evolving response across youth justice services has sought to equip the sector with stronger evidence, greater transparency and practical approaches to driving improvements, diverting from stigma and reducing remand.

The reporting year also saw the YJB play a significant role as a core participant in Phase 1 of the Southport Inquiry. While the Inquiry's report was published shortly after the end of the reporting period, our engagement throughout the year reinforced the importance of understanding trauma, vulnerability, safeguarding, addressing unmet needs, effective risk management and the most up-to-date evidence-base to prevent children offending. The lessons emerging from the Inquiry will continue to inform our work and our advice to government and partners.

Alongside these operational and strategic priorities, 2025/26 was a year in which the future shape of youth justice became the subject of significant national discussion. The independent Public Bodies Review of the YJB concluded during the year, and the Government announced its intention to go further and reform the youth justice system including the role of the YJB. While the Youth Justice White Paper itself was published after the reporting period ended, the foundations for reform were laid throughout 2025/26.

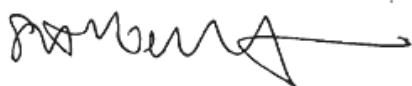
The YJB was not a passive observer of these developments. We actively contributed our expertise, evidence and experience to seek to influence and inform policy discussions, including close work with the Home Office on the development of new guidance relating to child knife possession offences. We welcomed the Government's increasing emphasis on prevention, earlier intervention and more locally responsive public services. These priorities are strongly aligned with the evidence-base that has informed the YJB's work for many years. As national discussions continue regarding devolution, public service reform and the future role of central government, we have sought to ensure that the needs of children, victims and communities remain central to those debates.

As reform progresses, it is essential that changes continue to be grounded in evidence about what works. The Child First evidence-base, together with a clear focus on public protection, victims and reducing reoffending, provides a strong foundation on which future policy can build. Throughout the year the YJB has worked to ensure that evidence, rather than assumption, remains at the heart of decision-making.

Looking ahead, we recognise both the opportunities and challenges before us. The Government has set out an ambitious vision for public service reform, placing greater emphasis on prevention, local leadership and the integration of services around the needs of people and communities. These ambitions are highly relevant to youth justice, where effective partnership working, early intervention and evidence-based support remain essential to preventing offending and reducing reoffending.

As discussions continue about the future shape of the youth justice system and the wider reform of public bodies, the YJB will continue to provide independent expertise, robust evidence and practical insight drawn from across England and Wales. We will work constructively with government, youth justice services and partners to ensure that future arrangements strengthen accountability, improve outcomes for children, support victims and enhance public protection.

I would like to thank our staff, Board members, youth justice services, partners and stakeholders for their continued commitment throughout the year. Together, we will continue to build a youth justice system that is evidence-led, fair, effective and focused on creating safer communities, fewer victims, and better outcomes for children while providing the best possible value to the communities we serve.



Stephanie Roberts-Bibby

Chief Executive and Accounting Officer

3 September 2026



Stock photograph, posed by models





Performance report 2025/26

- Overview
- Youth justice performance
- Our work - activity delivered
- Sustainability



Overview

This section introduces the Youth Justice Board for England and Wales (YJB) and provides a high level overview of the key elements of this Annual Report and Accounts for 2025/26. It explains our purpose, role, and performance during the year, and how we have used public resources to deliver our statutory responsibilities.

The section sets out our vision and mission, which guides our work across the youth justice system, and describes who we are, what we do, and who this report is for. It is intended to support accountability to Parliament, inform stakeholders across the youth justice sector, and provide transparency to the public.

It includes our Chief Executive's review of the year, highlighting significant developments, challenges, and achievements, alongside an overview of our financial performance and stewardship of public money.

The section also summarises youth justice system performance and the actions we have taken during the year to support improvement, influence policy and practice, and promote better outcomes for children, victims, and communities.

Our vision

Our vision is for a Child First youth justice system: A youth justice system that sees children as children, treats them fairly and helps them to build on their strengths so they can make a constructive contribution to society. This will prevent offending and create safer communities with fewer victims.

In working to achieve this vision, our mission statement provides more detail about our core purpose and the approach we will take.

Our mission

The Youth Justice Board is the only statutory body to have oversight of the entire youth justice system. We provide independent, evidence-based advice and leadership to drive improvements that increase children's positive outcomes and prevent offending.

To deliver our mission we:

- **monitored and oversaw the operation of the youth justice system**, and the provision of local youth justice services, using evidence-led frameworks to assess performance, support improvement, and escalate concerns where standards were not met.
- **provided independent, evidence-based advice** to ministers, Parliament, policymakers, practitioners, and the public on the operation and effectiveness of the youth justice system, informed by data, research, inspection findings, and system intelligence.



- **administered, allocated, and assured the use of grant funding** to support the operation of local youth justice services, ensuring public funds are used for the purposes intended by Parliament and delivered value for money. This included administering innovation funding to support evidence-informed approaches that improved outcomes for children and strengthened local practice.
- **commissioned, collated, and published information, research, and analysis**, and identified and shared evidence-informed practice, to influence national and local policy and practice and support consistent application of the Child First evidence-base.
- **supported and enabled the effective use of information systems and technology** across the youth justice system to improve oversight, decision-making, information-sharing, and outcomes for children.

Who we are?

The YJB is a statutory non-departmental public body established by the [Crime and Disorder Act 1998](#). It came into operation in September 1998 and was the first and only independent statutory body charged with overseeing how children and young people who offend, or are at risk of offending, are dealt with across England and Wales.

Our Non-Executive Board members are appointed by the Secretary of State for Justice and bring extensive and up-to-date experience of the youth justice system. The Board is supported by a skilled and experienced staff group of public servants who deliver the YJB's statutory responsibilities and day-to-day operations.

We are responsible for **monitoring and overseeing the operation of the youth justice system**, including the provision and performance of local youth justice services. Through this role, we provide independent, evidence-based advice to ministers, policymakers, practitioners, and partners, helping to inform policy, improve practice, and strengthen system delivery.

Our work is guided by a clear goal: **to prevent offending and reoffending by children**. We seek to achieve this through collaboration with partners across the system and by focusing our efforts where they will have the greatest impact for children, victims, and communities.

Central to our approach is the **Child First** evidence-base, which underpins our [Strategic Plan for 2024–2027](#) and guides how we seek to influence the youth justice system. Child First is an evidence-based framework that prioritises children's individual needs, strengths, sense of belonging, and lived experiences. It reflects the evidence on what works best to improve outcomes for children, reduce offending, and create safer communities with fewer victims.

To deliver this, we focus on understanding what works and how to translate evidence into practice. We use this knowledge both in exercising our statutory functions and in influencing the work of others across the youth justice system, supporting consistent, evidence-informed decision-making.

What we do

The YJB holds a unique statutory role in overseeing the youth justice system in England and Wales. Central to this role is our responsibility to ensure that the system operates effectively to prevent offending and reoffending by children and to improve outcomes for children, victims, and communities.

A key part of our statutory mandate is to provide **independent, evidence-based advice and guidance** on the operation and improvement of youth justice services. This role is not solely advisory. It is embedded in legislation and underpins our system leadership, oversight, and influence across the youth justice sector.

We deliver this role through a set of **interlinked statutory functions**, which enable us to:





Who is this report for?

This Annual Report and Accounts is intended to support accountability, transparency, and public understanding of the YJB's work during 2025/26. Our key audiences include:

- **Parliament:** The Annual Report and Accounts is formally laid before the UK Parliament. The report provides assurance on the YJB's use of public funds, delivery of statutory responsibilities, and overall financial and operational performance.
- **stakeholders across the youth justice system:** This includes youth justice services, local authorities, inspectorates, and partner organisations. The report provides insight into system performance, oversight arrangements, funding, and the dissemination of evidence-informed practice.
- **public and other interested parties:** The report is publicly available and is intended to inform anyone with an interest in the operation of the youth justice system and the role and impact of the YJB. In line with the YJB's Welsh Language Scheme and commitments under the [Welsh Language Act 1993](#) a Welsh language version is also produced and published to support accessibility for Welsh-speaking audiences.
- **staff and internal teams:** The report reflects on organisational performance and achievements during the year, reinforces our values and priorities, and supports internal understanding, engagement, and transparency.

Our statutory functions

Our statutory functions underpinned all our work during 2025/26. They enabled us to oversee the youth justice system, shape policy and practice, and provide independent, evidence based advice to ministers. We met all our legal responsibilities during the year and focused our resources where they could have the greatest impact for children, victims, and communities.

In exercising these functions, we prioritised activity that supports early intervention and prevention, recognising that acting early leads to better outcomes for children and more effective use of public resources. Tackling inequality was central to our work, both in how we operated as an organisation and in how we worked with others across the youth justice system. We ensured that fairness, equity, and inclusion remained visible and embedded in our values, decision making, and actions.

Monitoring and overseeing the youth justice system

We worked directly with **157 local youth justice services (YJSs)** across England and Wales. Each service was overseen by a local management board that brought together the five statutory partners education, health, children's services, police, and probation alongside other key partners who played a critical role in supporting children to prevent offending.

We assessed how effectively YJSs performed and how well they worked with partners to prevent offending and to support children, families, victims, and communities. Where we identified services that required additional support, we worked alongside them to strengthen performance and improve the quality and consistency of delivery.

We also provided advice on governance arrangements and supported YJS management boards to strengthen leadership, oversight, and accountability. This activity enabled us to build a clear and comprehensive picture of how the youth justice system was functioning and informed the advice we provided to ministers.

Our [Oversight Framework](#) underpinned this work. It supported the monitoring of both local and system-level performance, helped identify risk and underperformance, and enabled the sharing of effective practice. Our assessments drew on data, evidence, inspection findings, and professional judgement.

Each year, we review the **annual youth justice plans** submitted by every YJS. These plans set out progress to date, future priorities, and how local activity aligned with our strategic objectives. They also provided assurance on the intended use of grant funding, supporting responsible stewardship of public money.

Advising the Secretary of State

We provided independent, evidence-based advice to the Secretary of State and government officials on:

- how effectively the youth justice system operated to prevent offending and how services were delivered;
- the most effective approaches to preventing children from offending;
- national standards for youth justice services and for settings that held children in custody; and,
- actions that could be taken to prevent children from becoming involved in crime, reduce the number of victims and create safer communities.

Our advice was informed by national and international research, our own data and analysis, and insight from working closely with system partners. We also ensured that the voices and experiences of children, victims, and professionals are reflected in advice provided across government.

Managing and distributing grant funding

We managed grant funding provided by the Secretary of State for Justice to support the delivery of local YJSs. We set clear grant conditions to ensure that public funds were used appropriately, effectively, and for the purposes intended by Parliament. Our monitoring arrangements helped us understand how funding supported local efforts to prevent offending and improve outcomes.

We also led on modeling different funding scenarios, enabling us to provide informed advice on how funding could be allocated to address need and support equitable outcomes. With ministerial approval, we awarded targeted grants to support innovation and the application of evidence-informed practice.

Supporting technology and tools

We supported youth justice services and partner organisations by providing and maintaining systems that strengthened how they worked with children across the youth justice system. These included the Youth Justice Case Management System, AssetPlus, the Prevention and Diversion Assessment Tool, and the Youth Justice Application Framework (YJAF), a secure digital platform that supported case management, data sharing, and access to practice tools.



During the year, we continued to deliver reliable IT support through YJAF. The platform performed well and maintained strong security, providing a dependable service for users across the sector. We also invested in further development, addressing key functionality issues and improving overall capability to better meet user needs.

In parallel, we continued to embed the infrastructure, tools, and expertise needed to bring together evidence, knowledge, and data in one place within the organisation. This strengthened our ability to analyse information, generate insight, and support effective decision making across the sector.

Together, these systems helped services work more effectively with children, share information securely, and monitor outcomes.

Publishing information and research

We published and shared data, research, and analysis to support improvement and better outcomes for children and victims. This included:

- **published data and official statistics**, including regular and one-off statistical publications such as the [Annual Youth Justice Statistics](#) and the [Serious Incidents Annual Report](#).
- **shared quarterly data summaries, dashboards, and toolkits**, including information on serious violence and ethnic disproportionality, to support local decision-making and inform our Oversight Framework. This included the development and refinement of performance measures, including ten Key Performance Indicators.
- **published research and evidence**, including reports, reviews, and evidence summaries.

Commission research to support practice development:

We worked with stakeholders and government departments to identify gaps in the evidence base and commissioned research and evaluations aligned with our strategic priorities. This supported learning across the youth justice system and strengthened the evidence underpinning policy and practice.

We also managed the **Academic Liaison Network**, which brought together researchers from across the UK and Europe, helping to inform our work and reinforcing our role as a trusted source of youth justice expertise.

Sharing good practice

Our [Youth Justice Resource Hub](#) helps connect theory with practice by giving professionals, researchers, and volunteers access to evidence-based resources. It serves as a platform to share evidence-based practice and enables access to evidence, knowledge and information and research for youth justice professionals, academics, researchers, students and volunteers. We have been rebuilding this to improve user experience, enhance its look and feel and include new features - this was launched at the start of 2025/26 to improve accessibility, user experience, and functionality.

- we also supported collaboration and learning through a range of forums and events, including: **developing Practice Fora** - spaces for professionals to share ideas and experiences.
- **Hwb Doeth** - a key forum for developing practice in Wales.



- **Workforce Development Council** - co-chaired with the Youth Custody Service and Youth Justice Institute, focusing on staff development.
- **themed webinars** - bringing together senior leaders to explore key challenges and share how to drive change across the youth justice sector.

Identify and share evidence-informed practice across the sector

Effective performance and evidence-informed practice were identified through regular meetings between the YJB's oversight teams and YJSs.

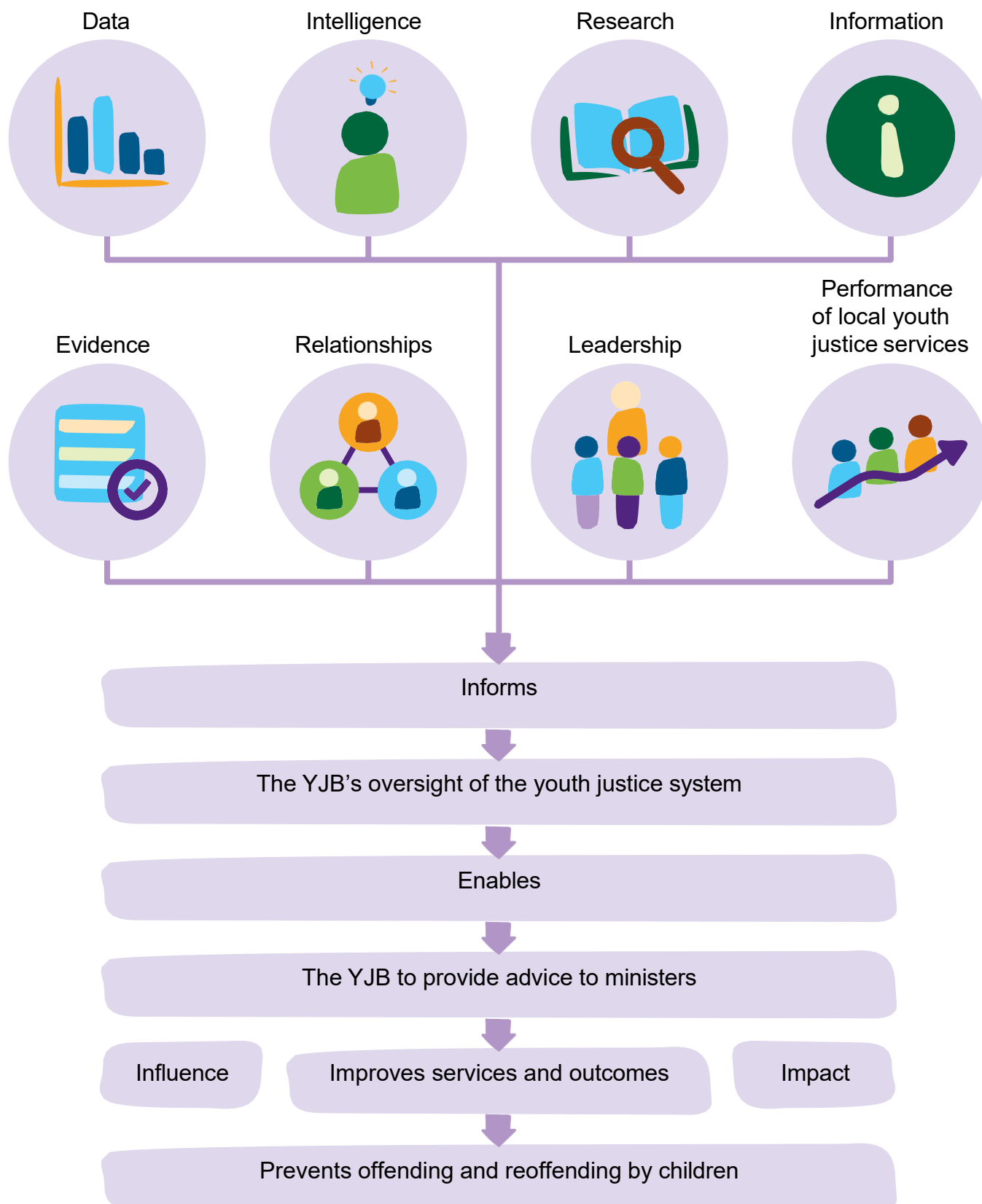
In March 2026, we held our annual Youth Justice Leaders' Summit. This provided an opportunity for leaders across the youth justice sector to come together, share learning, and reflect on practice. The summit focused on early intervention, supporting the ministerial priority to reduce the use of remand and ensure custody was used only where necessary and appropriate.

Our effectiveness was further strengthened by how we:

- **promoted the voice of the child**, including through our Youth Advisory Panel, which ensured lived experience informs policy and practice; and
- **used evidence to inform expert advice**, through analysis, commissioned research, and engagement with sector experts ensuring our guidance reflected the best available evidence.

Empowering youth voices and evidence-based insights

The YJB promotes the voice of children by consulting its youth advisory panel, which includes individuals with current or past experience in the youth justice system. It also uses information and evidence to develop expert insights for achieving the best outcomes.





Wales

Youth justice in Wales: A distinctive approach

Devolution and context

Youth justice in Wales operates within a distinct constitutional, policy, and delivery context. While justice remains a reserved matter for the UK Government and the Ministry of Justice, key youth justice partners including **health, education, and social care** are devolved to the Welsh Government. The Welsh Government also provides funding to the YJB to support the prevention of offending by children in Wales.

This devolved landscape requires a tailored approach to oversight, partnership working, and policy influence, ensuring that youth justice activity in Wales reflects Welsh policy priorities, legislative frameworks, and cultural context.

Our role in Wales

The YJB adapts its work in Wales to reflect this distinct context while continuing to discharge its statutory responsibilities consistently across England and Wales. Our role combines oversight, stewardship, system leadership, and evidence-based advice, delivered through close collaboration with Welsh Government and system partners.

Joint working with the Welsh Government

We have a long-standing partnership agreement with the Welsh Government and work closely with officials to shape both strategic and operational direction for youth justice in Wales.

The YJB Board member for Wales co-chairs the **Wales Youth Justice Advisory Panel (WYJAP)** with the Welsh Government. WYJAP provides a whole-system view of youth justice in Wales, acts as a strategic reference group, and advises on the delivery of shared priorities.

Through WYJAP, partners work collectively to:

- analyse data and evidence on offending and reoffending by children in Wales;
- identify shared challenges and develop collaborative solutions; and
- inform advice to ministers and policy development at both UK and Welsh Government levels.

System improvement

The Youth Justice Blueprint for Wales, concluded in March 2025 but system improvement work continues.

Evidence and insight

We collect and analyse data to understand youth justice trends and outcomes in Wales. This evidence informs our advice to Welsh Government ministers, Senedd committees, and officials, and ensures that Welsh-specific circumstances are reflected in consultations, briefings, and policy submissions.

This analytical capability supports informed decision-making and strengthens the evidence base underpinning youth justice policy and practice in Wales



Strategic collaboration

We contribute to a wide range of strategic partnerships across Wales, offering independent, evidence-based advice on youth justice issues. Our engagement includes devolved inspectorates, the Children's Commissioner for Wales, Police and Crime Commissioners, criminal justice agencies, and third sector organisations.

This collaboration helps align effort across the system, supports shared understanding of need and risk, and strengthens collective responses to challenges facing children, victims and communities.

Oversight and systemic influence

Through our oversight role and evidence-based advice, we support systemic improvement in youth justice in Wales. This includes influencing both strategic and operational direction, particularly through our leadership and stewardship of the now concluded Youth Justice Blueprint.

WYJAP, as a formal sub-group of the YJB Board, has a dual role. It provides a high-level overview of youth justice system performance in Wales and acts as a strategic reference group for change and improvement programmes.

WYJAP agreed three priority areas to frame its work during 2025/26:

1. Partnership with education

- strengthening the role of schools and education settings as places of safety.
- improving early identification of need and early intervention to prevent offending and escalation.

2. Partnership with health

- better understanding and meeting the health needs of children who come into contact with the youth justice system.
- improving access to appropriate health support and services to improve outcomes.

3. Partnership with policing

- strengthening the relationship between youth justice and child-centred policing approaches.
- supporting consistent and proportionate responses to children at risk of offending.

The YJB and Policing in Wales are jointly leading a piece of work to build upon the significant success of Out-of-Court Resolutions (OoCR) in Wales. The programme, which commenced in 2025, aims to improve the standard of decision-making and delivery. It takes an evidence-based approach to develop an all-Wales approach which will bring consistency to OoCR delivery across Wales, helping address underlying causes of crime and improve outcomes for children, victims and communities.

All four police forces, British Transport Police and all 17 youth justice services are committed to this work, and it is actively supported by the Welsh Government and the four Police and Crime Commissioners in Wales.



Cross-cutting themes

Two issues ran **across all three areas of focus** in 2025/26:

- addressing **racial disparities**, including the disproportionate representation of some ethnic groups at all stages of the youth justice system.
- **Violence Against Women and Girls, Domestic Abuse and Sexual Violence (VAWDASV)**, ensuring system responses recognise and address these risks and experiences.

Anti-Racist action plan

We actively support the Criminal Justice Board for Wales in delivering its Anti-Racist Action Plan. This collective commitment aims to address racism and promote race equality across the justice system in Wales. Our contribution focuses on evidence-based advice, partnership working and system oversight, and aligns with the Welsh Government's wider anti-racism ambitions for public services and society.

How we work

Our values shape how we deliver our mission and vision and define the culture we seek to develop across the organisation. They guide how we work with colleagues and partners, how we exercise our statutory responsibilities, and how we support staff to act with professionalism, integrity, and accountability.

Our values in action are reflected in how our people work every day. We expect staff to collaborate respectfully across teams and with external partners, valuing diverse perspectives and lived experience while maintaining clear professional boundaries. We work openly and transparently, sharing information appropriately and taking responsibility for our decisions and advice. We encourage staff to be evidence-led and reflective, using data and learning to challenge assumptions and improve practice. We also expect our leaders to role-model inclusive behaviours, promote fairness and equality, and create an environment where staff are supported to deliver high-quality work in the public interest.

Our values

Inclusive



We strive to challenge discrimination and promote equity in all that we do. We work with others to eliminate bias both within the Youth Justice Board and in the youth justice system.

Collaborative



We work together to deliver our strategic plan. We encourage system-led change and are enablers of innovation. We actively encourage, facilitate, and engage in partnership working to help meet the needs of children, victims, and their communities, and acknowledge that children are also victims.

Integrity



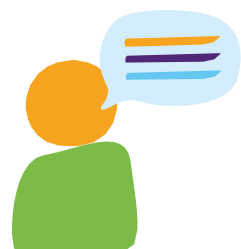
We fulfil our duties and obligations responsibly. We are professional and always act in a way that deserves and retains the confidence of all those with whom we have dealings with.

Accountable



We take responsibility for the work we do, for our actions, our behaviours and our performance.

Bold



Our work and advice remain firmly evidence based and, even if the message is difficult, we will not shy away from saying what evidence tells us to be true. We will continue to champion the needs of children wherever they are in the youth justice system and will make sure that we give them a voice.

Child First

The **Child First** evidence-base provides the foundation for how we exercise our statutory functions and influence practice across the youth justice system. It is underpinned by four core, evidence-based principles, commonly referred to as **ABCD**, which guide our advice, oversight, and engagement:

As children

Prioritise the best interests of children and recognise their particular needs, capacities, rights and potential. All work is child-focused, developmentally informed, acknowledges structural barriers and meets responsibilities towards children.



Building pro-social identity

Promote children's individual strengths and capacities to develop their pro-social identity for sustainable desistance, leading to safer communities and fewer victims. All work is constructive and future-focused, built on supportive relationships that empower children to fulfil their potential and make positive contributions to society.

Collaborating with children

Encourage children's active participation, engagement and wider social inclusion. All work is a meaningful collaboration with children and their carers.

Diverting from stigma

Promote a childhood removed from the justice system, using pre-emptive prevention, diversion and minimal intervention. All work minimises criminogenic stigma from contact with the system.

In line with our vision, we are committed to ensuring that children are not unnecessarily drawn into the criminal justice system as a result of vulnerability or unmet need. This approach is grounded in a strong body of evidence which shows that formal contact with the criminal justice system can increase the likelihood of further offending, particularly where early intervention and support would be more effective.

Our vision is for a youth justice system that is evidence-based, treats children as children, and addresses the underlying causes of offending behaviour and seeks to prevent victims. By focusing on prevention, early intervention, and proportionate responses, the system is better able to support positive and sustained outcomes for children, reduce harm to victims, and contribute to safer communities.

We recognise that children who come into contact with the youth justice system often have complex needs and vulnerabilities. As a society, and through our public services, there is both a legal and moral responsibility to safeguard children and support their development. When these responsibilities are not met, the consequences can be long-lasting for children and have wider implications for public safety and community wellbeing. The Child First framework seeks to mitigate these risks by promoting responses that are fair, proportionate, and informed by evidence.

Our work

During 2025/26, our work continued to focus on the Youth Justice Board's statutory role in **monitoring and overseeing the youth justice system**, a complex network of services, organisations, and agencies operating across England and Wales. Our collective aim remained to prevent offending and reoffending, reduce harm, and improve outcomes for children, families, victims, and communities.

Our published [Oversight, Assurance and Compliance Framework](#) sets out clearly how we monitor the performance and delivery of local youth justice services and how we develop a system-wide understanding of risk, performance, and improvement. This framework underpins our approach to assurance, support, and escalation, and ensures that our oversight activity is evidence-based, transparent, and proportionate.

Our strategic direction during the year was also shaped by broader Government missions, in particular:

- Creating Safer Streets
- Unlocking Opportunity for Children

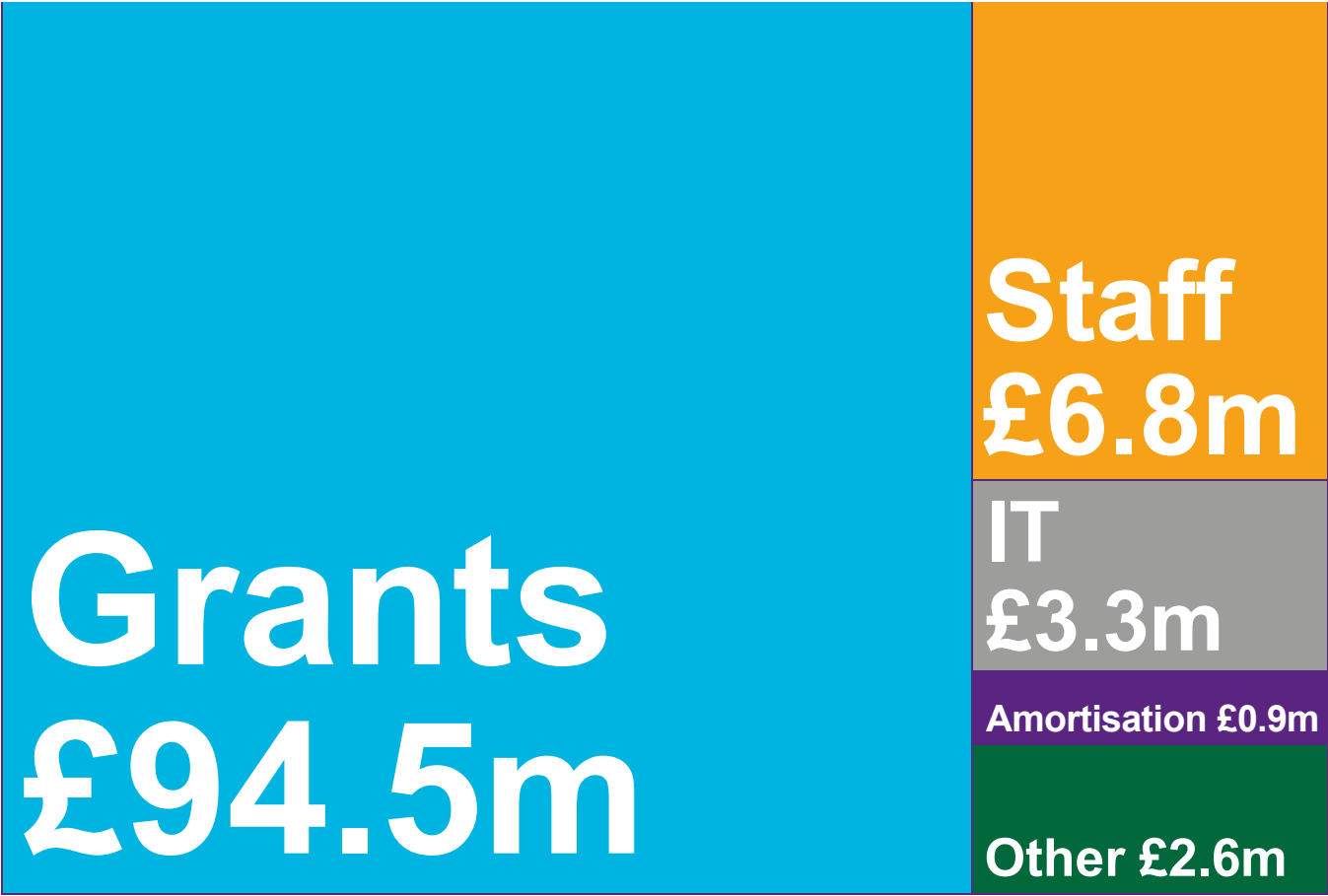
These missions align closely with our statutory responsibilities and strategic priorities. They reinforce our focus on prevention, early intervention, and addressing the underlying causes of offending, contributing to a safer, fairer society and improved outcomes for children and victims.

Our monitoring function enables us to support improvement where performance is strong, to challenge and escalate where concerns arise, and to develop solutions at local, regional, and national levels. Through this work, we build a robust picture of system level performance and emerging risks, which informs the independent, evidence based advice we provide to ministers and system partners. We assess the performance of individual youth justice services across four core areas, which together provide assurance on delivery, effectiveness, and governance:





How we spent our money in 2025/26 (£m)



In 2025/26, our net operating expenditure was £107.9 million, which was a £3.1 million (3%) increase compared with 2024/25. This increase was mainly driven by higher programme expenditure, including increased grants to youth justice services of £94.5 million and higher information and communications technology (ICT) programme costs of £3.3 million, primarily linked to the replacement of the Youth Justice Application Framework (YJAF).

Staff costs also increased to £6.8 million, reflecting 2025/26 pay awards, employer National Insurance changes, long service awards and the temporary addition of one Senior Civil Servant post.

These increases were partly offset by lower amortisation costs following the extension and alignment of the useful economic lives of YJAF intangible assets. Further information on expenditure during the year is provided in the audited financial statements section of this report.

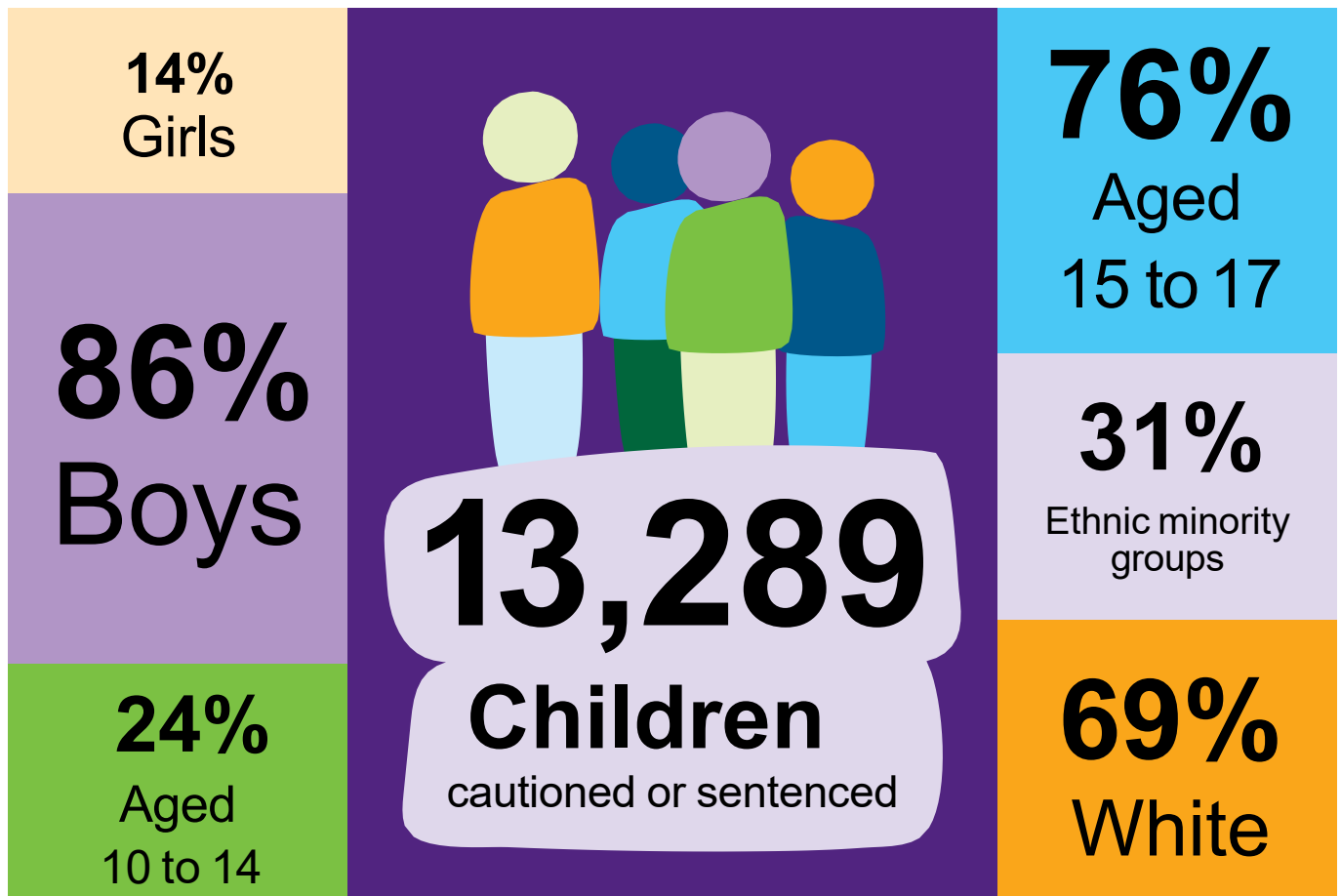
Risk management is embedded in how we plan and operate. The key risks and issues affecting delivery of our vision and mission are monitored and managed through our strategic risk register. Further details of our risk management framework and the principal risks managed during 2025/26 are set out in the governance statement within this report.



Youth justice performance

As part of the YJB's monitoring of the youth justice system, we collect and analyse a range of data on the performance of the youth justice system, including the number of children (those aged 10 to 17) in the system, the offences they committed, the outcomes they received, their demographics and trends over time. We produce and publish an annual report on this data, our annual [Youth Justice Statistics](#). The most recent publication (2024/25) includes data to the year ending March 2025 and is the basis for the following section.

In the year ending March 2025





Summary

Our latest statistics, for the year ending March 2025, show that the number of children stopped and searched decreased by 7% compared with the previous year. There were, however, notable geographical variations, with the largest decrease recorded in Yorkshire and the largest increase in Wales. Of the approximately 487,000 stop and searches where age was known, children accounted for 20%.

The number of first-time entrants (FTEs) to the youth justice system fell for the second consecutive year, reaching the lowest level on record in the year ending December 2024. For the second-year running, more FTEs received a court sentence than a youth caution. The average number of children in custody also fell to a record low.

The reoffending rate for children in the cohort entering the system in the year ending March 2024 decreased from the previous year, following two consecutive annual increases. However, both the number of children in the cohort and the number of reoffences increased, rising for the second and third consecutive years respectively.

The average time from offence to case completion was 230 days, an increase of nine days compared with the previous year. This was equal to the highest level recorded, previously reached in the year ending March 2021 when court closures resulting from the COVID-19 pandemic affected system timeliness.

Black children continued to be disproportionately represented at most stages of the youth justice system. Compared with the previous year, volumes involving Black children increased across several measures, including arrests, first time entrants, and children receiving cautions or sentences. This followed reductions seen across many of these measures in previous years.

Children from Mixed ethnic backgrounds also remained disproportionately represented across several stages of the youth justice system. Compared with the previous year, the proportion of Mixed ethnicity children receiving cautions or sentences increased. They also remained over-represented within the custodial remand population and, despite an overall reduction in the number of children in custody over the past decade, the proportion of children in custody from Mixed ethnic backgrounds has continued to increase.

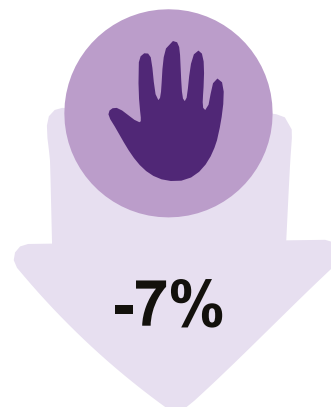
Stop and search: children

In the year ending March 2025, the number of stop and searches involving children fell by 7% compared with the previous year. Children accounted for just over one in five stop and searches where age was known.

There were around 95,900 stop and searches involving children. Of those where ethnicity was known, Black children were involved in 18%, 12 percentage points higher than their proportion in the 10 to 17-year-old population in 2021. Black children therefore remained the only ethnic group to be disproportionately represented relative to their share of the population. However, this represents a reduction since 2021, when Black children accounted for 22% of stop and searches involving children.

Geographical trends varied compared to the previous year:

- Wales saw a 5% increase, from around 3,400 to around 3,600.
- London saw a 15% decrease, from just over 26,000 to around 22,000.
- Yorkshire saw a 19% decrease, from around 7,100 to around 5,700.



First time entrants (FTEs) to the youth justice system

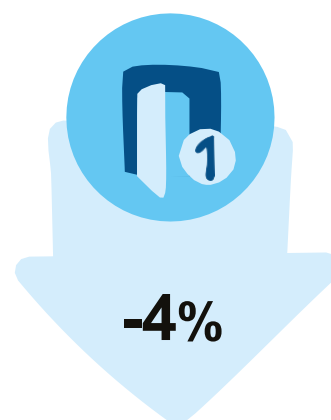
In the year ending December 2024, there were just over 8,100 children recorded as first time entrants (FTEs) to the youth justice system. This was a 4% decrease compared with the previous year, and the lowest level recorded over the last ten years.

While overall numbers have continued to fall, the proportions varied by ethnicity. The proportion of FTEs from a White background decreased to 74%. Compared with the year ending December 2014, the proportion of FTEs among children who were Black increased from 12% to 18%. Although this proportion had fallen for three consecutive years, it increased in the latest year.

For the second consecutive year, there were more child FTEs receiving a sentence at court than receiving a youth caution. In the year ending 31 December 2024 59% of child FTEs received a sentence at court compared with 54% in the previous year and 28% in the year ending December 2014. The overall decrease in child FTEs and children receiving youth cautions may reflect changes in the use of diversionary outcomes for children.

Compared with the previous year, the number of child FTEs in the year ending December 2024 varied:

- West Midlands, the North East and London recorded increases of 11%, 10% and 8% respectively
- all other English regions recorded decreases, including a 26% reduction for the East Midlands to around 470 child FTEs
- Wales recorded a decrease of 10% to around 390 child FTEs.





Children in custody

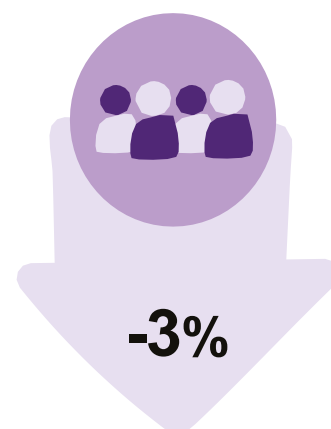
A custodial sentence can sometimes be the most appropriate response to a proven offence, but it should always be a last resort for children. Early intervention is often more effective, less costly, and leads to better outcomes for the children involved.

In the year ending March 2025, there was an average of just under 420 children in custody at any one time. This represented a 3% decrease compared with the previous year and the lowest number on record. Geographically, YJSs from Yorkshire saw the largest reduction in the average monthly youth custody population, from 45 to 30 children.

In the latest year, the number of young adults aged 18 held in the secure estate for children and young people fell by 40 (27%). Despite this reduction, it remained at the second highest level during the time series. This followed a temporary ministerial decision taken in December 2022, in response to capacity pressures in the adult secure estate, to delay the automatic transition to the young adult estate until the age of 19. Young adults aged 18 accounted for 21% of those held in the secure estate in the year ending March 2025, compared with 26% in the previous year and 9% in the year ending March 2015.

Where ethnicity was known, the average number of children in custody for the year ending March 2025, was lower for Black, White and Mixed ethnicity children than in the previous year. Over the last 10 years, the proportion of:

- White children in custody fell from 61% to 48%. Mixed ethnicity children increased, from 10% to 18%, representing the largest increase of any ethnic group.
- Black children increased slightly, from 21% to 22%.
- Asian or other ethnic groups increased from 9% to 12%, the highest level recorded during the time series.



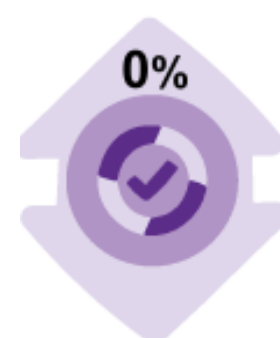
Proven offences by children

In the year ending March 2025, the number of proven offences committed by children remained static at around 35,600 compared with the previous year, following two consecutive annual increases.

Proven sexual offences increased for the third consecutive year, rising by 6% to around 1,500. In contrast, proven drugs offences fell by 4% to around 2,500 offences.

Violence against the person was the largest offence group, accounting for 23% of proven offences, followed by theft and handling (14%). Possession of weapons offences were the third largest offence group, accounting for 12% of proven offences.

Wales accounted for 5% of all proven offences, while London and the South East each accounted for 16%.





There were some notable geographical variations in the types of proven offences:

- in London, 21% of all proven offences were for possession of weapons offences, compared with 6% in both Wales and the North East.
- in Wales, violence against the person offences accounted for the highest proportion of proven offences (23%).
- London recorded the lowest proportion of violence against the person offences (17%)

In the year ending March 2025, there were just under 3,700 knife or offensive weapon offences committed by children that resulted in a caution or sentence. This was 2% higher than the previous year and 23% higher than 10 years ago. The vast majority (95%) of these offences were possession offences, while the remaining 5% related to threatening another person with a knife or offensive weapon.

Reoffending by children

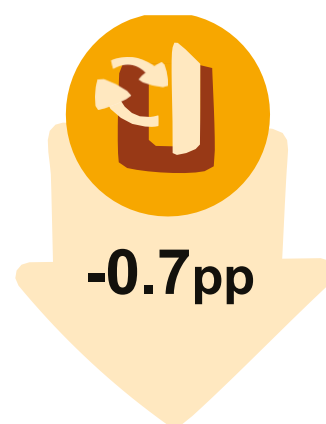
The reoffending rate for children decreased to 31.8% in the year ending March 2024, a reduction of 0.7 percentage points compared with the previous year. Reoffending rates decreased for children from all ethnic groups except the Other ethnic group. However, the number of children in the cohort increased for children from all ethnic groups except Black children

Reoffending rates also varied by disposal type (the outcome through which a child entered the cohort). A child enters the reoffending cohort if they receive a caution, receive a non-custodial conviction at court, or are released from custody during the cohort period.

Children who received a caution had the lowest reoffending rate (21.6%) of all index disposal types, a fall of 0.6 percentage points compared with the previous year and the lowest level recorded in the last 10 years.

Consistent with the pattern observed over the past decade, children released from custody had the highest reoffending rate. For children released from custody in the year ending March 2024, 61.7% reoffended, a decrease of 4.4 percentage points from the previous year.

It is important to recognise that the reasons behind offending and reoffending are complex and often linked to challenges in children's lives, homes and communities.



The YJB in numbers



GOV.UK publications

~25

Official YJB news, reports, guidance published externally



Evidence packs published

New Evidence & Insights packs (on Violence Against Women and Girls/misogyny and Victims)



Resource Hub uploads

161

Effective practice resources added (151 practice + 10 research)



YJS in top quadrant

42

YJSs with 'strong' performance at year-end (Quadrant 1)



Board/SCS visits

35+

Senior community & custody visits to YJSs in 2025/26



LinkedIn reach

~130k

Combined impressions on YJB LinkedIn posts (followers ~25k)

Our work - activity delivered

In 2025/26, the YJB delivered a broad programme of work across England and Wales, aligned to our [Strategic Plan](#) to strengthen the youth justice system and improve outcomes for children, victims and communities. Most of our activity focused on supporting improvement in local youth justice services (YJSs), reflecting our statutory role in oversight, performance monitoring and direct sector support. By the end of the year, the number of services rated as 'strong' had increased to 42 while the number rated as 'failing' had reduced to zero, demonstrating improved performance across the country.

Equally, our commitment to addressing persistent disparities and championing 'Child First' evidence principles shaped all areas of delivery. We embedded equity and evidence-led, child-centred practice in every aspect of our work, from data-driven performance monitoring to influencing policy and developing frontline tools, ensuring that Objectives 2 and 3 of our Strategic Plan (reducing disproportionality and putting children at the heart of the system) were advanced through each project.

In early 2026, we responded to significant external developments, including the Government's announcement of a major youth justice modernisation programme and the conclusion of an independent [Public Bodies Review of the YJB](#). The Board and staff provided extensive evidence and began transformation planning to ensure our expertise shapes these future reforms, while continuing to deliver our statutory functions and our planned programme of work at pace.

As Core Participants in Phase 1 of the Southport Inquiry, the YJB played a significant role in supporting the Inquiry's work. This included the submission of written opening and closing statements and the provision of evidence in response to formal requests, drawing on YJB's oversight of YJSs and expertise in youth justice policy and practice.

The YJB core team attended several Inquiry evidence sessions, both in person and online, including oral evidence given by the Chief Executive. This helped us identify emerging themes and issues relevant to the youth justice system and ensured our contributions remained aligned with the focus of Phase 1. As the Inquiry moved into Phase 2, we continued to implement the two recommendations assigned to the YJB.

Overall, the year combined high-impact outputs, including research, guidance, and innovative digital resources (such as our expanding Youth Justice Resource Hub) with sustained engagement and capacity-building. We published new evidence and insights (for example, independent evaluations of our tools and evidence packs on issues such as harmful sexual behaviour and youth violence), convened the sector at national events reaching hundreds of practitioners, and reinforced the system's long-term foundations. All of our work was grounded in what we know prevents offending, reduces harm to victims, and makes communities safer.



Strategic Function 1: Monitoring and overseeing the operation of the youth justice system

In 2025/26, we continued to monitor the performance of the youth justice system with a specific focus on community provision, ensuring that services meet established standards. This has included the ongoing review of YJSs and multi-agency partnerships against evidence-based expectations alongside targeted support to drive improvements in delivery and promote the replication of best practice. We have also progressed the development of our information and insights platforms and products, strengthening our ability to generate robust analysis. These tools are being used to support and inform our oversight, planning, decision-making and advice to stakeholders.

Deliverables	Description
Oversight Framework: Improvement Library	Developed an internal improvement library to provide practical advice and resources that support oversight teams in delivering improvement support to frontline youth justice services.
Oversight: Developing Practice (DP) fora	Continued quarterly regional DP fora to bring together youth justice practitioners, partners and stakeholders to share learning and focus on key themes including reoffending, serious violence, victims, and Violence Against Women and Girls.
Oversight: Youth justice plans	Reviewed annual youth justice plans submitted by youth justice services and identified almost 300 examples of good practice across England and Wales.
Standards for Children	Commenced implementing the 10 recommendations from the Standards for Children report published in 2024/25 before pausing work following the Ministerial announcement on the future reform of the YJB.
Serious incidents reporting	Produced internal quarterly serious incident reports for England and Wales throughout the reporting period. The Serious Incidents Annual Report 2024 to 2025 will be published in 2026/27.



Strategic Function 2: Providing independent evidence-based advice to ministers and officials in Whitehall and the Welsh Government

We continued to provide high quality, evidence-based advice to ministers on the operation of the system. This has included development of clear evidence-based positions on youth justice issues and helping to inform policy development.

Deliverables	Description
Position Statements	Developed internal position statements on victims and Violence Against Women and Girls, and began developing a position statement on online harms.
Stakeholder fora	Convened the Voluntary and Community Sector Liaison Group (VCSLG), External Liaison Group (ESLG), Youth Advisory Network (YAN), and Youth Justice System Oversight Group (YJSOG) to discuss entry into the system, reducing reoffending, and Violence Against Women and Girls.
Practitioners' forum: Black and Mixed Ethnicity boys	Delivered a national practitioners' forum to share effective practice, promote learning, and support professionals working with Black and Mixed ethnicity boys across the youth justice sector.
Practitioners' forum: Girls	Delivered a national webinar on girls in the youth justice system with the National Children's Bureau (NCB) and facilitated a regular practitioners' forum to share best practice, peer support, and learning on working with girls in the youth justice system.
Devolution of youth justice to Wales	Continued working with the Welsh Government to explore opportunities to support research and provide insight to inform the development of youth justice arrangements in Wales, including funding.



Strategic Function 3: Administering and distributing grant funding

We continued to allocate the core grant funding to 157 local authorities across England and Wales, ensuring services were appropriately resourced to meet local needs. Alongside this the YJB worked with the Ministry of Justice (MoJ), Ministry of Housing, Communities, and Local Government (MHCLG), Welsh Government and other government departments to develop proposals for a fairer, evidence-based funding formula for future allocations. We also continued to administer targeted funding to drive innovation through Pathfinder projects, alongside supporting the delivery of key thematic initiatives focused on addressing disproportionality, improving accommodation for children, and enhancing the use of temporary release from custody.

Deliverables	Description
Allocation and payment of core grant funding to Local Authorities for 2025/26	Managed the full lifecycle of youth justice core and Pathfinder grants, including planning, allocation, payment, compliance monitoring, audit assurance, and reconciliation.
Review of grant terms and conditions	Reviewed and updated the 2025/26 Terms and Conditions of core grant to ensure legal compliance, operational clarity, and timely distribution to youth justice services.
New grant funding formula (GFF)	Explored options to replace the existing youth justice services core grant funding formula with a new model developed by Economics by Design in 2022.
Pathfinder: Addressing Ethnic Disparity (AED)	Supported a pathfinder programme to reduce the disproportionate representation of Black and Mixed heritage children in the youth justice system through early intervention, prevention, and culturally sensitive trauma-informed practice.
Pathfinder: London Accommodation Pathfinder (LAP)	Funded supported accommodation as a psychologically informed alternative to custody for 16 to 17-year-old boys, including those on remand, at risk of custody, or preparing for resettlement, with a focus on Black and Mixed heritage children who are disproportionately represented in the youth justice system.
Pathfinder: Leeds Release on Temporary Licence (ROTL) Pilot	Provided funding to support a ROTL post at Wetherby Youth Offender Institution (YOI).

Strategic Function 4: Providing assistance in the use of information technology and equipment for the youth justice system

We continued to support the use of information technology and systems across YJS, helping to enable effective service delivery and data-driven practice. This included the delivery, maintenance and enhancement of national data and information systems used by the sector.

During 2025/26 we undertook a review of the Youth Justice Application Framework (YJAF) to assess whether it remained fit for purpose. The review concluded that enhancing system functionality and reliability would be essential to better support YJSs in case management and data reporting.

Deliverables	Description
AssetPlus: Assessment of data quality and use	Commenced a review of the quality and use of AssetPlus data to improve understanding of children's needs and support more effective planning of interventions in the community and secure estate.
AssetPlus: Language review	Reviewed and updated AssetPlus language to align with the Child First evidence framework, engaging with youth justice services to assess the impact of proposed changes and support implementation.
Insights project	Enhanced internal intelligence platforms to improve information sharing, collaboration, and organisational insight. This supported the production of internal and external reports and improvements to document management and digital resources.
Youth Justice Application Framework (YJAF)	Reviewed youth justice IT systems by completing an independent technical assessment of YJAF. Appointed Made Tech Limited to develop a new Youth Justice Platform following a procurement exercise completed in December 2025.



Strategic Function 5: Collating and publishing information about the performance of the youth justice system

We worked to strengthen organisational analytical capability to better inform oversight and drive continuous improvement across the youth justice system. This included the ongoing analysis and application of Key Performance Indicator (KPI) data, alongside the publication of a KPI Quality and Methodology Information Paper, ensuring transparency and consistency in how performance is measured and applied within the Oversight Framework.

We also continued to develop and share data products, including the quarterly Youth Justice Data Summary (YDS) workbook, toolkits and dashboards, providing YJSs with accessible insights to support local performance management and decision-making. In addition, we progressed a programme of analytical publications, including periodic reviews on racial disparity affecting children within the youth justice system, as well as reporting on disproportionality at key stages of the youth justice journey, to support evidence-led policy and practice.

Deliverables	Description
External Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)	In June 2025 we published a Quality and Methodology Information report and improved data quality processes to enable reliable quarterly KPI reporting through a new dashboard for youth justice services. We continued to share the KPI dashboard to youth justice services on a quarterly basis and made regular improvements over the course of the year to respond to ongoing feedback and address identified issues. This included updates which are published in the KPI guidance change log .
Annual Youth Justice Statistics 2024/25	Published The Annual Youth Justice Statistics on 29 January 2026.
Data Recording Requirements and Data Dictionary	Updated the Data Recording Requirements (DRR) and data dictionary to support consistent data submissions from YJSs to the YJB.
Transformation of Youth Data Summary (YDS) data into dashboards	Launched an interactive dashboard for the quarterly YDS to provide youth justice services with accurate, timely, and evidence-based information.
AssetPlus: Reimagining information sharing between youth custody and community	Worked with an external supplier to define requirements for a Child First information sharing service between youth custody services and youth justice services, to support better information sharing across custody and community settings.

Deliverables	Description
Serious violence toolkit	Produced quarterly serious violence toolkits for youth justice services to provide data and insight on serious violence, knife crime, robbery, and violence against the person offences.
Understanding Racial Disparity publication	Published the Understanding Racial Disparity infographic in January 2026

Strategic Function 6: Commissioning research to support practice development

We progressed a programme of in-house and commissioned research across key priority areas, including prevention and diversion, the Child First approach, and child exploitation, with findings published to inform policy and practice.

Deliverables	Description
Academic Liaison Network (ALN)	Led a network of academics specialising in youth justice to strengthen the YJB's evidence base and support evidence-informed policy and practice.
Research Project: Prevention and Diversion Tool (PDAT) Evaluation	Published the evaluation of the Prevention and Diversion Assessment Tool (PDAT) in January 2026 and delivered a sector webinar to share learning on its development and implementation.
Research Project: Applying the Child First Framework in Youth Justice Services	Published the Applying the Child First Framework in Youth Justice Services Report in June 2025.
Research Project: 2024 violent disturbances	Published research and delivered a sector webinar in November 2025 to share knowledge from the Learning from the 2024 disturbances , helping YJSs strengthen future preparedness, coordination, and frontline response arrangements.
Research Project: Child criminal exploitation	Commissioned research to improve understanding of how youth justice services identify, support, and safeguard children affected by criminal exploitation.
Research Project: Workforce research	Commissioned research to improve understanding of the youth justice workforce, including workforce skills, training needs, and future investment requirements across England and Wales.



Strategic Function 7: Identifying and sharing evidence-informed practice across the sector

We continued to identify and disseminate best practice across the youth justice services. This included maintaining and promoting the adoption of Case Management Guidance. We continue to support workforce development through facilitation of the Workforce Development Council and ongoing refinement of the Elevate programme delivery model to ensure it meets participant needs.

Deliverables	Description
Annual Child First Day	Delivered the annual Child First Day on 20 August 2025 to strengthen understanding of the Child First evidence base and decision-making framework.
Annual Leaders' Summit, 2026	Hosted the Youth Justice Leaders' Summit in Birmingham on 26 March 2026, bringing together youth justice leaders from across England and Wales.
Case Management Guidance (CMG)	Supported the adoption of Case Management Guidance across youth justice services and statutory partners, while updating guidance in response to sector feedback.
Developing Practice fora	Delivered regional Developing Practice fora across England to support youth justice practitioners to share learning, reflect on challenges, and exchange effective practice.
Hwb Doeth	Commissioned research to improve understanding of how youth justice services identify, support, and safeguard children affected by criminal exploitation.
Knife possession guidance	Worked with the Home Office to develop and publish the Government guidance for child knife possession offences in February 2026.
Oversight: Practice discovery visits	Conducted practice discovery visits to review and understand specific areas of practice within youth justice services.
Oversight: Workforce Development: Elevate Programme	Supported the development of middle managers from Black, Asian and minority ethnic groups through the Elevate Programme and began planning for the next cohort in 2026/27.

Deliverables	Description
Wales Blueprint	The Youth Justice Blueprint for Wales is a partnership programme, led by the Welsh Government, to improve outcomes for children in and at risk of entering the youth justice system. During 2025/26, delivery focused on Out-of-Court Resolution reforms, alongside wider Blueprint priorities aimed at preventing unnecessary entry into the formal youth justice system.
Wales Out-of-Court Resolutions (OoCR)	Supported the Youth Justice Blueprint for Wales during 2025/26 before the programme concluded and transitioned into Out-of-Court Resolution work.

Enablers

Deliverables	Description
Anti-Racism: Anti-Racist Statement	Published an Anti-Racist Statement setting out the YJB's commitment to tackling racism, promoting racial equity, and creating an inclusive organisation.
Anti-Racism: Cultural Cohesion Quality Mark (CCQM)	Delivered training and development sessions to support progress towards YJB's CCQM accreditation and Stage 3 progress. The programme was paused mid-year pending clarity on the outcome of YJB Reform.
Culture and values	Delivered a communications plan to embed new core values and clear behavioural standards. The action plan was paused mid-year pending clarity on the outcome of YJB Reform.
COVID-19: Response to Public Inquiry	Provided information and evidence to support the COVID-19 Public Inquiry in June 2025.
Communications	Delivered strategic communications activity, including the Youth Justice Leaders' Summit, campaigns on key youth justice issues, and the publication of statutory reports, evidence packs, and strategic documents.
Digital and Data Strategy	Continued implementing the Digital and Data Strategy to improve the use of data, digital tools, and insight to support oversight of the youth justice system and improve outcomes for children.



Deliverables	Description
Financial management	Proactively managed and monitored the YJB's financial activity in partnership with Ministry of Justice finance teams and the Grants Centre of Excellence, providing strategic and financial management advice and robust reporting to the Accounting Officer.
Internal Audit recommendations	Responded to internal audit reviews across key business areas and secured closure of recommendations from five audits, with further work continuing on Learning and Development actions into 2026/27.
New Sense of Purpose (NSOP) review	Reviewed the impact of the NSOP change programme to assess how organisational structures, people, and processes have supported delivery since 2021.
Oversight framework	Applied the Youth justice oversight framework to monitor the performance and quality of YJSs, identify risks and good practice, and support proportionate intervention and decision-making.
People development	Developed our people through targeted learning, leadership development, and capability-building aligned with organisational priorities. This strengthened the skills needed to lead through change, deliver business priorities, and improve outcomes for children and the youth justice system.
Readiness for Change / Change Programme	Undertook a programme of work to strengthen organisational readiness for change ahead of the outcomes of both the YJB Public Bodies Review and the wider Arm's Length Body Review. This included establishing adaptable governance, enhancing workforce preparedness through planning and scenario modelling, and refreshing key people policies and processes. Collectively, these measures were designed to mitigate delivery risk, support business continuity, and enable a timely and controlled response to potential organisational change.
Southport Inquiry	Southport Inquiry Report , in April 2026. We also delivered a media engagement plan to explain the evidence to the wider public, provide reassurance to the public, and offer clear leadership to the youth justice sector.

Deliverables	Description
Supporting Ministerial priorities	Aligned organisational activity to Ministerial priorities for youth justice reform across England and Wales.
Wellbeing	Recognised the potential impact of organisational ambiguity and change, invested in staff wellbeing through flexible working arrangements, wellbeing support, awareness activity and structured listening spaces. These interventions have supported colleagues to remain healthy and engaged, contributing to organisational resilience and sustained performance.
Welsh Language Act	Continued working with the Welsh Language Commissioner to ensure compliance with the Welsh Language Act 1993 .
White Ribbon	Supported work towards White Ribbon Accreditation to strengthen the organisation's commitment to ending Violence Against Women and Girls and promoting a safe and inclusive workplace culture.



Sustainability

The YJB produced its annual report in line with the mandatory requirements and disclosures of HMT's Financial Reporting Manual (FReM), Sustainability Reporting Guidance (SRG) 2025/26, and HMT's TCFD-aligned Disclosure Requirements 2025/26.

De minimis thresholds for reporting on sustainability and climate-related performance are over 500 full time equivalent or £500m in operating income or grant funding. As a smaller public entity of 96 full time equivalent and £106m grant funding, we do not meet this threshold. MoJ reports on and discloses the consolidated position of sustainability and climate-related performance for MoJ and its entities in its Annual Report and Accounts and, where necessary, the YJB.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Stephanie Roberts-Bibby', with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Stephanie Roberts-Bibby

Chief Executive and Accounting Officer

3 September 2026





Accountability report 2025/26

- Accountability report
- Remuneration and staff report
- Parliamentary accountability and audit report
- The certificate and report of the Comptroller and Auditor General to the Houses of Parliament





Accountability report

Corporate governance report

This section of the report outlines our governance over 2025/26.

Board members

The Crime and Disorder Act 1998 provides that the Youth Justice Board (YJB) shall be formed of between 10 and 12 members appointed by the Secretary of State. The Non-Executive Board members who served during the year were:

Name	Position	Gender	Date of appointment	Date of leaving
 Phillip Bowen	Non-Executive Member (Interim Chair from 12 February 2026)	M	01/03/2023	Ongoing
 Keith Fraser	Non-Executive Member (Previous Chair)	M	01/01/2018	31/12/2025
 Duwayne Brooks	Non-Executive Member	M	01/03/2023	28/02/2026
 Jacob Sakil	Non-Executive Member	M	01/12/2020	Ongoing



Name	Position	Gender	Date of appointment	Date of leaving
 Louise Shorter	Non-Executive Member, and Chair of the People and Remuneration Committee	F	01/12/2020	Ongoing
 Susannah Hancock	Non-Executive Member (Chair of the Performance Committee until December 2025)	F	01/12/2020	Ongoing
 Robert Sullivan	Non-Executive Member (Chair of the Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee, and Senior Independent Director from February 2025)	M	01/11/2024	Ongoing
 Martin Pratt	Non-Executive Member	M	01/11/2024	Ongoing
 Karin Phillips	Non-Executive Member (Co-Chair of the Wales Youth Justice Advisory Panel)	F	01/11/2024	Ongoing

Biographies of our Non-Executive Board members are available [online](#).

We have adopted a code of conduct for our Non-Executive Board members. The code, along with a register of [members' interests](#), can be found on the biography page referenced above.

Senior Leadership Group

This year our Senior Leadership Group (SLG) consisted of the following Executive management:

Name	Position	Gender	Date of appointment	Date of leaving
 Stephanie Roberts-Bibby	Chief Executive and Accounting Officer	F	22/11/2023	Ongoing
 Cheryl de Freitas	Chief Operating Officer	F	01/07/2025	Ongoing
 Karis Oram	Interim Chief Business and Transformation Officer (from 01/07/2025); Interim Chief Operating Officer (from 16/09/2024); Executive Director of Business Intelligence and Insights	F	14/02/2022	Ongoing
 Kate Langley	Executive Director of Operations (South of England)	F	01/06/2023	Ongoing

Name	Position	Gender	Date of appointment	Date of leaving
 Louise Wood	Executive Director of Operations (North of England)	F	03/10/2022	Ongoing
 Paula Williams	Executive Director of Operations Cymru (Wales) (from 02/06/2025)	F	17/02/2024	Ongoing
 Ann Skamarauskas	Executive Director of People and Organisational Development	F	01/12/2016	Ongoing
 Hannah Collyer	Interim Executive Director of Business Intelligence and Insights	F	19/09/2024	Ongoing
 Lynzi Jarman	Executive Director of Operations Cymru (Wales)	F	05/09/2018	30/05/2025



A list of all Board and SLG members who were in post during the year is set out in the remuneration and staff report.

The Chief Executive, as Accounting Officer, is responsible for ensuring that public funds made available to the Youth Justice Board are used for the purposes intended by Parliament, that effective internal controls are maintained, and that proper accounts are prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Secretary of State. Further details of the responsibilities of the Accounting Officer are set out in the Statement of Accounting Officer's Responsibilities.

Company directorships and other significant interests

All Board members and senior officials are required to declare any company directorships and other significant interests. These declarations are reviewed and managed in line with the YJB's governance arrangements to ensure there is no actual or perceived conflict with their responsibilities.

Personal data incidents

No personal data breaches were reported to the [Information Commissioner's Office \(ICO\)](#) during the year.

Basis of accounts

The statement of accounts has been prepared in a form directed by the Secretary of State and is issued in accordance with the Crime and Disorder Act 1998.

Auditors

The financial statements are audited by the Comptroller and Auditor General (C&AG), who is appointed by statute. The audit fee is disclosed in Note 2.1. This does not include any fees for non-audit work as no such work was undertaken.

Welsh language compliance

We are committed to the principle of treating the English and Welsh languages on a basis of equality when conducting public business in Wales. Our [Welsh language scheme](#), last updated in July 2023, sets out how we meet the statutory principles established in Welsh law and how these are applied in the delivery of the YJB's functions. We also provide an annual monitoring report to the Welsh Language Commissioner to demonstrate compliance and progress

Statement of Accounting Officer's responsibilities

The Principal Accounting Officer of the MoJ has designated the Chief Executive of the YJB as the Accounting Officer for the YJB.

The responsibilities of an Accounting Officer, including responsibility for the propriety and regularity of the public finances, for keeping proper records, and for safeguarding the YJB's assets, are set out in Managing Public Money, published by HM Treasury. As Accounting Officer, the Chief Executive is personally responsible to Parliament for these matters.

Under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998, the Secretary of State, with the approval of HM Treasury, has directed us to prepare for each financial year a statement of accounts in the form and on the basis set out in the Accounts Direction. The accounts are prepared on an accruals basis and must give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the YJB, of its net expenditure, Statement of Financial Position, and the changes in taxpayers' equity and cash flows for the financial year.

Under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998, the Accounting Officer discharges these responsibilities on behalf of the Board, which is required by legislation to keep proper accounting records and to prepare a statement of accounts for each financial year.

In preparing the accounts, the Accounting Officer is required to comply with the requirements of the [Government Financial Reporting Manual \(FReM\)](#) and, in particular, to:

- observe the Accounts Direction issued by the Secretary of State, including the relevant accounting and disclosure requirements, and apply appropriate accounting policies on a consistent basis;
- make judgements and estimates on a reasonable basis;
- state whether applicable accounting standards, as set out in the FReM, have been followed and disclose and explain any material departures in the financial statements; and
- prepare the financial statements on a going concern basis.

As Accounting Officer, I have taken all the steps that I ought to have taken to make myself aware of any relevant audit information and to establish that the Youth Justice Board's auditors are aware of that information. As far as I am aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the auditors are unaware.

I confirm that the Annual Report and Accounts, taken as a whole, is fair, balanced and understandable, and I take personal responsibility for the Annual Report and Accounts and the judgements required to reach that conclusion.

Signed by



Stephanie Roberts-Bibby

Chief Executive and Accounting Officer

3 September 2026



Governance statement

Introduction by Stephanie Roberts-Bibby, Chief Executive and Accounting Officer of the Youth Justice Board for England and Wales

As Chief Executive and Accounting Officer of the Youth Justice Board (YJB), I am accountable for the proper use of public funds and for the delivery of the YJB's statutory responsibilities.

This includes responsibility for the budget formally delegated to me by the Ministry of Justice, and oversight of Ministry of Justice funding made available to the YJB to support delivery of our functions. I discharge these responsibilities within the authority and conditions set out in my formal letter of delegation from the Ministry of Justice.

During 2025/26, the YJB maintained governance, risk management, assurance and financial control arrangements designed to support effective delivery, safeguard public resources, and promote regularity, propriety, value for money, transparency and accountability.

This Governance Statement explains the governance framework, risk management arrangements, assurance processes and internal controls that operated during the year. It also describes how these arrangements supported the responsible management of public resources, consistent with the principles set out in [Managing Public Money](#).

Based on the assurances available to me, I am not aware of any matters within my delegated responsibility during 2025/26 that had a material impact on the regularity or propriety of the YJB's use of public funds.

Governance framework

The YJB is a non-departmental public body established under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998. Our statutory functions and role were set out earlier in this Annual Report and Accounts in the *"Who we are and what we do section"*.

Framework document

The YJB operates within a [Framework Document](#) agreed with the MoJ. This sets out the governance, accountability and working arrangements between the two organisations.

The Framework Document covers:

- YJB's core responsibilities, including the individual responsibilities of the Chair, Board members, and Chief Executive
- Ministry of Justice's responsibilities as sponsor department, including the roles of ministers and the Principal Accounting Officer
- the governance and accountability relationships between MoJ and YJB
- the day-to-day working arrangements between the two organisations, including governance, financial management, reporting and the conditions attached to public funding.

The Framework Document supports clear accountability by defining roles, responsibilities and decision-making arrangements. It also helps ensure that public resources are managed properly, while recognising the YJB's operational independence within its statutory remit. This is consistent with the wider accountability principles reflected in the YJB's Annual Report and Accounts and in [Managing Public Money](#), including proper stewardship, regularity, propriety and safeguarding public funds.

Strategic and business planning

The [Youth Justice Board's Strategic Plan 2024–2027](#) sets out our vision, mission, and strategic objectives for the period covered by this Annual Report and Accounts. The Strategic Plan is informed by evidence on what works in youth justice, the statutory responsibilities placed on the YJB, and the strategic steer provided by ministers. It provides the framework within which our annual business planning and delivery activity for 2025/26 was undertaken.

Our annual Business Plan translates the Strategic Plan into clear priorities, commitments, and activities for the year, ensuring alignment between long-term strategic intent, Government missions, and day-to-day delivery.

Our Chair, Board and committees

Chair and Board

The Chair and Board provide strategic leadership and set the overall direction of the YJB, ensuring that our priorities are aligned with relevant Government missions and carried out in line with our statutory remit. The Board is responsible for setting strategic choices, overseeing performance, and holding the executive to account for delivery.

Non-Executive Board members are appointed by the Secretary of State for Justice in accordance with the Governance Code for Public Appointments, issued by the Office of the Commissioner for Public Appointments. Under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998, the Board should comprise between 10 and 12 members, appointed by the Secretary of State.

At 31 March 2026, the Board comprised seven members, including the Chair. During the year, no new members were appointed to replace those whose tenures had concluded. Tenures were, however, extended where necessary to ensure continuity of existing skills, experience, and representation. The composition of the Board includes specific representation for Wales, reflecting the distinct youth justice context.

A full list of current and recent Non-Executive Board members, together with brief biographies and their registers of interests, is published on GOV.UK.

The Chief Executive and members of the Senior Leadership Group (SLG) attend Board meetings as required to support effective governance, provide assurance, and contribute expertise.

The Board met formally four times during 2025/26. Where attendance was affected by individual circumstances, continuity of governance was maintained through the active engagement and participation of other Board members.



Committees

The Board is supported by a number of committees, which provide assurance, oversight, and challenge and report regularly to the Board, escalating matters where appropriate. These are:

- Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee (FARAC)
- Performance Committee (PC) – This committee was disbanded, with its last meeting taking place in December 2025
- People and Remuneration Committee (PRem)
- Wales Youth Justice Advisory Panel (WYJAP), which is jointly operated with the Welsh Government.

A schedule of attendance at formal Board meetings is shown in the following table.

Meeting attendance in 2025/26

Meeting attendance by eligible members between 1 April 2025 and 31 March 2026					
Member	YJB Board	Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee (FARAC)	Performance Committee (PC)	People and Remuneration Committee (PRem)	Wales Youth Justice Advisory Panel (WYJAP)
Keith Fraser	3 of 3	5 of 5	3 of 3	3 of 3	2 of 2
Duwayne Brooks	-	-	-	-	-
Jacob Sakil	4 of 4	2 of 6	-	-	-
Louise Shorter	4 of 4	-	-	4 of 4	-
Phillip Bowen	4 of 4	1 of 1	3 of 3	1 of 1	1 of 1
Susannah Hancock	4 of 4	5 of 6	3 of 3	-	-
Karin Phillips	4 of 4	5 of 6	1 of 3	4 of 4	4 of 4
Martin Pratt	4 of 4	-	3 of 3	3 of 4	-
Robert Sullivan	3 of 4	6 of 6	3 of 3	1 of 4	-
Stephanie Roberts-Bibby	4 of 4	6 of 6	2 of 3	3 of 4	3 of 3
Karis Oram	3 of 4	4 of 6	2 of 3	3 of 4	-
Cheryl de Freitas	2 of 3	2 of 2	2 of 2	2 of 3	1 of 1

Note: Not all board members and senior executives were eligible to attend every meeting. Attendance figures are therefore shown as the number of meetings attended out of the number each member was eligible to attend.

Board meetings and committee meetings are attended by Non-Executive Board members, relevant members of the Senior Leadership Group (SLG), and other YJB staff as required. Meetings of the Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee (FARAC) are also attended by representatives from the Government Internal Audit Agency (GIAA), the National Audit Office (NAO), and relevant Ministry of Justice (MoJ) officials.

Details of Board and committee membership are set out in the Accountability Report.

All Board committees met on a quarterly basis during the year, with the exception of the FARAC. In addition to its scheduled quarterly meetings, the FARAC held two further meetings specifically convened to review and approve the Annual Report and Accounts for 2024/25, resulting in six meetings in total during the year.

The work of the Board and its committees is governed by the YJB's Board Operating Framework, which sets out the committees' terms of reference, standing orders, and roles and responsibilities. This framework supports effective decision making, clear accountability, and robust governance across the organisation.

The **Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee (FARAC)** provides focused scrutiny of the YJB's corporate governance, financial management, and risk framework. It advises the Board on the effectiveness of risk management, internal control, and governance processes, and considers the planned activity and findings of both internal and external audit.

The **Performance Committee** had two primary roles. First, it oversaw and scrutinised delivery of the YJB's Strategic Plan, Business Plan, and Delivery Plan. Secondly, it provided assurance to the Board on the effectiveness of the YJB's system oversight role, including progress against the statutory aim of preventing offending and reoffending by children. This assurance was informed by the Committee's review of the quarterly Corporate Performance Report, which tracked delivery of internal activity, monitored trends in youth justice data, and provided updates on local Youth Justice Service performance.

To simplify the YJB's internal governance structures and ensure the right information is considered in the appropriate fora, a Board decision was taken to disband the Performance Committee. Its responsibilities were redistributed, with organisational performance oversight moving to the Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee, and system performance becoming a standing item for the Board.

The **Wales Youth Justice Advisory Panel (WYJAP)** oversees progress against the YJB's strategic objectives in Wales and takes a whole system view of youth justice delivery. It identifies opportunities for system improvement and acts as a strategic reference group for both the YJB Board and the Welsh Government's youth justice change initiatives. The Panel is jointly chaired by the YJB Board member for Wales and the Deputy Director of the Welsh Government Community Safety Division and is attended by senior representatives from key youth justice partners in Wales.

The **People and Remuneration Committee (PRem)** oversee matters relating to the remuneration and terms of employment of YJB staff. This includes scrutiny of senior pay arrangements, consideration of the Chief Executive's appraisal and those of any senior civil servant equivalents, and oversight of the appointment of staff who report directly to the Chief Executive. As part of wider governance reforms, it now meets less frequently on a fixed schedule, with elements of workforce reporting and discussion taking place through Board and reform governance structures.



The Senior Leadership Group

The Senior Leadership Group (SLG) provides executive leadership of the Youth Justice Board and is responsible for translating the Board's strategic direction into effective delivery. The SLG drives performance against the Strategic Plan and Business Plan through a programme of themed meetings covering strategy, finance, performance, people, and organisational resilience.

The SLG is chaired by the Chief Executive and includes the Chief Operating Officer, Chief Business and Transformation Officer, Directors of each directorate and the Head of Finance. Through collective leadership, the SLG ensures that statutory responsibilities are discharged effectively, financial management and control are robust, risks are managed appropriately, and resources are deployed in line with organisational priorities.

Our directorates

Operations – North, South and Cymru

The Operations Directorate leads the YJB's engagement with the youth justice system across England and Wales. It supports the delivery of the YJB's statutory responsibilities through oversight, performance monitoring and direct engagement with youth justice services (YJSs), local partnerships and national stakeholders.

The directorate plays a central role in assessing system performance, supporting continuous improvement, and identifying emerging risks and opportunities across the sector. It also leads the YJB's strategic engagement in Wales, working closely with Welsh Government and national partners to support the delivery of youth justice priorities.

Key responsibilities include:

- directing engagement and intelligence-gathering with youth justice partnerships, inspectorates and national stakeholders to support delivery of the Board's aims and identify risks and opportunities;
- delivering statutory oversight through system monitoring, the identification and promotion of effective practice, and support for service improvement;
- monitoring performance across the youth justice system, including compliance with the [Standards for children in the youth justice system](#) in England and Wales; and
- leading strategic relationships in Wales with Welsh Government ministers and officials, YJS Managers Cymru, the Children's Commissioner for Wales, Welsh inspectorates, policing and criminal justice partners, and leaders across children's services and education.

Through this work, the directorate helps strengthen system performance, supports service improvement and provides assurance on the effective operation of the youth justice system across England and Wales.

Business and Transformation Directorate

The Business and Transformation Directorate supports the YJB to operate as an effective, resilient and well-governed public body. It provides the corporate, financial, digital, governance and change functions required to deliver the YJB's statutory responsibilities and strategic priorities.



The directorate brings together expertise in finance, governance, risk and assurance, digital and technology, strategy, business change and organisational improvement. It ensures that effective systems, processes and controls are in place to support delivery and accountability.

Key responsibilities include:

- leading corporate governance, programme and portfolio management, and organisational change activity to support strategic priorities and reform programmes;
- overseeing financial management, budgeting and financial control, and providing assurance on propriety, regularity and value for money;
- administering the youth justice grant to local authorities;
- managing risk, benefits and assurance frameworks, including the coordination of internal audit activity and oversight of action tracking and delivery;
- providing digital, data and technology leadership, including information assurance and the development and maintenance of core systems;
- supporting effective decision-making through high-quality management information, reporting and performance insight; and
- enabling effective ways of working through business support, corporate processes and cross-organisational collaboration.

Through this work, the directorate ensures that the YJB has the infrastructure, systems and capability required to respond effectively to change, support delivery and maintain confidence among ministers, partners and auditors.

Executive and Communications Central Office

The Executive and Communications Central Office (ECCO) provide direct support to the Chief Executive, Board and SLG, and plays a central role in promoting effective governance, communications and organisational coordination across the YJB.

The directorate brings together the Secretariat and Communications functions, ensuring effective decision-making, clear information flows and consistent communication with internal and external stakeholders. It supports leadership in meeting the YJB's accountability, transparency and public-facing responsibilities.

Key responsibilities include:

- providing comprehensive secretariat support to the Board, Board committees, Senior Leadership Group and executive leadership team, including the coordination of agendas, papers, decisions and action tracking;
- supporting the Chief Executive, Chief Operating Officer, Chief Business Transformation Officer and Chair through diary management, correspondence handling and administrative support;
- managing ministerial correspondence, submissions and briefings, including responses to Parliamentary Questions, Freedom of Information requests and complaints;
- delivering internal and external communications that are timely, accurate and aligned with organisational priorities and government requirements;
- maintaining the YJB's public profile through publications, GOV.UK updates, digital channels and the Youth Justice Resource Hub;

- supporting organisational engagement through internal communications, staff briefings, newsletters and leadership communications; and
- coordinating stakeholder engagement activities, including events, webinars and other communications activities.

Through this work, ECCO supports effective leadership, strengthens organisational accountability and ensures that the YJB's work is communicated clearly to Parliament, ministers, partners, staff and the public.

People and Organisational Development Directorate

The People and Organisational Development Directorate supports the YJB by ensuring it has the workforce capability, organisational culture and operational resilience required to deliver its statutory responsibilities effectively.

The directorate plays a central role in developing and sustaining a high-performing organisation through workforce planning, leadership development, inclusion, learning and organisational effectiveness. Its work supports both organisational stability and continuous improvement, particularly during periods of change.

Key responsibilities include:

- developing and overseeing the YJB's people strategy, covering workforce planning, recruitment, retention, reward, equity, diversity and inclusion, and capability development;
- providing professional advice and assurance to the Chief Executive and Board on people-related matters, including workforce risks and organisational capability;
- coordinating delivery of the YJB's organisational development plan, supporting culture change, leadership development and improved ways of working;
- providing management information and analysis to support evidence-based decisions on workforce capacity, resourcing and organisational health;
- supporting health, safety and wellbeing arrangements and promoting a safe and inclusive working environment; and
- managing organisational facilities and supporting business continuity and organisational resilience planning.

Through this work, the directorate helps ensure that the YJB remains an inclusive, capable and resilient organisation, equipped to support its staff and sustain high standards of delivery in the public interest.

Business Intelligence and Insights

The Business Intelligence and Insights Directorate provides analytical, research, digital and stakeholder engagement expertise to support the delivery of all YJB functions and strengthen oversight of the youth justice system.

The directorate plays a key role in generating and applying evidence to inform policy, practice and decision-making. It supports the collection, analysis and dissemination of information and insight across the youth justice system, helping to strengthen the evidence-base for improvement.

Key responsibilities include:

- improving access to data and insight through the development of reporting tools and analytical products for youth justice services;
- strengthening system oversight through the collection, analysis and publication of national youth justice data, including the Annual Youth Justice Statistics, quarterly data returns and the Youth Justice Data Summary;
- delivering and developing the Youth Justice Application Framework (YJAF) and related digital services to support secure and effective information flows across the youth justice system;
- commissioning and publishing high-quality research to address priority evidence gaps and support evidence-led policy and practice;
- engaging with external research, analytical and policy networks, including the Academic Liaison Network and cross-government groups; and
- convening stakeholder forums and advisory groups to support collaboration, learning and sector engagement.

Through this work, the directorate strengthens the evidence-base for youth justice, supports informed decision-making and promotes continuous improvement across the youth justice system.

Account of corporate governance

Parliamentary accountability

The Secretary of State for Justice is accountable to Parliament for the activities and performance of the YJB. The Secretary of State's responsibilities include:

- approving the YJB's strategic objectives and the policy and resources framework within which it operates
- accounting to Parliament for the YJB's performance and use of public funds
- securing grant-in-aid for the YJB and obtaining Parliamentary approval for that funding
- appointing the YJB's Chair and Non-Executive Board members; and
- laying the YJB's Annual Report and Accounts before Parliament.

The Chair is accountable to the Secretary of State for Justice and is responsible for ensuring that the YJB operates effectively, supports the minister for Youth Justice, and conducts its affairs with probity and integrity.

The Chair, Chief Executive, and other senior officials may be called upon to appear before Parliamentary committees, commissions, and inquiries to give evidence on the YJB's work, the operation of the youth justice system, and the stewardship of public funds.

The YJB provides information to the MoJ and other government departments as required to support responses to Parliamentary Questions (PQs). During the year, the YJB did not provide substantive contributions to Parliamentary Questions.



The role of the Board

The Board has collective responsibility for ensuring that the YJB delivers the strategic objectives agreed with the Secretary of State for Justice, makes effective and efficient use of staff and other resources, and discharges its statutory functions.

The Board provides strategic leadership, oversight and challenge, and holds the executive to account for performance, governance, and risk management. The full duties, responsibilities, and delegated authorities of the Board are set out in the [MoJ/YJB Framework Document](#), which governs the working relationship between the department and the YJB.

Board effectiveness

The Chair completed end-of-year performance reviews for individual Board members in respect of their contribution during 2025/26. The annual performance appraisal of the Chair is undertaken by the Director General Policy - Courts and Access to Justice, and interim Director General - Prisons, Offenders and Analysis on behalf of the Secretary of State for Justice, to whom the outcome of that assessment is reported.

The Board undertook an independent review of Board effectiveness, which commenced in September 2023 and concluded in December 2024. An action plan was developed following receipt of the final report, and implementation of the agreed actions continued during 2025/26. This work is supporting further strengthening of Board practice, skills, and effectiveness.

The annual internal Board effectiveness review was not undertaken during 2025/26 due to the concurrent Public Bodies Review and cross-government Arm's Length Bodies Review, resulting in the subsequent reform of youth justice proposals, including reform of the YJB.

The provision of information and data to the Board

The Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee receive a quarterly performance highlight report to support its oversight of progress against the YJB's Strategic Plan, Business Plan, and Delivery Plan. The quarterly Board also receives performance information on the youth justice system, aligned to the four system aims and key performance indicators.

Following each meeting, the Committee Chair provides an update to the full Board, highlighting key areas of discussion and identifying issues requiring escalation or Board-level consideration. This process supports effective challenge, informed decision-making, and collective accountability.

Performance reporting provides the Board with data and analysis on system performance, including first time entrants, use of custody, remand, reoffending, knife and offensive weapon offences, behaviour management, the secure estate, performance and risk in local youth justice services, and delivery against the Business Plan and statutory functions.

This reporting draws on multiple data sources, including the Police National Computer (PNC), data submitted by youth justice services through the Youth Justice Application Framework, and information provided by secure establishments. Data is subject to routine quality assurance, with any issues identified and resolved in discussion with youth justice services.

Data sourced from the PNC and the secure estate is not managed by the YJB and is therefore subject to the quality assurance arrangements of the organisations responsible for those systems. Corporate and financial management information is drawn from systems provided by the MoJ.

Ministerial Directions

No Ministerial Directions were sought or issued during 2025/26.

Payment of grants to youth justice services

Under section 41(5) of the Crime and Disorder Act 1998, the YJB has the authority, with the approval of the Secretary of State for Justice, to allocate grants to local authorities and other bodies for the purposes of operating the youth justice system and providing youth justice services.

In 2025/26, we allocated £94.5 million grant funding to youth justice services based on assessed need and in accordance with the approved Terms and Conditions of Grant. These arrangements support local flexibility, enabling youth justice services to direct resources to priority areas in line with their local youth justice plans and statutory responsibilities.

Grant funding is released only once the Terms and Conditions have been formally accepted. Acceptance is evidenced through sign-off by both the local authority Chief Financial Officer and the Youth Justice Service Manager. As part of our assurance arrangements, we receive costed plans from each youth justice service, in advance of the financial year and audit certificates after the year end, providing assurance over the regularity and propriety of grant expenditure.

Performance oversight

Our approach to performance oversight is set out in the Oversight Framework, which provides a structured and transparent approach to monitoring service delivery, promoting effective practice, and supporting improvement where required. The framework supports a consistent approach to assurance across the youth justice system and strengthens our understanding of system performance and risk.

Oversight activity draws on both quantitative and qualitative evidence. Detailed analysis includes consideration of key youth justice indicators such as first-time entrants, proven reoffending, and the use of custody. This is complemented by qualitative assessments of how local partnerships align with the standards for children in the youth justice system. We also now collect and analyse ten further new key performance indicators along with several sub-measures for each indicator, which we share via a dashboard with youth justice services on a quarterly basis. These include accommodation, education, training and employment (ETE), and special educational needs or disability (SEND) / additional learning needs.

We also review annual Youth justice plans and draw on a wide range of intelligence sources, including direct engagement with services, inspection outcomes, and progress against post-inspection improvement plans. Together, these sources provide a comprehensive view of performance and enable proportionate challenge and support.

Where performance indicates a need for improvement, we provide targeted oversight and improvement support and actively promote sector-led improvement activity. Where progress is difficult to sustain, established escalation processes are in place, including escalation to Chief Executive and ministerial levels, ensuring that issues of concern are addressed at the appropriate level.

Internal audit

We commission the Government Internal Audit Agency (GIAA) to provide an independent and



objective internal audit service to the Youth Justice Board. Internal audit work is carried out in accordance with the [Public Sector Internal Audit Standards](#) and the GIAA's approved methodology.

The GIAA prepares an annual internal audit plan based on its assessment of the risks facing the organisation. This assessment is informed by discussions with members of the Senior Leadership Group (SLG) and consideration of the YJB's strategic objectives, risk profile, and control environment. The internal audit plan is reviewed and endorsed by the Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee (FARAC) and formally approved by the Chief Executive, as Accounting Officer.

The implementation of agreed internal audit recommendations is monitored by management and overseen by FARAC, providing assurance to the Board on progress and the effectiveness of management action.

The GIAA issues an assurance rating for each completed audit, reflecting its assessment of the adequacy and effectiveness of the control framework in the area reviewed. The definitions of these assurance ratings are set out below.

Assurance rating	Definition
Substantial	The framework of governance, risk management and control is adequate and effective.
Moderate	Some improvements are required to enhance the adequacy and effectiveness of the framework of governance, risk management and control.
Limited	There are significant weaknesses in the framework of governance, risk management and control such that it could or could become inadequate and ineffective.
Unsatisfactory	There are fundamental weaknesses in the framework of governance, risk management and control such that it is inadequate and ineffective or is likely to fail.

The commissioned and completed audits for 2025/26 are tabled below, alongside the GIAA's assurance rating:

Audit undertaken	Assurance rating
Learning and Development	Moderate
Administration of the Core Grant	Moderate
Insights	Moderate
Use of Data	Moderate

Overall view of internal audit

GIAA provides the Accounting Officer with an annual report which gives the overall opinion for the year on our frameworks for risk management, control and governance. A copy of the annual report is also submitted to the first Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee meeting of the financial year.

The report for 2025/26 indicated an “annual opinion of ‘Moderate’ on the adequacy and effectiveness of the framework of governance, risk management and control”.

Risk management

Risk management processes are coordinated at a corporate level through the Risk Team which provides regular and effective reporting to the Senior Leadership Group (SLG).

The SLG, Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee and the Board have continued to review and challenge the progress made to manage and mitigate the risks and issues documented in our Strategic Risk Register.

The risk management framework

The YJB risk management framework is aligned with [HM Treasury: The Orange Book, Management of Risk - Principles and Concepts](#) and sets out the entire risk management system within the organisation.

Risk profile

Throughout the business year, we review strategic risks quarterly with the Senior Leadership Group collectively. Strategic risks are also discussed at the quarterly Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee meetings. The YJB’s risk management is compliant with the [Government Financial Reporting Manual 2025/26](#), [Government Functional Standards](#) and in line with [HM Treasury’s Orange Book – Management of Risk: Principles and Concepts](#).

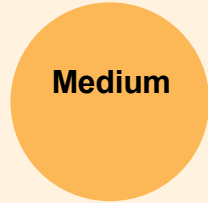
Our principal risks and mitigating actions identified during 2025/26 are set out below with the corresponding Very High/High/Medium/Low.

Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to fulfil our statutory function to provide sound, timely, evidence-based advice to ministers about how to prevent offending by children. Context: The YJB requires a sufficient evidence-base to support the advice provided to ministers and the delivery of its statutory monitoring function.	▪ completed the development of the Key Performance Indicator (KPI) and Youth Justice Data Summary (YDS) dashboards and integrated them into our established approach to performance monitoring and reporting, strengthening the evidence-base available to support decision-making. ▪ continued to review and quality assure our datasets, in particular work in relation to the KPI data, including publication of a Quality and Methodology Information paper in June 2025, work to address data issues raised by dashboard users, and updates over time to the KPI guidance to support effective data capture. ▪ continued to improve, embed and promote use of Infobase and Intelligent Contacts. ▪ completed research projects: - Prevention and diversion tool evaluation, - applying the Child First evidence-base, and - learning from the 2024 disturbances: Insights from youth justice services. ▪ developed position statements on victims and Violence Against Women and Girls. ▪ published annual statistics and annual insights report, and ▪ produced a report on emerging trends and themes.	 Medium Q1 Medium - Q4 Medium



Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to effectively deliver our statutory monitoring function to prevent offending by children Context: Effective oversight arrangements are necessary to ensure the YJB can effectively carry out its statutory monitoring function and improve the performance of local youth justice services.	- completed all recommendations from the Government Internal Audit Agency relating to the internal audit of the oversight framework except for one which had a deadline of March 2027. - developed a new quarterly reporting template to improve consistency of reporting and reduce workload and duplication. The template was circulated to Operations staff and training delivered. Quality Assurance form also designed for Heads of Oversight to complete for their staff to ensure consistency and quality. - developed an improvement library (a repository for practical advice to support oversight teams in developing providing improvement support to frontline services). - organised four Developing Practice fora on victims, reoffending and Violence Against Women and Girls. - continued to promote the Youth Justice Apprenticeship across the sector.	 Medium Q1 Medium Q4 Medium

Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to adequately maintain and develop/ futureproof our IT systems and deliver our statutory function to support the IT provision to youth justice services. Context: The YJB requires strong and effective information technology systems to deliver its statutory functions to support the IT provision for youth justice services.	- completed a project to move YJAF to a new Amazon Web Services (AWS) platform. - undertook a technical audit of YJAF which informed the decision to its replacement. Awarded a contract to the successful bidder for the delivery of this work. - completed a discovery piece of work through a third-party supplier to improve information sharing between youth custody and community. Findings will inform the YJAF rebuild. - undertaken work to understand how Artificial Intelligence (AI) is used operationally as an organisation and across data systems for children.	 Q1 High Q4 Medium

Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to prevent a cyber incident to YJB services. Context: YJB systems deliver services over the Internet in line with wider government strategy, which exposes the organisation and our users to cyber risks	- YJB Cyber team ran a successful desktop exercise with the senior leadership team to measure how well the YJB business would run in the event of a cyber-attack; learning from that exercise has since been applied. - penetration tests were undertaken on the new YJAF platform and the Resource Hub; security rating for both was considered good. - implemented a paid for service (Wordfence) to provide a firewall security for WordPress which runs the Resource Hub website. - completed training in Secure by Design (SbD), a government-wide programme aiming to set security principles from the outset of digital projects. This approach is now being applied to all new digital projects.	 Q1 New risk opened in Q4 Q4 Medium



Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to realise the benefits of our work and evidence its full impact to prevent children from offending Context: By implementing a comprehensive approach to benefits management, we will be able to measure the effectiveness of our work, identify gaps and demonstrate our value.	- delivered nine recommendations from an internal audit on benefits management including fully updating our benefits management framework. - developed a benefits realisation plan to measure and track our strategic benefits (an annual benefits report summarising the results will be produced in 2026/27).	Medium Q1 Medium- Q4 Medium

Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to adhere to our organisational-wide governance processes, policies and functional standards, leading to a lack of corporate discipline and ability to maximise our resources. Context: The YJB requires effective governance processes to support the delivery of its statutory functions and strategic objectives.	- embedded the Portfolio Plan within our governance arrangements, providing a consistent mechanism for monitoring and reporting progress against the commitments set out in the YJB Business Plan 2025/26. - developed streamlined governance processes to ensure oversight and reporting while balancing the demands of the change programme. - developed a governance process for the change programme. - updated the YJB project management framework and developed an internal audit framework to ensure alignment and compliance with Government Functional Standards. - developed an internal audit framework.	Medium Q1 Medium- Q4 Medium

Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to maintain effective collaboration, trust and shared understanding with internal and external stakeholders during reform, undermining YJB's ability to deliver its statutory functions. Context: A lack of shared understanding of roles, responsibilities and priorities between the YJB and its sponsor department could compromise working relationships and ability to influence and deliver ministerial or YJB Board priorities effectively.	- continued to engage and influence Welsh Government and MoJ partners around issues of devolution. - continued to co-chair and work with Welsh Government to strengthen Welsh Youth Justice Advisory Panel arrangements. - created a supernumerary post using funding from the Welsh Government to take forward the work on Out-of-Court Resolutions.	 Q1 Medium- Q4 Medium

Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to secure sufficient and timely funding to effectively deliver our statutory functions and prevent offending by children. Context: Delays in confirming the YJB's budget and authority to spend, the absence of longer-term funding and efficiency requirements can impact on the YJB's ability to effectively deliver its statutory functions.	- engaged regularly with MoJ Finance to secure timely budget confirmation and escalate unresolved funding issues. - monitored budgets, payroll and workforce plans to identify pressures early and reprioritise resources where necessary. - provided evidence-based advice and financial scenarios to inform Spending Review and departmental funding decisions.	 Q1 Medium Q4 Medium



Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Failure to have sufficient and/or appropriately skilled staff to effectively deliver our strategic and business plans. Context: Through robust governance processes we will ensure our business commitments are proportionate to the size of our workforce. Our People Strategy will support the development of a learning culture.	▪ completed the 2025/26 pay remit process on schedule, enabling the approved pay award to be implemented in the August 2025 payroll for staff. ▪ defined an approach to undertake a skills gap audit in preparation for delivering the YJB's future operating model. ▪ fully utilised the Learning and Development (L&D) budget following an organisational-wide assessment of L&D needs. ▪ convened an in-person all-staff event in December 2025. ▪ rolled out a loyal service award policy for staff with 25 years of service. ▪ set up a working group to prepare the organisation for the change programme resulting from the public bodies review of the YJB and wider Arm's Length Bodies Review. ▪ developed and maintained an open and supportive work culture to retain and attract skilled staff by: ○ delivering clear and honest communication to staff about the change programme. ○ maintaining strong trade union relationships and actively addressing concerns raised. ○ being open in our job advertisements about the change programme. ○ continuing to regularly promote support available to staff, e.g. PAM Assist and Mental Health Allies. ○ supporting staff through a series of wellbeing seminars, financial support webinars and the work demands project.	 Medium Q1 Medium- Q4 Medium

Principal risks	Key mitigating actions and controls	RAG score
Risk: Ineffective/insufficient leadership at senior and Board level. Context: We will identify and develop the skills and capabilities needed at senior leadership and Board level to provide the direction, vision, motivation and inspiration needed to support the successful delivery of our core aims of reducing crime, creating safer communities and promoting positive outcomes for children.	▪ appointed a permanent Chief Operating Officer in July 2025. ▪ appointed a Chief Business and Transformation Officer in July 2025 on a temporary basis to support the YJB through the anticipated changes following the outcome of the public bodies review of the YJB and the wider review of ALBs. ▪ worked with the Public Appointments Team to secure extensions to the tenures of Karin Phillips MBE (from 1 June 2026 to 30 June 2027) and Jacob Sakil, Susannah Hancock and Louise Shorter (from 1 December 2026 to 30 June 2027). ▪ managed the transition of YJB Board leadership following Keith Fraser's departure as Chair, securing the former Deputy Prime Minister's approval for the extension of Phillip Bowen's appointment as Interim Chair from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027. ▪ completed the "Leading in Unpredictable Times" programme to strengthen individual and collective leadership capability during a period of significant organisational uncertainty and change.	 Q1 Medium- Q4 High



RAG Score	Response
	Risk exceeds acceptable level. - immediately determine a lower target score, devise additional controls to reduce risk to this level and ensure contingency plans in place. - immediately report to next management level, which will decide a response (e.g. actions / for information) and inform the reporting management level.
	Risk exceeds desirable level. - determine lower target score and additional controls unless this will not prove cost effective. In this case monitor closely and ensure contingency plans are in place. - report to the next management level which will decide a response (e.g. actions / for information) and inform the reporting management level.
	Risk acceptable but may require monitoring. - consider if risk can be removed from the register. Devise additional controls to reduce risk only where cost effective and proportionate. - manage risk within the local business.
	Acceptable level of risk. - consider whether there is a reason to retain on register? If retained, limit management action to monitoring the risk and escalating if its likelihood or impact increases. Review existing controls and remove any that are no longer required. - Manage the risk through local business arrangements where appropriate..

YJB assurance map

We measure the effectiveness of our mitigations for risks via an 'assurance map' based on guidance set out in [HM Treasury: The Orange Book – Management of Risks Principles and Concepts](#). This map sets out the assessment of key risks to the systems and processes that we must be assured are sufficiently managed. The control measures that are in place to mitigate our process and system-based risks are evaluated within the assurance map.

The evidence presented in the assurance map is reviewed and updated annually, this includes also being submitted to the Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee (FARAC) to provide independent assurance

Summary of assurance map

Controls	First line of defence	Second line of defence
- financial policies including the segregation of duties and internal delegation - strategic and business plans - YJS grant terms and conditions - fraud policies, training and escalation routes - staff policies and training - business continuity plan - risk management framework - communications strategy.	Business management assurance Assurance arrangements to document and monitor how well delivery objectives are met and risks are managed. These include: - monthly reporting - risk and asset registers - financial reconciliation processes - clear governance structures - line management checks.	Corporate oversight assurance This is separate from the work of those responsible for delivery, it includes: - scrutiny by the SLG - monitoring by our Health and Safety Committee - annual Governance Statement reporting - our Performance Oversight Board.
	Third line of defence	Independent
	Independent assurance This includes: - MoJ Grant Challenge and Assurance Panel - Finance, Audit, Risk and Assurance Committee oversight - Board oversight - MoJ Finance Business Partnering oversight - Government Internal Audit Agency audits.	External and independent assurance commissioned by bodies outside the organisation This includes: - National Audit Office reviews - MoJ Public Bodies Centre of Expertise oversight - His Majesty's Inspectorate of Probation/Office for Standards in Education, Children's Services and Skills joint inspection framework.



Information assurance, lapses of data security and freedom of information

The YJB maintains an Information Assurance Policy which sets out how the information we hold is managed and protected. The policy ensures that information is:

- handled securely;
- appropriately protected;
- as accurate and complete as possible; and
- made available to the right people, at the right time, and for appropriate purposes

The policy complies with the Cabinet Office [HMG Security Policy Framework](#) and supports compliance with data protection and information management requirements across the organisation.

The information and communication technology (ICT) systems operated or overseen by the YJB are managed in line with Government Digital Service requirements and guidance from the National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC), the UK government's technical authority for cyber security and information assurance. Ongoing work during the year continued to strengthen the resilience and security of our systems, reducing the risk of service disruption, data loss, or cyber-attack.

Lapses of data security

No personal data breaches were reported to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) during 2025/26. However, a small number of low-risk security incidents (42) were identified and managed in line with established procedures. None of these incidents were assessed as presenting a material risk of harm to the individuals concerned.

Whistleblowing and raising concerns

The YJB's whistleblowing and raising a concern policy sets out clearly how staff, including contractors and service providers, can raise concerns about potential wrongdoing. No whistleblowing cases were reported during the year.

Freedom of information

The YJB continues to meet its obligations under the Freedom of Information Act 2000. During 2025/26, we responded to 40 Freedom of Information requests, of which 37 were answered within the statutory 20-working-day timescale.

Health and safety

The YJB is committed to protecting the health, safety and wellbeing of its staff and visitors.

The Director of People and Organisational Development has overall accountability for health and safety. The day-to-day responsibilities are delegated to the Business Support Manager, who acts as the organisation's competent person. This role includes maintaining the Corporate Health and Safety Policy and overseeing delivery of the associated action plan.

The Corporate Health and Safety Committee provides formal oversight. It meets twice a year and is chaired by the Director of People and Organisational Development. Membership includes representatives from across the organisation, including trade union representatives, to support effective consultation and staff engagement.

The Committee reports to the Senior Leadership Group. An annual health and safety report is also submitted to the Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee (FARAC) to provide independent assurance.

These arrangements, supported by a health and safety action plan and risk register, enable the YJB to meet its statutory duties under the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974. The approach is aligned to the Health and Safety Executive's guidance on successful health and safety management (HSG65), covering policy, organisation, planning, implementation and performance monitoring.

During 2025/26, we continued to support the mental and physical wellbeing of staff through a combination of preventative activity, early intervention, manager support and inclusive wellbeing arrangements. This was particularly important during a period of organisational uncertainty.

Initiatives

Area	Description	Purpose and Outcomes
Wellbeing during change	Strengthened wellbeing support during organisational uncertainty, ensuring staff had access to support, information and opportunities to raise concerns.	Supported organisational resilience and helped identify wellbeing risks early.
Insight-led support	Used sickness absence data, workforce insight and staff feedback to understand emerging wellbeing pressures and target support.	Enabled a more evidence-based approach to managing wellbeing, absence and organisational health.
Manager capability	Supported managers in responding to wellbeing concerns through guidance on attendance, occupational health, reasonable adjustments and supportive conversations.	Promoted early intervention, consistent practice and safe, sustainable returns to work.
Inclusive wellbeing support	Maintained access to formal and informal support routes, including occupational health, employee assistance, mental health allies, reasonable adjustments and peer support.	Helped staff access the right support and promoted an inclusive, safe and supportive working environment.
Preventative wellbeing	Promoted healthy working practices, including workload awareness, regular breaks, use of annual leave and targeted wellbeing activity.	Supported staff to manage pressure, maintain balance and reduce the risk of avoidable absence.
Governance and assurance	Monitored wellbeing risks through workforce reporting, sickness absence analysis and health and safety governance arrangements.	Provided assurance that wellbeing risks were being identified, escalated and managed appropriately.

Signed by



Stephanie Roberts-Bibby

Chief Executive and Accounting Officer

3 September 2026



Remuneration and staff report

Remuneration policy

YJB staff, whether on permanent or fixed-term contracts, are public servants rather than civil servants. However, they have terms and conditions of employment (including pension arrangements) that are largely aligned with Civil Service terms, with any necessary adjustments for staff on legacy contracts.

The YJB does not offer performance-related pay to staff below the Senior Civil Service (SCS) level or equivalent grades. Pay and performance for staff in SCS or SCS-equivalent roles are managed in line with the Cabinet Office's SCS performance framework. The YJB also follows the [Civil Service Compensation Scheme](#) for any redundancy or related payments.

This report sets out the remuneration (salaries and benefits) of those serving on the YJB Board. It covers the Chair, all Non-Executive Board members, and the Executive Directors (namely the Chief Executive, the Chief Operating Officer, and the Chief Business and Transformation Officer).

These disclosures are made in line with HM Treasury requirements and the Government Financial Reporting Manual (FReM), which call for clear and transparent reporting. This ensures that the pay and benefits of individuals with significant influence over the YJB's direction and management are fully disclosed.

Board members' terms of appointment

Non-Executive Board members (including the Chair) are usually appointed for a term of up to four years. Subject to satisfactory performance and approval by the Secretary of State for Justice, they may be reappointed for further terms. In line with the Governance Code on Public Appointments, a Board member's total period of service should not normally exceed ten years. All reappointments are subject to a formal performance appraisal.

Keith Fraser, the previous Chair, completed his tenure and stepped down on 31 December 2025. Phillip Bowen was appointed to the YJB Board on 1 March 2023 and became Interim Chair on 12 February 2026. On 14 July 2026, the former Deputy Prime Minister, in his capacity as Secretary of State for Justice, approved a further appointment of Phillip Bowen as Interim Chair from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027.

The former Deputy Prime Minister also approved the further appointment of Karin Phillips MBE, the Board member with experience and knowledge of Wales, from 1 June 2026 to 30 June 2027, and extended the terms of Jacob Sakil, Susannah Hancock and Louise Shorter as Board members from 1 December 2026 to 30 June 2027.

Early termination of a Non-Executive Board member's appointment is at the discretion of the Secretary of State for Justice. In such cases, the standard notice period is 3 months.

Executive directors' terms of appointment

Executive Directors may join the YJB as permanent employees, on loan from the Civil Service, or as secondees from outside the Civil Service. The type of appointment depends on business need and the specific requirements of the role.

When a formal recruitment process is necessary, the YJB follows the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. This ensures that all recruitment is open, fair, and based on merit. These principles apply equally to candidates from within the Civil Service as well as those from outside it.

The YJB also operates a guaranteed interview scheme for disabled applicants who meet the essential criteria for a role. This scheme supports equality of opportunity and helps ensure compliance with the Public Sector Equality Duty.

People and Remuneration Committee

The People and Remuneration (PRem) Committee met four times during the year. It has delegated authority from the Board to consider and provide oversight of matters relating to senior pay, remuneration, and people governance.

The Committee's responsibilities include reviewing the annual performance appraisals of the Chief Executive, Chief Operating Officer, and Chief Business and Transformation Officer. It also approves any changes to the remuneration of the Chief Executive and those Senior Leadership Group (SLG) members who report directly to the Chief Executive. This remit extends to any arrangements or conditions for remuneration or benefits in kind beyond the basic salary, where applicable.

The PRem Committee comprises 5 Non-Executive Board members and is supported by relevant SLG members when required. This composition ensures an appropriate level of independence, challenge, and expertise in the Committee's oversight of people and remuneration matters.

Remuneration (audited information)

Board and Senior Leadership Group

The remuneration of our Chair and Non-Executive Board members is determined by the Secretary of State for Justice. Non-Executive Board member fees are £262.50 per day; this was increased from £250 per day on 1 December 2024 after our sponsor department, MoJ, reviewed remuneration to ensure that it was aligned with current expectations and needs. The Chair (Keith Fraser) and new Interim Chair (Phillip Bowen) were paid a salary. From 1 January 2026, in order to fulfil duties such as attending Board and sub-committee meetings, meeting with staff and stakeholders, conducting visits across England and Wales, and supporting the YJB through a period of reform, the Interim Chair's days were increased from two to three per month. No pension benefits are paid to Non-Executive Board members.

For the year ended 31 March 2026, our Non-Executive Board members and SLG members received remuneration as follows. Where an individual was not in post for the full year or on extended leave, a full year equivalent (FYE) figure is shown for comparative purposes.

For Non-Executive Board Members (audited information) £000

	2025/26					2024/25				
Name and Title	Salary/ Fees	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total	Salary/ Fees	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total
Phillip Bowen Board Member (Interim Chair from 12 February 2026)	20-25	–	–	–	20-25	5-10	–	–	–	5-10
Keith Fraser YJB Chair (to 31 December 2025)	30-35 (FYE 40- 45)	–	3.8	–	35-40	40-45	–	4.7	–	45-50
Susannah Hancock Board member	10-15	–	–	–	10-15	5-10	–	0.9	–	5-10
Louise Shorter Board member	5-10	–	0.1	–	5-10	5-10	–	1.4	–	10-15
Jacob Sakil Board member	5-10	–	–	–	5-10	5-10	–	0.4	–	5-10
Robert Sullivan Board member (from 1 November 2024)	5-10	–	–	–	5-10	0-5	–	–	–	0-5
Martin Pratt CBE Board member (from 1 November 2024)	5-10	–	–	–	5-10	0-5	–	0-5	–	0-5



	2025/26					2024/25				
Name and Title	Salary/ Fees	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total	Salary/ Fees	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total
Karin Phillips MBE Board member (from 1 November 2024)	10-15	–	2.6	–	15-20	0-5	–	1.0	–	0-5
Brian Tytherleigh¹ Board member (to 31 March 2025)	0-5	–	–	–	0-5	10-15	–	1.7	–	10-15
Neal Hazel Board member (to 31 August 2024)	–	–	–	–	–	0-5	–	0.5	–	0-5
Keith Towler Board member (to 30 September 2024)	–	–	–	–	–	5-10	–	0.3	–	5-10
Sharon Gray Board member (to 31 August 2024)	–	–	–	–	–	0-5	–	0.3	–	0-5
Duwayne Brooks² Board member (to 28 February 2026)	–	–	–	–	–	5-10	–	–	–	5-10

¹ Brian Tytherleigh left the Board on 31 March 2025. As Non-Executive Board member fees are paid one month in arrears, the fee relating to March 2025 was paid in April 2025.

² Duwayne Brooks was not an active Board member in 2025/26 and therefore did not receive any Board fees during the year.

Executive Management (audited information) £000

Name and Title	2025/26					2024/25				
	Salary	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total	Salary	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total
Stephanie Roberts-Bibby Chief Executive Officer	130-135	0-5	2.7	46	180-185	125-130	0-5	6.0	97	230-235
Cheryl de Freitas Chief Operating Officer (from 1 July 2025)	60-65 (FYE 80-85)	0-5 ³	–	28	95-100	–	–	–	–	–
Karis Oram Interim Chief Business and Transformation Officer (from 1 July 2025)	75-80 ⁴	0-5	–	24	100-105	65-70 (FYE 75-80)	–	–	62	130-135
Ann Skamarauskas Director of People and Organisational Development	80-85	–	–	33	110-115	75-80	–	–	29	105-110
Louise Wood Director of Operations North	70-75	–	–	28	95-100	65-70	–	–	27	95-100
Kate Langley Director of Operations South	70-75	0-5	–	28	95-100	65-70	–	–	27	95-100
Paula Williams Director of Operations Cymru (Wales) (from 2 June 2025)	70-75	–	–	29	100-105	70-75	–	–	23	90-95

³ The bonus paid to Cheryl de Freitas in 2025/26 relates to performance in her previous role prior to joining the YJB. Payment was approved by the People and Remuneration Committee.

⁴ Prior to 1 July 2025 Karis Oram held the post of Interim Chief Operating Officer. The remuneration reported is the amount received in both roles for the period.

	2025/26					2024/25				
Name and Title	Salary	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total	Salary	Bonuses	Benefits in kind (to nearest £100)	Pension benefits (to nearest £1,000)	Total
Hannah Collyer Interim Director of Business Intelligence and Insights (from 1 July 2024 to 3 August 2024 and from 16 September 2024)	75-80	0-5	–	30	105-110	45-50 (FYE 65-70)	–	–	18	60-65
Lynzi Jarman Director of Operations Cymru (Wales) (to 30 May 2025)	5-10 (FYE 65-70)	–	–	4	10-15	55-60	–	–	22	75-80
Jamie Bennett Chief Operating Officer (to 13 September 2024)	–	–	–	–	–	40-45 (FYE 115-120)	–	5.1	31	75-80

For an explanation of how bonuses are awarded, refer to the bonuses paragraph on page 80.



Benefits in kind – Board members

The monetary value of benefits in kind covers any benefits we provided, and reimbursements of costs treated by HM Revenue and Customs (HMRC) as a taxable emolument.

Non-Executive Board members are reimbursed for their travel and subsistence costs incurred in attending Board meetings at our central London headquarters and elsewhere.

Since Non-Executive Board members are deemed by HMRC to be our employees, the amounts of these reimbursements are treated as benefits in kind and are disclosed in the table above. The taxation arising on such expenses is borne by us.

Salary

Salary covers both pensionable and non-pensionable amounts and includes, but may not necessarily be confined to:

- gross salaries
- overtime
- reserved rights to London weighting or London allowances
- recruitment and retention allowances
- Private office allowances and any other allowance to the extent that it is subject to UK taxation.

Bonuses

Bonuses are based on performance levels and are awarded following the formal review process. The performance framework set by the Cabinet Office for the Senior Civil Service (SCS) is used as a guide for our executive managers graded as equivalent to the SCS. Our People and Remuneration Committee gives final approval of these bonuses.

Executive staff who are not graded as equivalent to SCS do not receive performance bonus payments. Our performance management guidance requires objective setting at the start of the year followed by regular, 4 weekly touchpoint meetings and a formal end of year review. Executive staff may be nominated for a special recognition award, usually a voucher for outstanding work or displayed exemplary behaviours.

Bonuses paid to SCS equivalent executives are included in the table above on a cash basis, so that bonuses disclosed for each year represent those paid to staff in that year but relate to performance in the previous year.

Benefits in kind – executive management (audited information)

The monetary value of benefits in kind covers any benefits provided by us and is treated by HMRC as a taxable emolument.

Pension benefits

Pension benefits are calculated as the real increase in pension multiplied by 20, plus the real increase in any lump sum, less contributions made by the employee. The real increases exclude increases due to inflation or any increase or decrease due to a transfer of pension rights.



Total remuneration for this calculation includes salary, non-consolidated performance-related pay, and benefits in kind. It does not include pension benefits, employer pension contributions and the cash equivalent transfer value of pensions.

Pension entitlements (audited information) £000

Name and Title	Accrued pension at age as at 31/03/2026	Real increase in pension at pension age	CETV at 31/03/2026	CETV at 31/03/2025	Real increase in CETV
Stephanie Roberts-Bibby Chief Executive Officer and Accounting Officer	50-55 plus a lump sum of 120-125	2.5-5 plus a lump sum of 0	1,055	968	28
Cheryl de Freitas Chief Operating Officer (from 01 July 2025)	25-30 plus a lump sum of 55-60	0-2.5 plus a lump sum of 0-2.5	494	454	16
Karis Oram Interim Chief Business and Transformation Officer (from 1 July 2025); Interim Chief Operating Officer (from 16 September 2024)	30-35	0-2.5	514	473	11
Ann Skamarauskas Director of People and Organisational Development	30-35	0-2.5	607	554	28
Paula Williams Director of Operations Cymru (Wales) (from 02/06/2025)	20-25	0-2.5	388	351	20
Louise Wood Director of Operations North	5-10	0-2.5	96	70	19
Kate Langley Director of Operations South	5-10	0-2.5	138	112	18
Hannah Collyer Interim Director of Business Intelligence and Insights (from 1 July 2024 to 3 August 2024 and from 16 September 2024)	5-10	0-2.5	98	76	14
Lynzi Jarman Director of Operations Cymru (Wales) (to 30 May 2025)	15-20	0-2.5	200	198	2

Civil Service pensions

Pension benefits are provided through the Civil Service Pension Scheme and are administered by Capita, which became the scheme administrator on 1 December 2025.

From 1 April 2015 a new pension scheme for civil servants was introduced – the Civil Servants and Others Pension Scheme or alpha, which provides benefits on a career average basis with a normal pension age equal to the member's state pension age (or 65 if higher). From that date all newly appointed civil servants and the majority of those already in service joined alpha. Prior to that date, civil servants participated in the Principal Civil Service Pension Scheme (PCSPS). The PCSPS has four sections: three providing benefits on a final salary basis (classic, premium or classic plus) with a normal pension age of 60; and one providing benefits on a whole career basis (nuvos) with a normal pension age of 65.

These statutory arrangements are unfunded with the cost of benefits met by monies voted by Parliament each year. Pensions payable under classic, premium, classic plus, nuvos and alpha are increased annually in line with pensions increase legislation. Existing members of the PCSPS who were within 10 years of their normal pension age on 1 April 2012 remained in the PCSPS after 1 April 2015. Those who were between 10 years and 13 years and 5 months from their normal pension age on 1 April 2012 switched into alpha sometime between 1 June 2015 and 1 February 2022. All members who switched to alpha had their PCSPS benefits 'banked', with those with earlier benefits in one of the final salary sections of the PCSPS having those benefits based on their final salary when they left alpha. The pension figures quoted for officials show pension earned in PCSPS or alpha - as appropriate. Where the official has benefits in both the PCSPS and alpha the figure quoted is the combined value of their benefits in the two schemes. Members joining from October 2002 may opt for either the appropriate defined benefit arrangement or a 'money purchase' stakeholder pension with an employer contribution (partnership pension account).

In 2018, the Court of Appeal found that the rules put in place in 2015 to protect older workers by allowing them to remain in their original scheme were discriminatory on the basis of age. As a result, steps have been taken to remedy those 2015 reforms, making the pension scheme provisions fair to all members. The pensions of those in scope of the 2015 remedy have been reported in the remuneration report on the basis of being in their relevant legacy scheme for the period between 1 April 2015 and 31 March 2022. On retirement, individuals will have a choice to elect to instead receive benefits under the terms of the alpha scheme for the remedy period.

The 2015 Remedy (McCloud) legislation remains in implementation. From July 2025, eligible members who opted out of the Civil Service Pension Scheme between 12 March 2012 and 28 February 2022 were able to apply to buy back pension service for the Remedy period (1 April 2015 to 31 March 2022), in accordance with Employer Pension Notice 738, issued by the Civil Service Pension Scheme administrator (Capita).

Accrued pension benefits included in this table for any individual affected by the Public Service Pensions Remedy have been calculated based on their inclusion in the legacy scheme for the period between 1 April 2015 and 31 March 2022, following the McCloud judgment. The Public Service Pensions Remedy applies to individuals that were members, or eligible to be members, of a public service pension scheme on 31 March 2012 and were members of a public service pension scheme between 1 April 2015 and 31 March 2022. The basis for the calculation reflects the legal position that impacted members have been rolled back into the relevant legacy scheme for the remedy period and that this will apply unless the member



actively exercises their entitlement on retirement to decide instead to receive benefits calculated under the terms of the alpha scheme for the period from 1 April 2015 to 31 March 2022.

Please refer to: <https://www.civilservicepensionscheme.org.uk/employerhub/employer-pension-notices/>

Employee contributions are salary-related and range between 4.6% and 8.05% for members of classic, premium, classic plus, nuvos and alpha. Benefits in classic accrue at the rate of one-eightieth of final pensionable earnings for each year of service. In addition, a lump sum equivalent to three years' initial pension is payable on retirement. For premium, benefits accrue at the rate of one-sixtieth of final pensionable earnings for each year of service. Unlike classic, there is no automatic lump sum. Classic plus is essentially a hybrid with benefits for service before 1 October 2002 calculated broadly as per classic and benefits for service from October 2002 worked out as in premium. In nuvos a member builds up a pension based on their pensionable earnings during their period of scheme membership. At the end of the scheme year (31 March) the member's earned pension account is credited with 2.3% of their pensionable earnings in that scheme year and the accrued pension is uprated in line with pensions increase legislation. Benefits in alpha build up in a similar way to nuvos, except that the accrual rate is 2.32%. In all cases members may opt to give up (commute) pension for a lump sum up to the limits set by the Finance Act 2004.

The partnership pension account is a stakeholder pension arrangement. The employer makes a basic contribution of between 8% and 14.75% (depending on the age of the member) into a stakeholder pension product chosen by the employee from a panel of providers. The employee does not have to contribute, but where they do make contributions, the employer will match these up to a limit of 3% of pensionable salary (in addition to the employer's basic contribution). Employers also contribute a further 0.5% of pensionable salary to cover the cost of centrally provided risk benefit cover (death in service and ill health retirement).

The accrued pension quoted is the pension the member is entitled to receive when they reach pension age, or immediately on ceasing to be an active member of the scheme if they are already at or over pension age. Pension age is 60 for members of classic, premium and classic plus, 65 for members of nuvos, and the higher of 65 or state pension age for members of alpha. (The pension figures quoted for officials show pension earned in PCSPS or alpha – as appropriate. Where the official has benefits in both the PCSPS and alpha the figure quoted is the combined value of their benefits in the two schemes but note that part of that pension may be payable from different ages.)

Further details about the Civil Service pension arrangements can be found at the website: www.civilservicepensionscheme.org.uk

Cash Equivalent Transfer Values

A cash equivalent transfer value (CETV) is the actuarially assessed capitalised value of the pension scheme benefits accrued by a member at a particular point in time. The benefits valued are the member's accrued benefits and any contingent spouse's pension payable from the scheme. A CETV is a payment made by a pension scheme or arrangement to secure pension benefits in another pension scheme or arrangement when the member leaves a scheme and chooses to transfer the benefits accrued in their former scheme. The pension figures shown relate to the benefits that the individual has accrued as a consequence of their total membership of the pension scheme, not just their service in a senior capacity to which disclosure applies.

The figures include the value of any pension benefit in another scheme or arrangement which the member has transferred to the Civil Service pension arrangements. They also include any additional pension benefit accrued to the member as a result of their buying additional pension benefits at their own cost. CETVs are worked out in accordance with the Occupational Pension Schemes (Transfer Values) (Amendment) Regulations 2008 and do not take account of any actual or potential reduction to benefits resulting from Lifetime Allowance Tax which may be due when pension benefits are taken.

CETV figures are calculated using the guidance on discount rates for calculating unfunded public service pension contribution rates that was extant at 31 March 2023. HM Treasury published updated guidance on 27 April 2023 – this guidance will be used in the calculation of 2025/26 CETV figures.

Real increase in CETV

This reflects the increase in CETV that is funded by the employer. It does not include the increase in accrued pension due to inflation, contributions paid by the employee (including the value of any benefits transferred from another pension scheme or arrangement) and uses common market valuation factors for the start and end of the period.

Fair pay disclosure (audited information)

Reporting bodies are required to disclose the relationship between the remuneration of the highest paid director in their organisation and the lower quartile, median and upper quartile remuneration of the organisation's workforce.

Percentage change from previous year in total salary and bonuses for the highest paid director and the staff average (audited information)

	2025/26		2024/25	
	Total salary	Bonus payments	Total salary	Bonus payments
Staff average	3%	296%	5%	100%
Highest paid director	4%	0%	4%	-67%

The staff average bonus increased by 296% in 2025/26, reflecting a temporary increase of one Senior Civil Service (SCS) post, rather than an increase in individual bonus awards.

Ratio between the highest paid directors' total remuneration and the pay and benefits of employees in the lower quartile, median and upper quartile (audited information)

	Lower quartile	Median	Upper quartile
2025/26	3.4:1	2.9:1	2.3:1
2024/25	3.5:1	2.9:1	2.4:1

Lower quartile, median and upper quartile for staff pay for salaries and total pay and benefits (audited information) (£)

	Lower quartile		Median		Upper quartile	
	2025/26	2024/25	2025/26	2024/25	2025/26	2024/25
Salary component of total pay and benefits	38,535	39,405	47,610	46,000	58,931	57,076
Total Pay and Benefits	40,785	39,405	47,610	47,287	59,106	57,236

Reporting bodies are required to disclose the relationship between the annualised remuneration of the highest-paid director in their organisation and the lower quartile, median and upper quartile remuneration of the organisation's workforce.

Pay multiples (audited information)

The annualised banded remuneration of the highest-paid director in 2025/26, excluding pension, was £135,000-£140,000 (2024/25: £135,000-£140,000). This was 2.9 times (2024/25: 2.9 times) the median remuneration of the workforce, which was £47,610 (2024/25: £47,287).

There has been a reduction in the ratio between the highest-paid director's total remuneration and that of employees in the lower quartile, decreasing from 3.5 times in 2024/25 to 3.4 times in 2025/26. This is primarily driven by the average pay award of 3.25% applied to staff in 2025/26. There has also been a decrease in the upper quartile ratio, reflecting increases in salaries for employees in the highest quartile following the pay award.

No employees received remuneration in excess of the highest-paid director. Remuneration ranged from £25,000-£30,000 to £135,000-£140,000 (2024/25: £25,000-£30,000 to £135,000-£140,000).

Fee paid staff are excluded from fair pay calculations.

Compensation for loss of office (audited information)

During 2025/26, nil was paid (2024/25, £104,000, in relation to two ill health dismissals).

Reporting of Civil Service and other compensation schemes - exit packages are subject to audit

There were no early departure costs in 2025/26 (2024/25: nil).



Staff numbers and staff composition

Staff numbers (audited information)

The table below shows the average number of full-time equivalent staff employed by the YJB during 1 April 2025 to 31 March 2026.

	2025/26	2024/25
Permanent staff	94.00	93.00
Temporary and seconded staff	2.00	1.00
Average full-time equivalent staff	93.11	92.72

At the start of the financial year (1 April 2025) the total number of staff was 94 with a full-time equivalent of 91.77. By 31 March 2026 this had increased slightly to 96 staff, full-time equivalent 92.64. Between 1 April 2025 and 31 March 2026, the YJB had no agency staff.

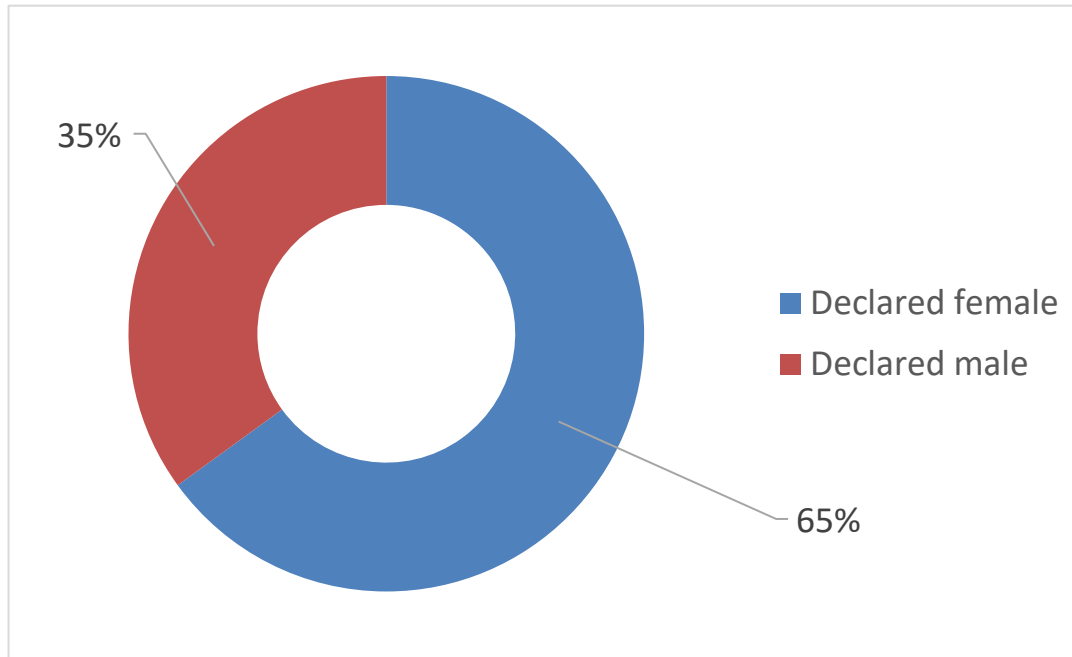
Staff statistics

To protect our staff personal and sensitive data reporting is by percentage rather than numbers and where categories with suppression of data below 5%. Percentages are rounded to the nearest whole figure. Reporting is based on the whole cohort of staff, irrespective of whether they have declared a protected characteristic.

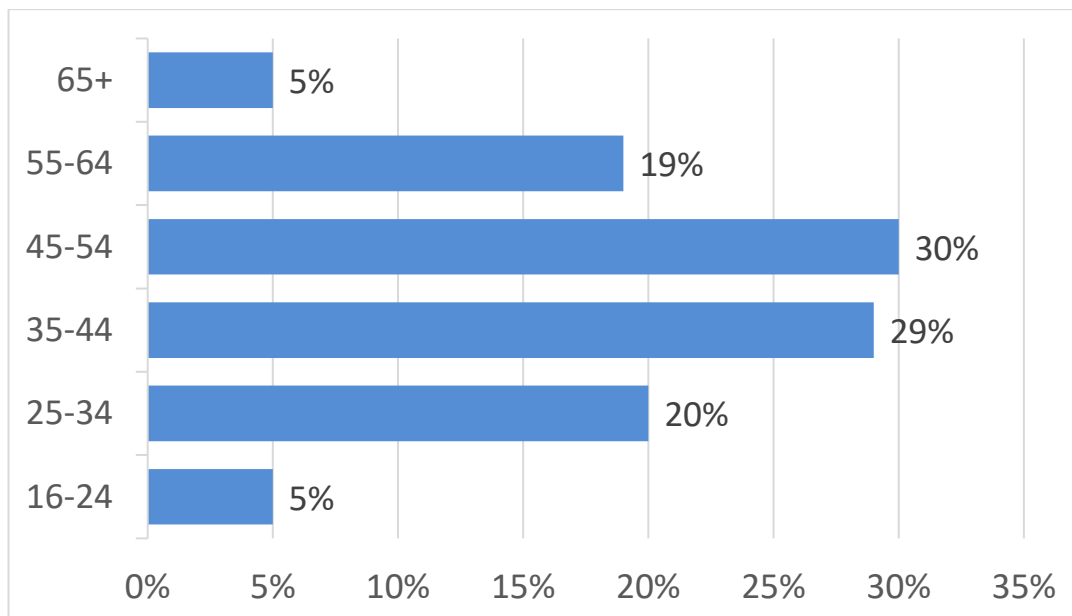


Our staff composition on 31 March 2026 (all staff)

Gender



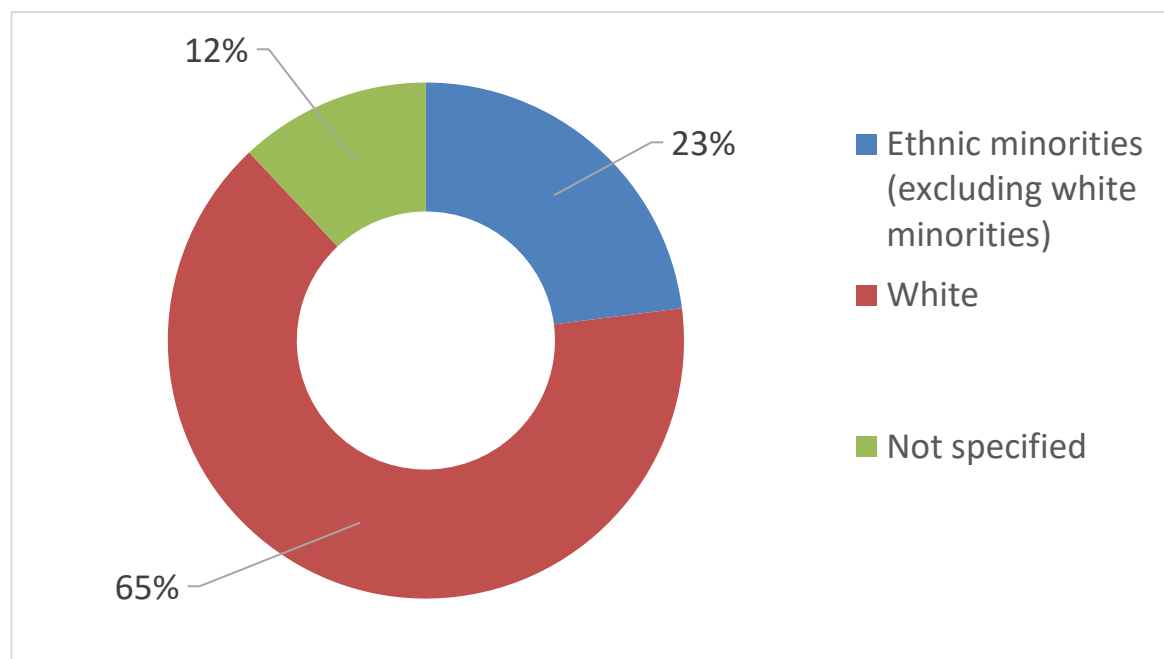
Age analysis*



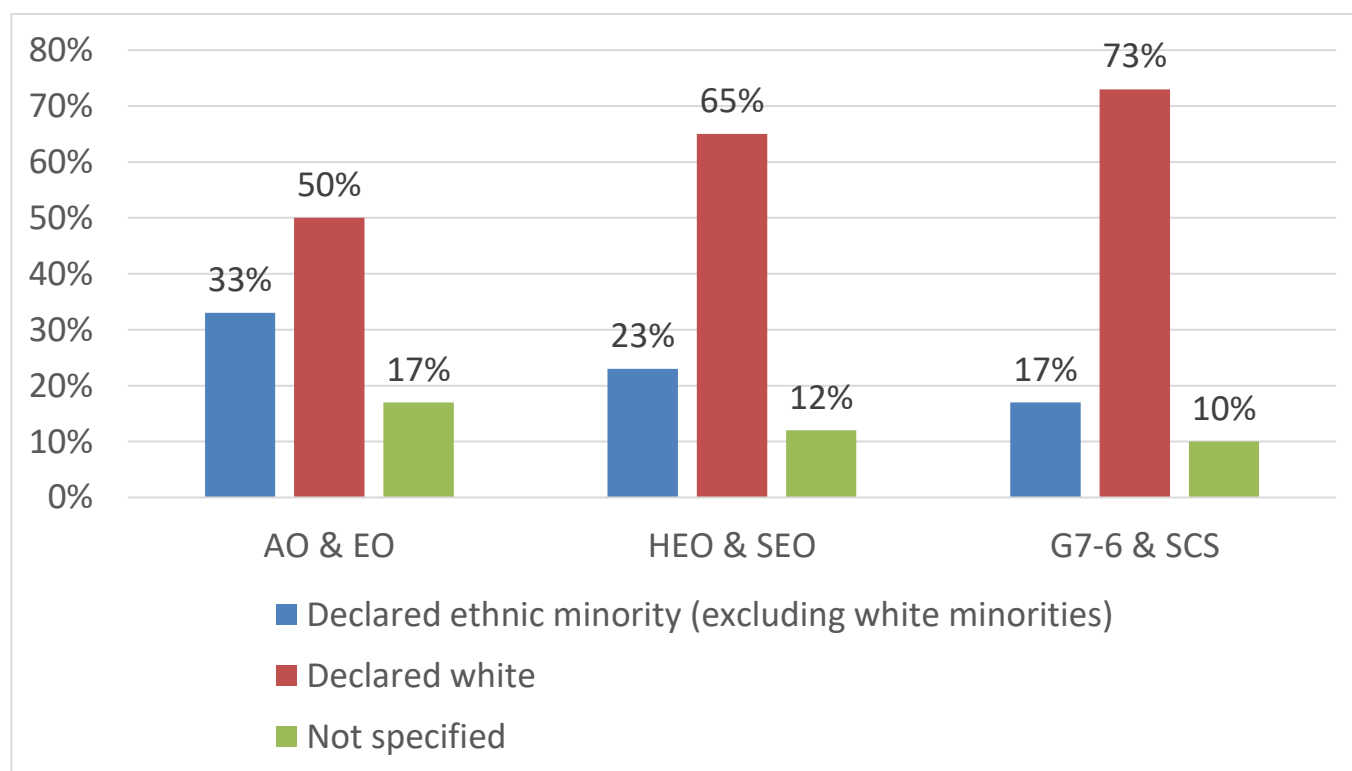
*Percentages may not total 100% because figures have been rounded to protect confidentiality and prevent individual staff from being separately identifiable.



Ethnicity

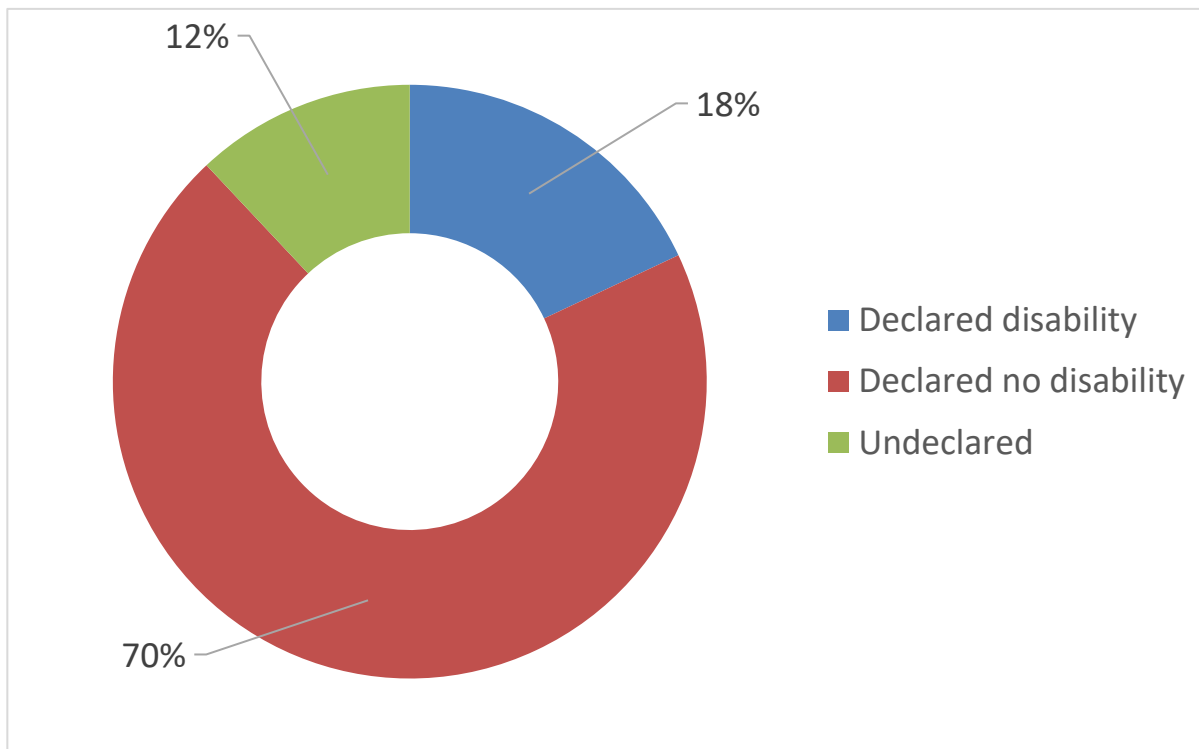


Ethnicity by grade

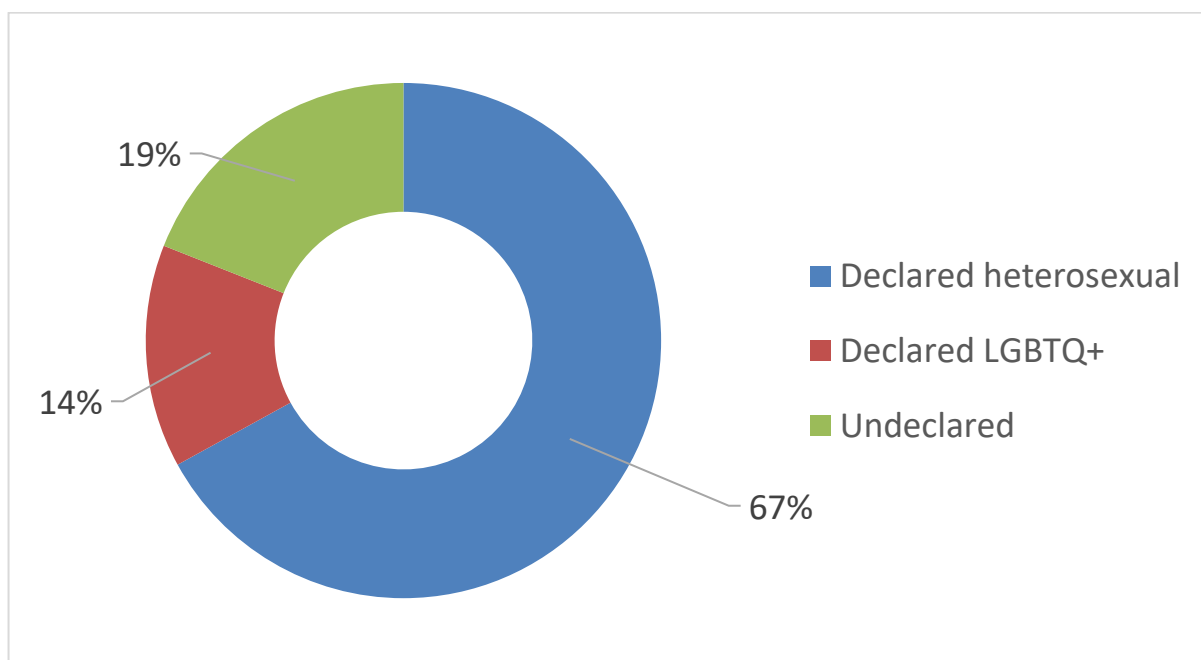




Disability



Sexual orientation



The Board's composition

A well-functioning Board needs a balanced mix of skills, experience and perspectives. This includes both executive directors, who manage the organisation, and independent non-executive directors, who provide oversight and challenge. This balance helps ensure effective decision-making and strong governance

The composition of the YJB has changed over time to reflect developments in the youth justice system. The Board was established under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998. Since then, there has been a sustained reduction in the number of children entering the system.

The YJB has increasingly adopted a Child First, evidence-based approach. This is reflected in the range of skills and experience within the Board. Members bring expertise from areas such as social work, education, health and law enforcement. This mix of perspectives supports informed decision-making and helps the Board address the complex needs of children in the system.

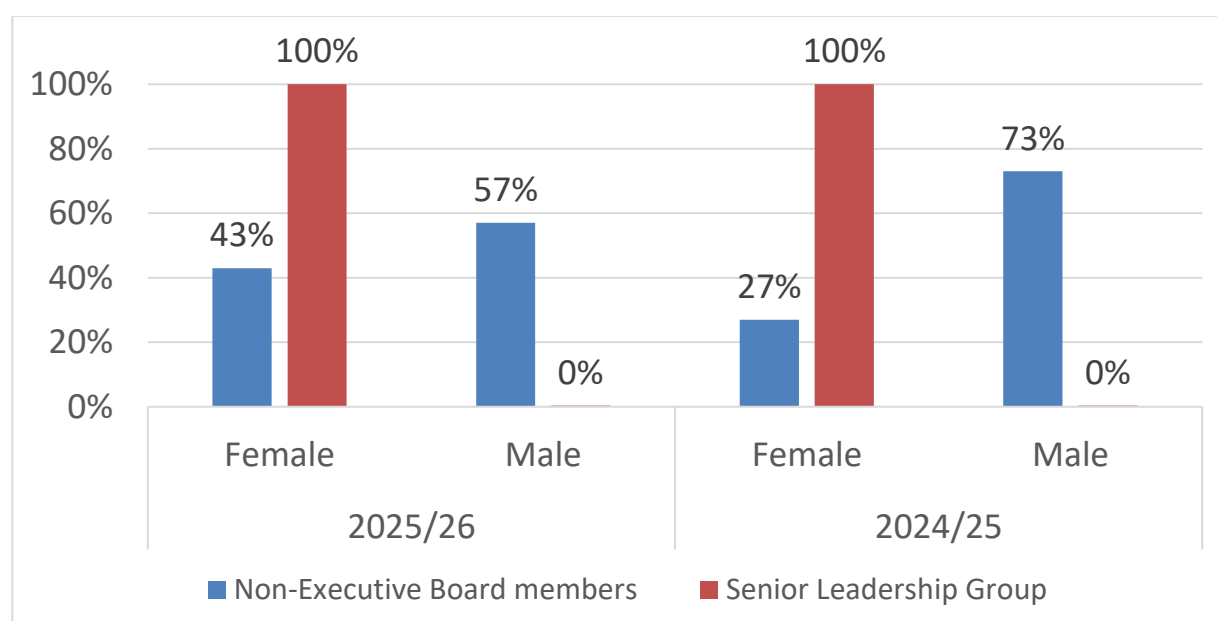
The Board's responsibilities continue to evolve in response to changes across the youth justice system. Responsibility for commissioning youth custody services sits with the Ministry of Justice (MoJ), while a number of operational custody functions are delivered by the Youth Custody Service within His Majesty's Prison and Probation Service. The Board's composition is kept under regular review to ensure it maintains the skills, experience and expertise required to fulfil its current statutory responsibilities and provide effective oversight of the youth justice system.

The YJB's Strategic Plan 2024 to 2027 sets out its priorities and confirms its focus on ensuring that MoJ funding is used effectively by local services. The Board will continue to review its composition to support delivery of these priorities.

During 2025/26, the Board comprised 9 members. The terms of two members ended during the year, in December 2025 and February 2026.

Non-Executive directors are appointed for their relevant skills and experience. Information on protected characteristics is limited. Data is currently available only on the gender of non-executive Board members.

The chart below shows Non-Executive Board member and Senior Leadership Group staff composition between female and male on 31 March 2026 and 31 March 2025.





Trade union facility time publication requirements

Provision for trade union facility time is agreed at 12 days for the year. We had two trade union representatives for the period 1 April 2025 to 31 March 2026. The two representatives utilised 12 days combined which equated to 86.4 hours with an estimated cost of £3,234.

Number of employees who were relevant union officials during 2025/26: 2

Full-time equivalent employee number: 2

Percentage of pay bill spent on facility time

Total cost of facility time: £3,234

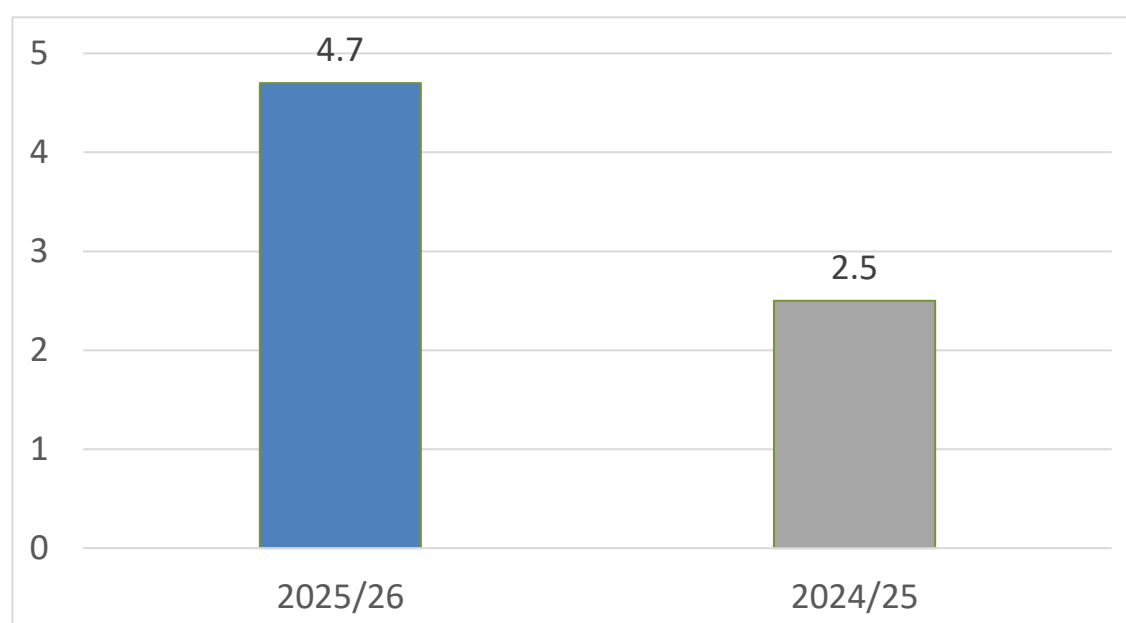
Total pay bill of trades union representatives: £140,678

Percentage of the total pay bill spent on facility time: 2.3%

Paid trade union activities

Time spent on paid trade union activities as a percentage of total paid facility time hours calculated as: 100%

Sickness absence (days)



Average sickness/absence

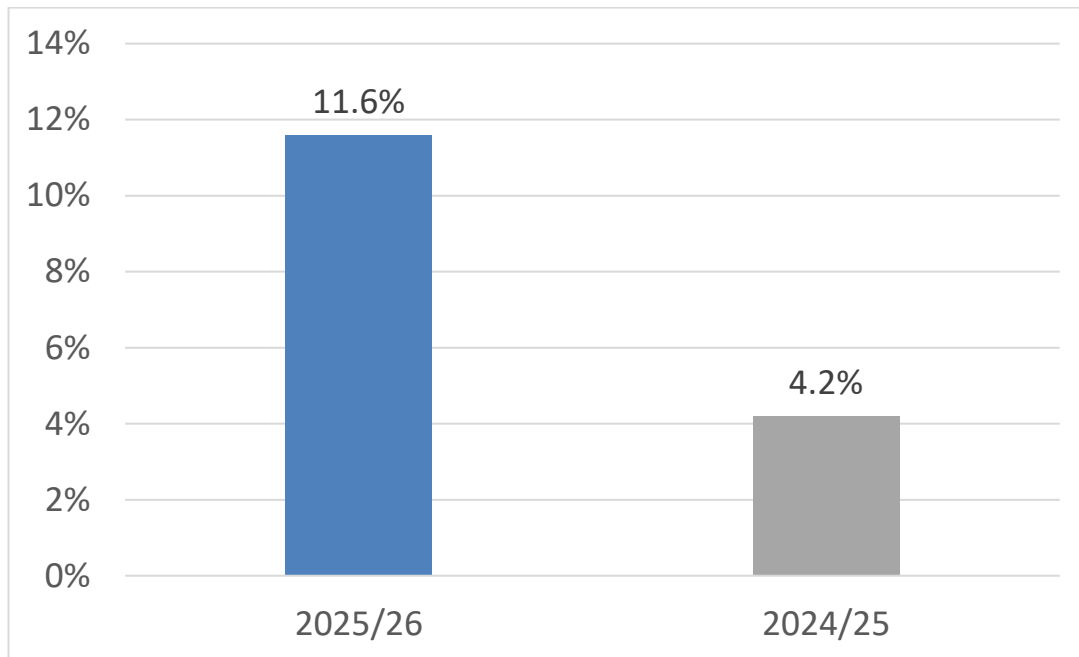
The average number of working days lost due to sickness **was 4.7 days per person in the year to 31 March 2026**. This is an increase of 2.2 days compared with 2024/25. The increase is due to long-term sickness absences, with more staff experiencing sustained periods of absence, particularly in stress, musculoskeletal and neurological-related categories.

By comparison, our sponsor department, the MoJ, recorded an average of **11 working days** lost per employee due to sickness absence in the year to 31 March 2026.

Comparative Civil Service figures are not currently available.



Staff turnover



In 2025/26, staff turnover **was 11.6%, down from 14.2% in 2024/25**. This figure includes staff transfers within the Civil Service and those who left the YJB on promotion. Promotion, pay and development opportunities remain the main reasons for staff leaving the organisation.

We use annual People Survey results and internal exit interview findings to better understand staff experience at the YJB. This feedback informs targeted action to improve the overall employee experience.



Equity, Diversity and Inclusion Working Group

The Equity, Diversity and Inclusion (ED&I) group has maintained its role in advancing equity, diversity and inclusion across the organisation. The group has progressed delivery of its ED&I action plan during 2025/26, aligned to its equality objectives for 2023 to 2027.

This work aimed to advance equality of opportunity, foster inclusive working practices, and support the organisation's ambition to become an anti-racist and equitable employer.

What we did

During 2025/26, the EDI Working Group:

- progressed delivery of the EDI Action Plan in line with the YJB's Equality Objectives 2023 to 2027.
- supported staff engagement and inclusion through staff networks, listening activities and opportunities for colleagues to share experiences and provide feedback.
- advanced the anti-racism programme by successfully completing Phase 1 of the Cultural Cohesion Quality Mark (CCQM) accreditation in January 2026. Further accreditation activity was paused pending decisions on YJB reforms.
- raised awareness of equality and inclusion by recognising key events and campaigns, including Black History Month and Pride.
- improved data and reporting, including publication of the Public Sector Equality Duty (PSED) report and enhancements to EDI workforce data.
- embedded inclusive practice across recruitment, policy development, staff support and organisational processes.

Impact

This work delivered a number of positive outcomes during the year:

- progress against equality objectives was achieved, with EDI priorities embedded within corporate planning and delivery arrangements.
- staff engagement and representation were strengthened through staff networks and structured engagement opportunities, ensuring a wider range of perspectives informed decision-making.
- organisational capability and external assurance were enhanced through achievement of CCQM Phase 1 and preparatory work towards White Ribbon accreditation.
- awareness and understanding of EDI issues increased through a programme of events, communications and learning activities.
- governance, transparency and accountability were strengthened through compliance with Public Sector Equality Duty reporting requirements and improved workforce diversity monitoring.
- inclusive practice became more consistently embedded within policies, processes and decision-making, supporting compliance with the Public Sector Equality Duty and promoting a more inclusive working environment.

Looking ahead

In 2026/27, the EDI Working Group will:

- continue delivery of the EDI Action Plan and monitor progress against the Equality Objectives 2023 to 2027.

- further embed equality, diversity and inclusion considerations within organisational governance, policies and business processes.
- review and restart CCQM and White Ribbon accreditation activity once the implications of YJB reforms are confirmed.
- continue to strengthen workforce data, staff engagement and evidence-based approaches to improving inclusion across the organisation.

Employment of people with disabilities

We are a **Level 2 accredited** [Disability Confident Employer](#). We display the Disability Confident badge on all recruitment adverts to show that disabled applicants are welcome and will receive appropriate support throughout the recruitment process and in employment.

All recruitment panel members must complete training on diversity, inclusion and relevant legislation before taking part in recruitment activity. Candidates who declare a disability and meet the essential criteria for a role are guaranteed an interview. Reasonable adjustments are provided throughout recruitment and employment where needed.

We use occupational health advice and individual risk assessments to identify and provide reasonable adjustments and specialist equipment for new and existing employees in a timely way.

Our health and safety lead supports the assessment and procurement process.

As at 31 March 2026, 18% of staff had declared a disability, compared with 18% across the Civil Service and the economically active working-age population aged 16 to 64 (Civil Service Statistics 2025).

We respect the right of individuals not to disclose personal information. However, the Senior Leadership Group, Equity, Diversity and Inclusion Group and Staff Engagement Group continue to encourage staff to share diversity data to help us assess whether our policies and practices are fair and inclusive.

We also provide wellbeing support through mental health allies and our employee assistance programme, PAM Assist.

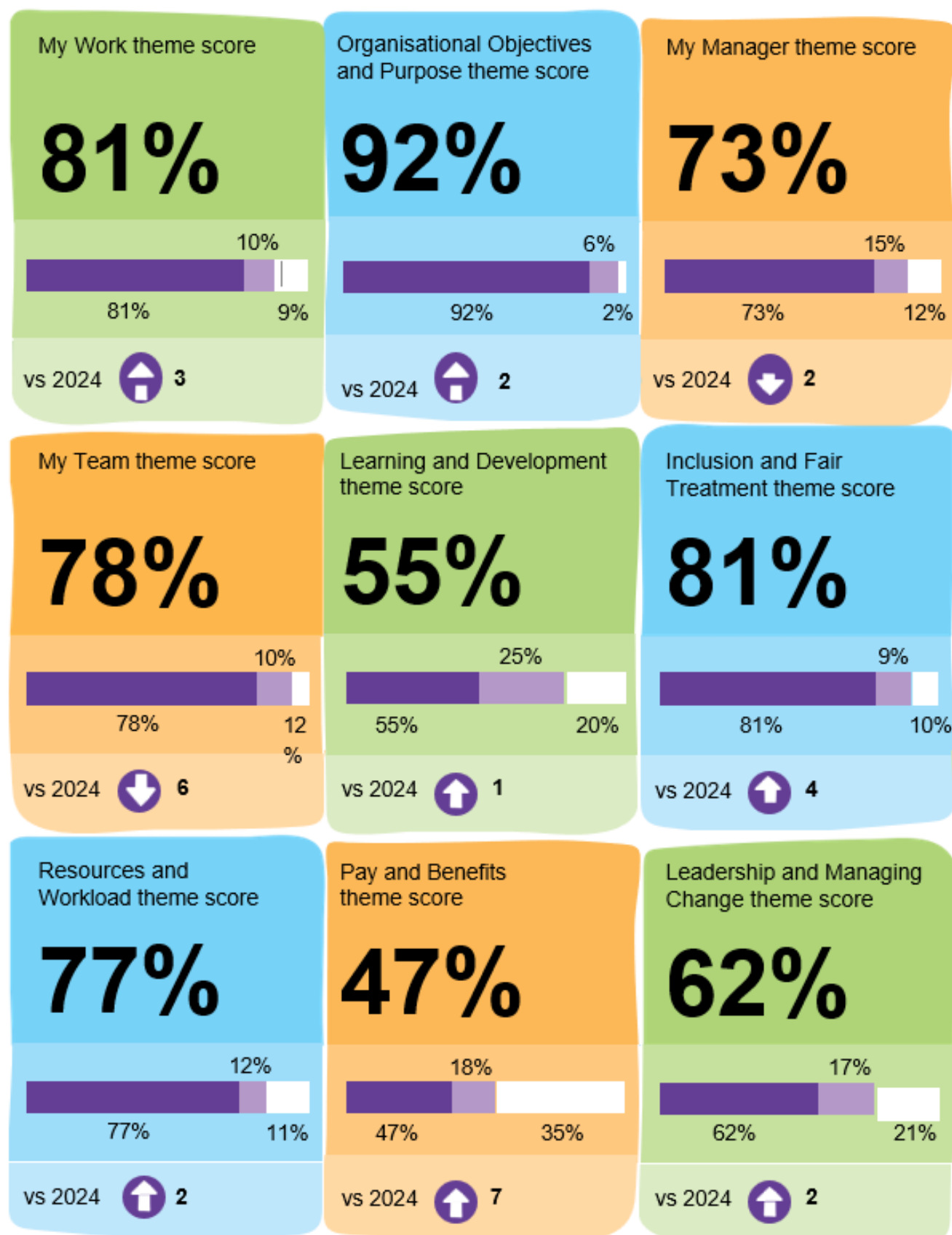
Employee relations

We aim to be an effective, inclusive and supportive organisation where all employees can contribute fully and achieve their potential.

We measure staff engagement annually through the Civil Service People Survey. In 2025, we achieved a 90% response rate and an employee engagement score of 69%. This was six percentage points higher than the previous year and above the Civil Service benchmark of 65%.

We continue to use staff feedback to improve the working environment, support wellbeing and strengthen organisational culture.

People Survey 2025 Core Themes and Scores



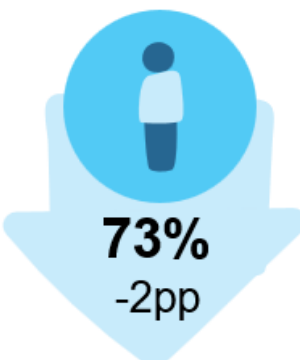
People Survey 2025: Strong Engagement and Positive Employee Experience

Response rate 90%**89 out of 99 staff****55%**
+1ppLearning and
Development**92%**
+2ppOrganisational
Objectives and
purpose**78%**
-6pp

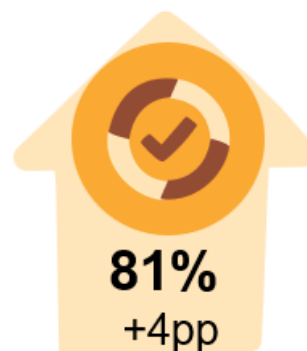
My Team

62%
+2ppLeadership
and Managing
Change**47%**
+7ppPay and
benefits**81%**
+3pp

My Work

73%
-2pp

My Manager

81%
+4ppInclusion and
Fair Treatment



Staff engagement

The Staff Engagement Group (SEG), made up of representatives from across all grades, provides an important channel for staff feedback and engagement.

During 2025/26, SEG supported communication, engagement and wellbeing across the organisation during a period of significant change and uncertainty.

SEG played an important role in the 2025 Civil Service People Survey by encouraging participation, sharing results and supporting follow-up actions. The survey achieved a 90% response rate and an employee engagement score of 69%, an increase of six percentage points from the previous year and above the Civil Service benchmark. Confidence in senior leaders taking action in response to survey results increased to 70%.

Using the survey results, SEG reviewed progress against the previous action plan and focused activity on leadership and change, bullying and harassment, learning and development, health and wellbeing, and pay and benefits.

The group supported communication through weekly staff messages, all-staff meetings, intranet updates and team discussions. It also promoted learning opportunities, wellbeing resources, staff benefits, recognition schemes and available support services, while maintaining visibility of actions taken in response to staff feedback.

SEG also coordinated a range of wellbeing and staff connection activities during the year, including Movement in May, Step and Snap, Coffee Roulette and wellbeing workshops. The group contributed to wider engagement initiatives, including the 2025 all-staff event, helping colleagues build relationships, share experiences and reflect on organisational change.

Throughout the year, SEG continued to provide a valuable forum for staff feedback and engagement, supporting communication, wellbeing, inclusion and employee engagement across the organisation.

Staff costs (audited information)

For the year ended 31 March 2026 £000:

	Board members	Employed staff ⁵	2025/26	2024/25
	£000	£000	£000	£000
Wages and salaries	121	4,699	4,820	4,628
Social security costs	12	651	663	529
Other pension costs	-	1,340	1,340	1,252
Total gross cost	133	6,690	6,823	6,409
Less recoveries in respect of outward secondments	-	-	-	(10)
Total net cost	133	6,690	6,823	6,399

The Principal Civil Service Pension Scheme (PCSPS) and the Civil Servant and Other Pension Scheme, known as alpha, are unfunded multi-employer defined benefit schemes in which the YJB is unable to identify its share of the underlying assets and liabilities. A full actuarial valuation was carried out as at 31 March 2020.

For 2025/26, employer's contributions of £1,331,000 was payable to the PCSPS (2024/25: £1,241,300) at a flat rate of 28.97% (2024/25: 28.97%) of pensionable pay, based on salary bands. The scheme's actuary reviews employer contributions approximately every four years following a full scheme valuation.

Employees can opt to open a partnership pension account (a stakeholder pension with an employer contribution). In 2025/26 employer contributions of £7,810 were paid to an appointed stakeholder pension provider Legal and General (2024/25: £10,300).

Employer contributions, which are age-related, ranged from 8% to 14.75% (2024/25: 8% to 14.75%) of pensionable pay. Employers also match employee contributions up to 3% of pensionable pay.

Employers also contribute a further 0.5% of pensionable salary to cover the cost of centrally provided risk benefit cover (death in service and ill health retirement).

No employees in 2025/26 retired early on ill-health grounds (2024/25: nil); the total additional accrued pension liabilities in 2025/26 amounted to nil (2024/25: nil).

Expenditure on consultancy

We did not incur any consultancy expenditure in 2025/26 (£11,940 in 2024/25 related to an external Board effectiveness review undertaken by Deloitte).

Off-payroll engagements

During 2025/26 we reviewed off-payroll engagements where we are required to consider intermediaries (IR35) legislation using HMRC's guidance and online status indicator. We advised our contracting body of the outcome of the status determinations so that, where appropriate, tax deductions are made at the source from payments made in respect of the engagement with us.

⁵ Note that for the purposes of this table, Executive Directors are included as employed staff. No staff costs were capitalised during 2025/26 (2024/25: nil).

There were no highly paid off-payroll workers, earning £245 per day or more, engaged either at 31 March 2026 or at any point during the year ended 31 March 2026.

For any off-payroll engagements of board members, and/or senior officials with significant financial responsibility, between 1 April 2025 and 31 March 2026

Number of off-payroll engagements of board members, and/or senior officials with significant financial responsibility, during the financial year.	Nil
Total number of individuals on payroll and off payroll that have been deemed 'board members and/or senior officials with significant financial responsibility', during the financial year.	18



Stock photograph, posed by model



Parliamentary accountability and audit report

Government Functional Standards (2025/26)

The [Government Functional Standards](#) (GFS) provide a common framework for managing corporate and professional functions across government. The Youth Justice Board (YJB) applies these standards proportionately, reflecting its size, remit and delivery model, including functions delivered jointly with, or through, the Ministry of Justice (MoJ).

For 2025/26, the YJB completed a structured self-assessment using evidence provided by functional leads. The updated returns show a strong overall compliance position across the standards assessed. Evidence includes established governance arrangements, documented frameworks, internal controls, risk and assurance processes, MoJ shared service arrangements, Government Internal Audit Agency (GIAA) work, National Audit Office (NAO) audit activity, and senior oversight through the Board, Senior Leadership Group and Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee.

Most standards were assessed as fully compliant. This includes Government Functions, Human Resources, Property, Digital, Security, Commercial, Internal Audit, Analysis, Counter Fraud, Debt and Grants. The updated evidence shows that previous gaps in Internal Audit have been addressed through a new YJB Internal Audit Framework, approved by Finance, Audit, Risks and Assurance Committee in May 2026, and that counter fraud arrangements have been strengthened through completion of the Cabinet Office self-assessment action plan and updates to the Counter Fraud, Bribery and Corruption Policy and Response Plan.

Finance has been assessed as partially compliant overall because one return identified the need to strengthen assurance activity, including dip sampling. Other Finance returns confirmed strong compliance with Managing Public Money, the Financial Reporting Manual, financial control, budgeting, forecasting, reconciliations, reporting, parliamentary accountability and audit requirements. The overall judgement therefore recognises a sound control framework with targeted improvement activity planned.

The updated assessment also highlights continuous improvement across several fully compliant areas, including workforce planning and people data, digital contract wording, commercial standardisation, analytical quality assurance, grant documentation and management information. These are maturity improvements rather than indications of fundamental control weaknesses.

Overall, the assessment provides reasonable assurance that the YJB's governance, risk management and control arrangements are aligned with the GFS, with identified improvement actions being managed through business-as-usual governance and assurance routes.

Summary of Compliance

The YJB assessed 14 applicable GFS during 2025/26. 13 standards (93%) were assessed as fully compliant, and one standard (Finance) was assessed as partially compliant. Improvement activity was focused on strengthening organisational maturity, assurance and continuous improvement rather than addressing fundamental control weaknesses.

Standard	Status	Key Assurance Evidence	Continuous Improvement
GovS 001 – Government Functions	● Full	Governance, accountability, risk management, assurance and oversight through Board, Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee, Senior Leadership Group, Portfolio Assurance Board and Project Steering Committee	Periodic review through established governance
GovS 002 – Project Delivery	● Full	Project Management Framework, Portfolio Steering Committee and Benefits Management Framework	Implement Project Continuous Self-Assessment in 2026/27
GovS 003 – Human Resources	● Full	HR policies, workforce planning, recruitment, learning and development aligned to Civil Service and MoJ frameworks	Enhance workforce planning, people MI and capability planning
GovS 004 – Property	● Full	Government Property Agency managed accommodation with compliance reporting provided through MoJ arrangements	No significant actions identified
GovS 005 – Digital	● Full	Digital governance, strategy, cyber assurance, supplier management and performance monitoring in place	Reference Functional Standards explicitly in future contracts
GovS 006 – Finance	● Partial	Strong financial governance, budgeting, forecasting, statutory reporting, audit and assurance arrangements	Strengthen assurance activity, dip sampling and forward-looking analysis
GovS 007 – Security	● Full	GovAssure assessment completed; physical and personnel security provided through MoJ	No significant actions identified
GovS 008 – Commercial	● Full	Governance, procurement, supplier management, capability and Commercial Continuous Improvement Assessment Framework arrangements embedded through MoJ	Increase standardisation and cross-government knowledge sharing
GovS 009 – Internal Audit	● Full	Government Internal Audit Agency service supported by the YJB Internal Audit Framework approved by FARAC	Framework review scheduled for May 2027
GovS 010 – Analysis	● Full	Accredited statistics, analytical governance, peer review, quality assurance and GSR professional standards	Strengthening QA documentation and user engagement
GovS 011 – Communication	● Full	Communication Strategy aligned to government priorities, formal governance and sign-off processes, OASIS planning model, campaign evaluation, audience insight, strategic planning tools, risk-assured events, stakeholder engagement, GCS professional development, crisis communications and evaluation frameworks	No significant actions identified
GovS 013 – Counter Fraud	● Full	Counter fraud self-assessment completed; action plan delivered; policies approved by FARAC	Ongoing review through annual reassessment
GovS 014 – Debt	● Full	Financial controls, forecasting, reporting and audit trails support compliance	Enhance risk articulation and early engagement
GovS 015 – Grants	● Full	Comprehensive grant lifecycle controls, approvals, assurance arrangements and oversight mechanisms	Improve management information and documentation consistency

Losses, special payments and remote contingent liabilities

In addition to the primary financial statements prepared under International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS), the Government Financial Reporting Manual (FReM) requires the YJB to report on losses, special payments and remote contingent liabilities. These notes and disclosures are subject to audit.

Regularity of expenditure

This section has been subject to audit.

The YJB's expenditure was applied for the purposes intended by Parliament.

Losses and special payments

The total value of losses incurred in the year and in the previous year was less than £300,000.

There were no special payments made in the year to 31 March 2026 (2024/25: nil).

Remote contingent liabilities

In addition to contingent liabilities reported within the meaning of IAS 37, the YJB is also required to disclose details of any liabilities for which the likelihood of a transfer of economic benefit in settlement is too remote to meet the definition of contingent liability.

As at 31 March 2026, the YJB had no remote contingent liabilities.

Signed by



Stephanie Roberts-Bibby

Chief Executive and Accounting Officer

3 September 2026



The Certificate and Report of the Comptroller and Auditor General to the Houses of Parliament

Opinion on financial statements

I certify that I have audited the financial statements of the Youth Justice Board for the year ended 31 March 2026 under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998.

The financial statements comprise the Youth Justice Board's:

- Statement of Financial Position as at 31 March 2026;
- Statement of Comprehensive Net Expenditure, Statement of Cash Flows and Statement of Changes in Taxpayers' Equity for the year then ended; and
- the related notes including the significant accounting policies.

The financial reporting framework that has been applied in the preparation of the financial statements is applicable law and UK adopted international accounting standards.

In my opinion, the financial statements:

- give a true and fair view of the state of the Youth Justice Board's affairs as at 31 March 2026 and its net operating cost for the year then ended; and
- have been properly prepared in accordance with the Crime and Disorder Act 1998 and Secretary of State directions issued thereunder.

Opinion on regularity

In my opinion, in all material respects, the income and expenditure recorded in the financial statements have been applied to the purposes intended by Parliament and the financial transactions recorded in the financial statements conform to the authorities which govern them.

Basis for opinions

I conducted my audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK) (ISAs UK), applicable law and Practice Note 10 *Audit of Financial Statements and Regularity of Public Sector Bodies in the United Kingdom (2024)*. My responsibilities under those standards are further described in the *Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements* section of my certificate.

Those standards require me and my staff to comply with the Financial Reporting Council's *Revised Ethical Standard 2024*. I am independent of the Youth Justice Board in accordance the ethical requirements that are relevant to my audit of the financial statements in the UK. My staff and I have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements.

I believe that the audit evidence I have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for my opinion.

Conclusions relating to going concern

In auditing the financial statements, I have concluded that the Youth Justice Board's use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate.

Based on the work I have performed, I have not identified any material uncertainties relating to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the Youth Justice Board's ability to continue as a going concern for a period of at least twelve months from when the financial statements are authorised for issue.

My responsibilities and the responsibilities of the Accounting Officer with respect to going concern are described in the relevant sections of this certificate.

The going concern basis of accounting for the Youth Justice Board is adopted in consideration of the requirements set out in HM Treasury's Government Financial Reporting Manual, which requires entities to adopt the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements where it is anticipated that the services which they provide will continue into the future.

Other information

The other information comprises information included in the Annual Report, but does not include the financial statements and my auditor's certificate thereon. The Accounting Officer is responsible for the other information.

My opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information and, except to the extent otherwise explicitly stated in my certificate, I do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon.

My responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or my knowledge obtained in the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated.

If I identify such material inconsistencies or apparent material misstatements, I am required to determine whether this gives rise to a material misstatement in the financial statements themselves. If, based on the work I have performed, I conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, I am required to report that fact.

I have nothing to report in this regard.

Opinion on other matters

In my opinion the part of the Remuneration and Staff Report to be audited has been properly prepared in accordance with Secretary of State directions issued under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998.

In my opinion, based on the work undertaken in the course of the audit:



- the parts of the Accountability Report subject to audit have been properly prepared in accordance with Secretary of State directions issued under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998; and
- the information given in the Performance and Accountability Reports for the financial year for which the financial statements are prepared is consistent with the financial statements and is in accordance with the applicable legal requirements.

Matters on which I report by exception

In the light of the knowledge and understanding of the Youth Justice Board and its environment obtained in the course of the audit, I have not identified material misstatements in the Performance and Accountability Reports.

I have nothing to report in respect of the following matters which I report to you if, in my opinion:

- adequate accounting records have not been kept by the Youth Justice Board or returns adequate for my audit have not been received from branches not visited by my staff; or
- I have not received all of the information and explanations I require for my audit; or
- the financial statements and the parts of the Accountability Report subject to audit are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns; or
- certain disclosures of remuneration specified by HM Treasury's Government Financial Reporting Manual have not been made or parts of the Remuneration and Staff Report to be audited is not in agreement with the accounting records and returns; or
- the Governance Statement does not reflect compliance with HM Treasury's guidance.

Responsibilities of the Accounting Officer for the financial statements

As explained more fully in the Statement of Accounting Officer's Responsibilities, the Accounting Officer is responsible for:

- maintaining proper accounting records;
- providing the C&AG with access to all information of which management is aware that is relevant to the preparation of the financial statements such as records, documentation and other matters;
- providing the C&AG with additional information and explanations needed for his audit;
- providing the C&AG with unrestricted access to persons within the Youth Justice Board from whom the auditor determines it necessary to obtain audit evidence;
- ensuring such internal controls are in place as deemed necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements to be free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error;
- preparing financial statements which give a true and fair view and are in accordance with Secretary of State directions issued under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998;
- preparing the annual report, which includes the Remuneration and Staff Report, in accordance with Secretary of State directions issued under the Crime and Disorder Act 1998; and
- assessing the Youth Justice Board's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the Accounting Officer anticipates that the services provided by the Youth Justice Board will not continue to be provided in the future.

Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements

My responsibility is to audit, certify and report on the financial statements in accordance with the Crime and Disorder Act 1998.

My objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue a certificate that includes my opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

Extent to which the audit was considered capable of detecting non-compliance with laws and regulations, including fraud

I design procedures in line with my responsibilities, outlined above, to detect material misstatements in respect of non-compliance with laws and regulations, including fraud. The extent to which my procedures are capable of detecting non-compliance with laws and regulations, including fraud is detailed below.

Identifying and assessing potential risks related to non-compliance with laws and regulations, including fraud

In identifying and assessing risks of material misstatement in respect of non-compliance with laws and regulations, including fraud, I:

- considered the nature of the sector, control environment and operational performance including the design of the Youth Justice Board's accounting policies, key performance indicators and performance incentives.
- inquired of management, the Youth Justice Board's head of internal audit and those charged with governance, including obtaining and reviewing supporting documentation relating to the Youth Justice Board's policies and procedures on:
 - identifying, evaluating and complying with laws and regulations;
 - detecting and responding to the risks of fraud; and
 - the internal controls established to mitigate risks related to fraud or non-compliance with laws and regulations including the Youth Justice Board's controls relating to the Youth Justice Board's compliance with the Crime and Disorder Act 1998 and Managing Public Money.
- inquired of management, the Youth Justice Board's head of internal audit and those charged with governance whether:
 - they were aware of any instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations;
 - they had knowledge of any actual, suspected, or alleged fraud;
- discussed with the engagement team regarding how and where fraud might occur in the financial statements and any potential indicators of fraud.
- As a result of these procedures, I considered the opportunities and incentives that may exist within the Youth Justice Board for fraud and identified the greatest potential for fraud in the following areas: revenue recognition, posting of unusual journals, complex transactions and bias in management estimates. In common with all audits under ISAs (UK), I am required to perform specific procedures to respond to the risk of management override.



As a result of these procedures, I considered the opportunities and incentives that may exist within the Youth Justice Board for fraud and identified the greatest potential for fraud in the following areas: revenue recognition, posting of unusual journals, complex transactions and bias in management estimates. In common with all audits under ISAs (UK), I am required to perform specific procedures to respond to the risk of management override.

I obtained an understanding of the Youth Justice Board's framework of authority and other legal and regulatory frameworks in which the Youth Justice Board operates. I focused on those laws and regulations that had a direct effect on material amounts and disclosures in the financial statements or that had a fundamental effect on the operations of the Youth Justice Board. The key laws and regulations I considered in this context included Crime and Disorder Act 1998, Managing Public Money, employment law and tax legislation.

Audit response to identified risk

To respond to the identified risks resulting from the above procedures:

- I reviewed the financial statement disclosures and testing to supporting documentation to assess compliance with provisions of relevant laws and regulations described above as having direct effect on the financial statements;
- I enquired of management and the Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee concerning actual and potential litigation and claims;
- I reviewed minutes of meetings of those charged with governance and the Board and internal audit reports;
- I addressed the risk of fraud through management override of controls by testing the appropriateness of journal entries and other adjustments; assessing whether the judgements on estimates are indicative of a potential bias; and evaluating the business rationale of any significant transactions that are unusual or outside the normal course of business; and
- I tested the regularity of grant expenditure paid to youth justice services in accordance with the Crime and Disorder Act 1998.

I communicated relevant identified laws and regulations and potential risks of fraud to all engagement team members and remained alert to any indications of fraud or non-compliance with laws and regulations throughout the audit.

A further description of my responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements is located on the Financial Reporting Council's website at: www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities. This description forms part of my certificate.

Other auditor's responsibilities

I am required to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence to give reasonable assurance that the expenditure and income recorded in the financial statements have been applied to the purposes intended by Parliament and the financial transactions recorded in the financial statements conform to the authorities which govern them.

I communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control I identify during my audit.



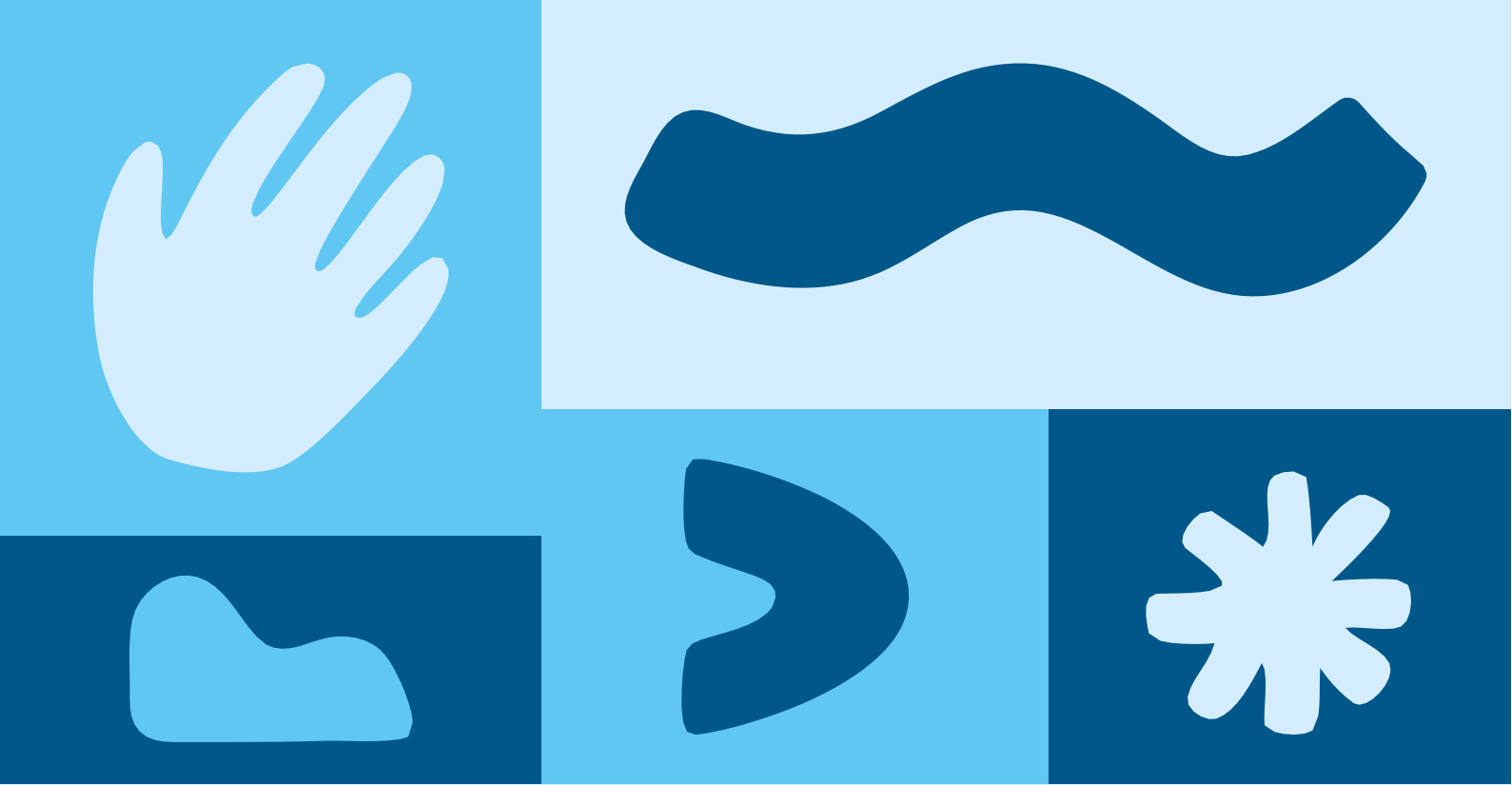
Report

I have no observations to make on these financial statements.

Gareth Davies
Comptroller and Auditor General

National Audit Office
157-197 Buckingham Palace Road
Victoria
London
SW1W 9SP

09 September 2026



Financial Statements 2025/26



Financial Statements 2025/26

Statement of Comprehensive Net Expenditure (SoCNE)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

		2025/26	2024/25
	Notes	£000	£000
Income	4	(105)	(90)
Expenditure			
Staff costs	3	6,823	6,399
Depreciation and amortisation	5,6	882	995
Grants to youth justice services	2	94,466	92,930
Information and communications technology (ICT) programmes	2	3,278	2,640
Other expenditure	2	2,572	1,934
Net operating expenditure		107,916	104,808
Other comprehensive net expenditure			
Net loss on revaluation of intangible assets	6	1	-
Total comprehensive net expenditure for the period		107,917	104,808

The notes on pages 112 to 124 form part of these accounts



Statement of Financial Position (SoFP)

		31 March 2026	31 March 2025
	Notes	£000	£000
Non-current assets			
Right of use assets	5	7	11
Intangible assets	6	1,887	2,282
Total non-current assets		1,894	2,293
Current assets			
Trade and other receivables	7	186	116
Cash and cash equivalents	8	521	775
Total current assets		707	891
Total assets		2,601	3,184
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	9	(1,172)	(1,446)
Lease liabilities	9	(3)	(3)
Total current liabilities		(1,175)	(1,449)
Total assets less current liabilities		1,426	1,735
Non-current liabilities			
Lease liabilities	9	(4)	(8)
Total non-current liabilities		(4)	(8)
Total assets less total liabilities		1,422	1,727
Taxpayers' equity and other reserves			
Revaluation reserve		36	59
General reserve		1,386	1,668
Total taxpayers' equity		1,422	1,727

The notes on pages 112 to 124 form part of these accounts.

Signed by

Stephanie Roberts-Bibby

Chief Executive and Accounting Officer

3 September 2026



Statement of Cash Flows (SoCF)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

		2025/26	2024/25
	Notes	£000	£000
Cash flows from operating activities			
Net expenditure for the year	SoCNE	(107,916)	(104,808)
(Increase)/decrease in trade and other receivables	7	(70)	(46)
Increase/(decrease) in trade and other payables	9	(274)	599
Adjustments for non-cash transactions			
Amortisation and depreciation	5,6	882	995
Services and facilities provided by sponsoring department	2.3	1,367	883
Net cash outflow from operating activities		(106,011)	(102,377)
Cash flows from investing activities			
Purchase of intangible assets	6	(484)	(1,073)
Net cash (outflow) / inflow from investing activities		(484)	(1,073)
Cash flows from financing activities			
Grants from sponsoring departments	10	106,245	104,077
Repayment of principle on lease	5	(4)	(2)
Net cash inflow from financing activities		106,241	104,075
Net increase/(decrease) in cash and cash equivalents in the period		(254)	625
Cash and cash equivalents at the beginning of the period		775	150
Cash and cash equivalents at the end of the period	8	521	775

The notes on pages 112 to 124 form part of these accounts.

Statement of Changes in Taxpayers' Equity (SoCITE)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

	Notes	Revaluation reserve £000	General reserve £000	Taxpayers' equity £000
Balance at 1 April 2024		97	1,478	1,575
Grant-in-aid	10	-	104,077	104,077
Net operating expenditure for the year	SoCNE	-	(104,808)	(104,808)
Non-cash charges				
Services and facilities provided by sponsoring department	2	-	883	883
Transfers between reserves				
Release of reserves to the general reserve		(38)	38	-
Balance as at 31 March 2025		59	1,668	1,727
Changes in taxpayers' equity for 2025/26				
Grant-in-aid	10	-	106,245	106,245
Net operating expenditure for the year	SoCNE	-	(107,916)	(107,916)
Non-cash charges				
Services and facilities provided by sponsoring department	2	-	1,367	1,367
Transfers between reserves				
Release of reserves to the general reserve		(22)	22	-
Net gain on revaluation of intangible assets		(1)	-	(1)
Balance as at 31 March 2026		36	1,386	1,422

The notes on pages 112 to 124 form part of these accounts.



Supporting notes to the Financial Statements

1. Statement of Accounting Policies

1.1 Basis of preparation

These accounts have been prepared in accordance with the Government Financial Reporting Manual 2025/26 (FReM) issued by His Majesty's (HM) Treasury. The accounting policies contained in the FReM apply International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) as adapted or interpreted for the public-sector context. They are in a form as directed by the Secretary of State with the approval of Treasury and in accordance with section 41 of, and Schedule 2 to the Crime and Disorder Act 1998.

Where the FReM permits a choice of accounting policy, the policy which is judged to be the most appropriate to the particular circumstances of the YJB for the purpose of giving a true and fair view has been selected. The accounting policies adopted by the YJB are described below. They have been applied consistently in dealing with items considered material to the accounts.

The functional and presentation currency of the YJB is the British pound sterling (£).

1.2 Going concern

The Youth Justice Board (YJB) is an executive non-departmental public body established by statute and financed principally by the Ministry of Justice (MoJ).

The Government's White Paper *Cutting Youth Crime. Changing Young Lives* announced reforms to the youth justice system, including the transfer of certain functions from the YJB to the MoJ, namely national oversight of the youth justice system, performance monitoring of youth justice services, development of National Standards and administration of the core youth justice grant. The YJB is expected to retain a revised role focused on evidence-led continuous improvement, innovation and the dissemination of effective practice. These planned changes have been considered in the assessment of going concern and do not impact the preparation of the financial statements on that basis.

Management has considered the effect of these reforms, the YJB's financial position and its expected funding. The YJB will continue to perform its remaining statutory functions, while the transferred functions will continue to be delivered within MoJ.

Management therefore expects the YJB's activities to remain funded for at least 12 months from the date the financial statements are authorised for issue. These financial statements have accordingly been prepared on a going concern basis.

1.3 Accounting convention

These accounts have been prepared on an accruals basis under the historical cost convention modified to account for the revaluation of non-current assets.

1.4 Changes in accounting policy and disclosures

a) New and amended standards adopted

IFRS 17 Insurance Contracts replaces IFRS 4 Insurance Contracts for 2025/26. It establishes the principles for the recognition, measurement, presentation and disclosure of insurance contracts within the scope of this standard. The YJB has assessed the requirements of IFRS 17 and determined that its activities do not fall within the scope of insurance contracts as defined by the standard. As a result, IFRS 17 has no impact on the YJB's financial statements.

The 2025/26 FReM includes new guidance on accounting for social benefits. It defines social benefits as "current transfers received by households (including individuals) intended to provide for the needs that arise from certain events or circumstances, for example, sickness, unemployment, retirement, housing, education, or family circumstances". The YJB has assessed the requirements of this guidance and determined that its activities do not involve the provision of social benefit payments. Accordingly, the new guidance on social benefits has no impact on the YJB's financial statements.

The 2025/26 FReM removes the option to remeasure intangible assets using the revaluation model. With approval from HM Treasury, the YJB early adopted this change effective from 1 April 2024. The amendment has been applied prospectively, with the carrying values as at the transition date (1 April 2024) now treated as deemed historical cost.

b) New standards, amendments and interpretations issued but not effective for the financial year beginning 1 April 2025 and not early adopted.

IFRS 18 Presentation and Disclosure in Financial Statements will replace IAS 1 Presentation of Financial Statements and is effective for annual reporting periods beginning on or after 1 January 2027 in the private sector. The impact of IFRS 18 on the public sector is still being assessed, and a decision has not yet been taken on an implementation date.

IFRS 19 Subsidiaries without Public Accountability: Disclosures allows eligible subsidiaries to apply IFRS Accounting Standards with reduced disclosure requirements and is effective for annual reporting periods beginning on or after the 1 January 2027 in the private sector. The impact of IFRS 19 on the public sector is still being assessed, and a decision has not yet been taken on an implementation date.

1.5 Intangible non-current assets

Intangible assets comprise internally developed software for internal use (including such assets under construction), software developed by third parties, and purchased software licences.

Development costs that are directly attributable to the design and testing of identifiable and unique software products controlled by the YJB are capitalised when they meet the criteria specified in the FReM, which has been adapted from IAS 38 'Intangible Assets'.

Other development expenditure that does not meet these criteria is recognised as an expense as incurred. Development costs previously recognised as an expense are not recognised as an asset in a subsequent period.

Purchased software licences are recognised when it is probable that future service potential will flow to the YJB and the cost of the licence can be measured reliably. Such licences are initially measured at cost.



Intangible assets were revalued at the end of each reporting period using the Producer Price Index issued by the Office for National Statistics (ONS) up to 31 March 2024. From 1 April 2024 YJB was granted permission to early adopt the 2025/26 FReM adaptation withdrawing the revaluation model for intangible assets. The carrying values at the transition date of 1 April 2024 are considered historical cost and will be amortised over the remaining lives of the assets.

Intangible assets under construction are not amortised until the assets are ready for use. At this point they are amortised using the straight-line method over their expected useful lives. The useful life of internally developed software ranges from three to seven years. Purchased software licences are amortised over the licence period

Capitalisation threshold

The threshold for capitalising intangible assets is £10,000 (including irrecoverable VAT).

Grouping of assets

The YJB operates a grouping policy on the purchase of intangible assets. When several items of a capital nature are purchased together and the combined cost is greater than £10,000, they are capitalised even if the individual items have a cost of less than £1,000.

Assets under construction

Assets under construction are valued at historical cost within intangible assets and are amortised when the asset is ready for use. At this point the asset's carrying value is transferred to the appropriate intangible asset category.

1.6 Impairment

An impairment reflects a diminution in value of an asset as a result of a clear consumption of economic benefits or service potential. At 31 March each year, the YJB assesses all assets for indications of impairment. If any such indication exists, the assets in question are tested for impairment by comparing the carrying value of those assets with their recoverable amounts.

Where the recoverable amount of an asset is less than its carrying value, the carrying value of the asset is reduced to its recoverable amount. The recoverable amount of an asset is the higher of its 'fair value less costs to sell' and 'value in use'. All impairment loss is charged directly to the Statement of Comprehensive Net Expenditure (SoCNE) unless the asset

was previously revalued. Impairment loss on a revalued item will reduce the amount in the revaluation surplus. When an asset's carrying amount decreases (other than as a result of a permanent diminution), the decrease is recognised in the revaluation reserve to the extent that a balance exists in respect of the asset. Decreases in excess of the revaluation surplus are charged to the SoCNE.

1.7 Leases

Accounting standard IFRS 16 prescribes the accounting policies for leases, requiring lessees to recognise assets and liabilities for all leases unless the lease term is 12 months or less, or the underlying asset is of low value.

YJB occupies office space at 10 South Colonnade, Canary Wharf, London, under agreement with the sponsor department, which is recognised in the annual charges for accommodation costs. The sponsor department may amend accommodation arrangements at relatively short notice as part of its wider management of the estate, and the YJB cannot exclusively control the right to use the space. It has therefore been determined that these arrangements do not meet

the threshold to be recognised as a lease under IFRS 16.

Lease assets and liabilities relating to 10 South Colonnade are recognised in the MoJ Annual Report and Accounts, with the related accommodation charges continuing to be recognised in these accounts under accommodation costs.

The YJB also occupies office space in Welsh Government Offices, Llys Y Draig, Penllegrgaer. This lease qualifies as a right-of-use asset under IFRS 16 Leases as it confers the YJB's right to use the leased asset during the lease term. Therefore, YJB recognises a right-of-use asset and a corresponding lease liability

Initial measurement – YJB as lessee

On 22 February 2024, at the commencement of the lease of office space in the Welsh Government Offices the YJB recognised a right-of-use asset and a lease liability measured at the value of the remaining lease payments, discounted by YJB's incremental rate of borrowing. This rate is advised annually by HM Treasury (4.72% for leases recognised in 2024). YJB's lease includes a termination option, but the YJB is reasonably certain this option will not be exercised. Therefore, the remaining payments included assume the option will not be exercised.

Subsequent measurement – YJB as lessee

After initial recognition, the lease liability has been adjusted for repayments and accruals of interest. The lease is also monitored for reassessments and modifications which could affect the carrying amount of the liability; to date there have been none. The right-of-use asset is subsequently measured using the fair value model. YJB considers that the cost model (measurement by reference to the lease liability) is a reasonable proxy for fair value, given the lease length is five years and the rents payable are aligned with open market rates. The value of the asset will be adjusted for subsequent depreciation and impairment and for reassessments and modifications of the lease liability if they were to occur. Expenditure for each financial year includes interest on the lease liability and a straight-line depreciation charge on the right-of-use asset over the life of the lease, together with any impairments of the right-of-use asset.

1.8 Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents recorded in the Statement of Financial Position (SoFP) and Statement of Cash Flows (SoCF) includes cash in hand and deposits held on call with banks. The YJB does not currently hold any items that meet the definition of cash equivalents such as short term highly liquid investments.

1.9 Employee benefits

Employee accruals

Accruals are made for untaken employee annual leave and bonuses relating to individual performance during the year.

Defined benefit pension schemes

The provisions of the Principal Civil Service Pension Scheme (PCSPS) cover most past and present employees. The PCSPS is an unfunded defined benefit scheme although, in accordance with Section 8.2 of the FReM, the YJB accounts for this as a defined contribution scheme. The expected cost of the future pension liabilities is expensed on a systematic and rational basis over the period during which it benefits from employees' services by payment of charges calculated on an accruing basis. Liability for payment of future benefits is a charge on the scheme.



Defined contribution pension schemes

Under defined contribution schemes, the YJB's legal or constructive obligation is limited to the amount that it agrees to contribute to the fund. The YJB recognises contributions payable as an expense in the year in which it is incurred.

Early departure costs

The YJB is required to pay the additional cost of benefits beyond the normal PCSPS benefits in respect of employees who retire early unless the retirement is on approved medical grounds. The total cost is provided in full when the early departure programme has been announced and is binding on the YJB.

Redundancy and other departure costs, where applicable, are paid in accordance with the provisions of the Civil Service Compensation Scheme, a statutory scheme made under the Superannuation Act 1972. Exit costs are accounted for in full in the year the exit package is confirmed. Ill health retirement costs are met by the pension scheme and are not included in YJB's accounts.

1.10 Income

Income is accounted for on an accruals basis.

1.11 Expenditure

Net expenditure

Net expenditure is wholly attributable to the YJB's goal of providing leadership in the youth justice system. For this reason, it is not deemed necessary to disclose results by segment. There is no income or expenditure relating to geographical areas outside the United Kingdom.

Grant expenditure

Grants payable in respect of the YJB expenditure is accounted for on an accruals basis. A liability is deemed to arise when the grant recipient carries out the specific activity which forms the basis for entitlement. Funds provided, which have not been fully utilised by the grantee, are disclosed as a receivable in the SoFP.

Administration and programme expenditure

Other Expenditure within the SoCNE is analysed between administration, programme and notional expenditure in Note 2. The classification of expenditure as administration or programme follows the definition set out in HM Treasury's Consolidated Budgeting Guidance.

Administration expenditure reflects the cost of support activities such as business and corporate support services, back-office administration and administration of grants.

Programme expenditure reflects costs directly related to frontline service delivery.

1.12 Other costs met by the Ministry of Justice (MoJ)

The MoJ provides the YJB with accommodation and corporate services. Such services are recorded as a notional charge in the Statement of Comprehensive Net Expenditure to report the full cost of the YJB's operations and the funding for these costs is included in grant-in-aid credited to reserves. The services are accounted for at full cost based on the services received.

1.13 Provisions

In line with accounting standard IAS 37 (Provisions, Contingent Liabilities and Contingent Assets), provisions are recognised when YJB has a present legal or constructive obligation as a result of past events for which it is probable that an outflow of economic benefits will be required to settle the obligation, and for which a reliable estimate can be made for the amount of the obligation. The measurement of the provision is based upon the best estimate of the expenditure required to settle the obligation. Creation of provisions are charged to the SoCNE. The YJB had no provisions at 31 March 2026.

1.14 Grants from sponsoring departments

The YJB is principally funded by grant-in-aid received from MoJ, which is accounted for when received.

Grant-in-aid (GIA) is treated as financing. GIA is credited to the general reserve because it is regarded as contributions from a controlling party. Other grants received to support the statutory purposes of the YJB or specific initiatives are recognised as income and credited to the SoCNE.

1.15 Contingent liabilities

A contingent liability is disclosed when the likelihood of a payment is less than probable, but more than remote. Where the time value of money is material, contingent liabilities required to be disclosed under IAS 37 Provisions, Contingent Liabilities and Contingent Assets are stated as discounted amounts. The YJB has no contingent liabilities at 31 March 2026.

1.16 Value added tax (VAT)

Most of the activities of the YJB are outside the scope of VAT; output tax does not therefore apply and input tax on purchases is not recoverable. The secondment of staff to other bodies is within the scope of VAT and output tax is charged and paid to HMRC. Irrecoverable VAT is charged to the relevant expenditure category or included in the capitalised purchase costs of non-current assets.

1.17 Financial instruments

As the cash requirements of the YJB are met through the estimate process, financial instruments play a more limited role in creating and managing risk than would apply to a non-public sector body. The financial instruments held by the YJB relate largely to contracts to buy non-financial items (in line with the YJB's expected purchase and usage requirements) or to amounts owed to the YJB by other areas of the public sector (local government or other government departments). The YJB is therefore exposed to little credit, liquidity or market risk.

1.18 Critical accounting estimates and judgements

There are no items that meet the definitions of critical judgements or key sources of estimation uncertainty

2. Other expenditure

2.1 Administration and programme expenditure

		2025/26	2024/25
	Notes	£000	£000
Administration expenditure			
Audit fee – external ⁶		74	74
Audit fee – internal		54	41
Communications		23	9
Information and communications technology		241	485
Legal		267	-
Other administration		237	205
Research		146	112
Personnel		3	1
Travel and subsistence		15	26
Total administration expenditure		1,060	953
Programme expenditure			
Grants to youth justice services		94,466	92,930
Other programme expenditure		30	21
Travel and subsistence		115	77
Information and communications technology programmes		3,278	2,640
Total programme expenditure		97,889	95,668
Other costs			
Corporate services provided by sponsoring department	2.2	1,367	883
Total other expenditure		100,316	97,504

⁶ External audit fees do not include any non-audit work undertaken by the National Audit Office (NAO). There were no fees paid to NAO for non-audit work in 2025/26 or 2024/25.



2.2 Services and facilities provided by sponsoring department

	2025/26	2024/25
	£000	£000
Communications	56	49
Estates	172	81
Human Resources	12	14
Information and communications technology	572	205
Commercial and contract management	353	231
Shared services	14	14
Information operations ⁷	-	107
Finance	188	182
Total corporate overhead charge	1,367	883

3. Staff costs

	Non-Exec Board members	Employed staff ⁸	2025/26	2024/25
	£000	£000	£000	£000
Wages and salaries	121	4,699	4,820	4,628
Social security costs	12	651	663	529
Other pension costs	-	1,340	1,340	1,252
Total gross cost	133	6,690	6,823	6,409
Less recoveries in respect of outward secondments	-	-	-	(10)
Total net cost	133	6,690	6,823	6,399

4. Income from activities

	2025/26	2024/25
	£000	£000
Other income ⁹	105	90
Total income from activities	105	90

⁷ Part of MoJ Justice Digital in 2025/26

⁸ Note that for the purposes of this table, Executive Directors are included as employed staff.

⁹ YJB income from the Welsh Government

5. Leases

Right of use asset

	2025/26 £000	2024/25 £000
Cost or valuation		
At 1 April	13	13
Additions	–	–
Cost or valuation at 31 March	13	13
Depreciation		
At 1 April	(2)	(1)
Charge in year	(4)	(1)
Depreciation at 31 March	(6)	(2)
Carrying value at 1 April	11	12
Carrying value at 31 March	7	11

Lease liabilities

	2025/26 £000	2024/25 £000
Not later than one year	3	3
Later than one year and not later than five years	5	9
Later than five years	-	-
Gross liabilities	8	12
Less interest	(1)	(1)
Present value of obligations	7	11

Amounts recognised in the Statement of Comprehensive Net Expenditure

	2025/26 £000	2024/25 £000
Depreciation	4	1
Interest expense	1	-
Total	5	1



Amounts recognised in the Statement of Cash Flows

	2025/26 £000	2024/25 £000
Repayment of principal on lease	4	2
Interest expense within operating activities	1	-
Total	5	2

6. Intangible assets

	Assets under construction	Internally generated software	2025/26 Total
	£000	£000	£000
Cost or valuation			
At 1 April	-	7,819	7,819
Additions	94	390	484
Disposals	-	(96)	(96)
Reclassifications	(78)	78	-
At 31 March 2026	16	8,191	8,207
Amortisation			
At 1 April	-	(5,537)	(5,537)
Charge for the year	-	(878)	(878)
Disposals	-	96	96
Revaluations	-	(1)	(1)
At 31 March 2026	-	(6,320)	(6,320)
Carrying value at 31 March 2025		2,282	2,282
Carrying value at 31 March 2026	16	1,871	1,887
Asset financing:			
Owned	16	1,871	1,887
Carrying value at 31 March 2026	16	1,871	1,887



6. Intangible assets (continued)

	Assets under construction	Internally generated software	2024/25 Total
	£000	£000	£000
Cost or valuation at 1 April	-	14,084	14,084
Additions	-	1,073	1,073
Disposals	-	(7,338)	(7,338)
At 31 March 2025	-	7,819	7,819
			-
Amortisation at 1 April	-	(11,881)	(11,881)
Charge for the year	-	(994)	(994)
Disposals	-	7,338	7,338
At 31 March 2025	-	(5,537)	(5,537)
Net book value at 31 March 2025	-	2,282	2,282
Asset financing:			
Owned	-	2,282	2,282
Net book value at 31 March 2025	-	2,282	2,282

7. Trade and other receivables

	31 March 2026	31 March 2025
Amounts falling due within one year:	£000	£000
Trade and other receivables	126	113
Prepayments	60	3
Total	186	116

8. Cash and cash equivalents

	31 March 2026	31 March 2025
	£000	£000
Balance at 1 April	775	150
Net change in cash and cash equivalent balances	(254)	625
Balance at 31 March 2026	521	775
Of which was held at:		
Government Banking Service and cash-in-hand	521	775
Balance at 31 March 2026	521	775

9. Trade and other payables

Amounts falling due within one year:	31 March 2026	31 March 2025
	£000	£000
Accruals	717	799
Lease liabilities	3	3
Trade and other payables	455	647
Balance at 31 March 2026	1,175	1,449

Amounts falling due after one year:	31 March 2026	31 March 2025
	£000	£000
Lease liabilities	4	8
Balance at 31 March 2026	4	8

10. Grants from sponsoring departments

	2025/26	2024/25
	£000	£000
Grant-in-aid from the Ministry of Justice	106,245	104,077
Total	106,245	104,077

11. Commitments

At 31 March 2026, the YJB had no capital or other financial commitments (nil in 2024/25).

12. Related party transactions

The YJB is an executive non-departmental public body that, during the 2025/26 financial year, was principally sponsored by MoJ which provides services and facilities to YJB. These are recharged notionally by MoJ.

In addition, the YJB has a number of transactions with local authorities, whose combined balances are material.

During 2025/26, the YJB undertook material transactions of the following values with related parties:

	2025/26	2024/25
	£000	£000
Ministry of Justice		
Expenditure with the Ministry of Justice	119	192
Balance owed to the Ministry of Justice at 31 March 2026	-	-
His Majesty's Prison and Probation Service		
Expenditure with His Majesty's Prison and Probation Service	-	69
Balance owed to His Majesty's Prison and Probation Service at 31 March 2026	-	-



Non-Executive Board members are required under the Code of Conduct for Non-Executive Directors to declare any personal, financial and business interests which may conflict with their duties on the Board. Members may not participate in Board discussions or decisions on financial matters where a conflict of interest arises.

A register of Board members' interests is maintained and is available online at: <https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/youth-justice-board-for-england-and-wales/about/membership>

13. Events after the reporting period

In accordance with the requirements of IAS 10 Events After the Reporting Period, events are considered up to the date on which the financial statements are authorised for issue, which is interpreted as the date of the certificate and report of the Comptroller and Auditor General.

There are no events after the reporting period which require disclosure.



Stock photograph, posed by models

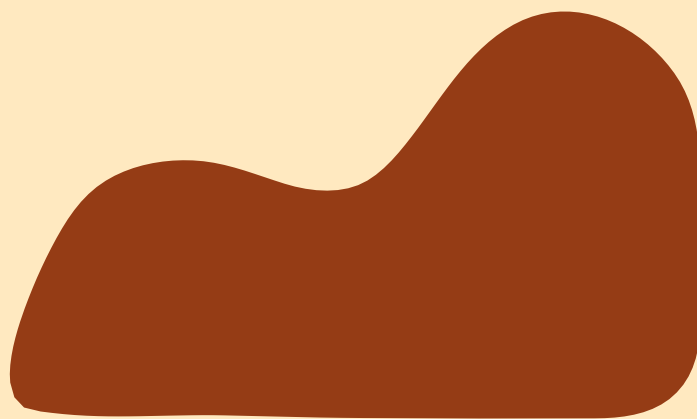


Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full term
ALN	Academic Liaison Network
AWS	Amazon Web Services
C&AG	Comptroller and Auditor General
CCQM	Cultural Cohesion Quality Mark
CETV	Cash Equivalent Transfer Value
CMG	Case Management Guidance
DRR	Data Recording Requirements
ED&I	Equity, Diversity and Inclusion
FARAC	Finance, Audit and Risk Assurance Committee
FReM	Financial Reporting Manual
FTE	Full-Time Equivalent (of staff)
FTEs	First Time Entrants (to the youth justice system)
FYE	Full Year Equivalent
GIAA	Government Internal Audit Agency
GFS	Government Functional Standard
HMT	His Majesty's Treasury
HR	Human Resources
ICO	Information Commissioner's Office
IFRS	International Financial Reporting Standards
ISA	International Standards on Auditing
IT	Information Technology
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
LAP	London Accommodation Pathfinder
MoJ	Ministry of Justice
NAO	National Audit Office
NCB	National Children's Bureau
NDPB	Non-Departmental Public Body
OoCR	Out of Court Resolution
PC	Performance Committee



Abbreviation	Full term
PCSPS	Principal Civil Service Pension Scheme
PDAT	Prevention and Diversion Assessment Tool
PQ	Parliamentary Question
PRem	People and Remuneration Committee
ROTL	Release on Temporary Licence
SCS	Senior Civil Service
SEG	Staff Engagement Group
SEND	Special Educational Needs and Disability
SLG	Senior Leadership Group
SoCF	Statement of Cash Flows
SoCITE	Statement of Changes in Taxpayers' Equity
SoCNE	Statement of Comprehensive Net Expenditure
SoFP	Statement of Financial Position
SRG	Sustainability Reporting Guidance
URD	Understanding Racial Disparity
VAT	Value Added Tax
VAWDASV	Violence Against Women, Domestic Abuse and Sexual Violence
VCSLG	Voluntary and Community Sector Liaison Group
WYJAP	Wales Youth Justice Advisory Panel
YAN	Youth Advisory Network
YDS	Youth Data Summary
YJAF	Youth Justice Application Framework
YJB	Youth Justice Board
YJSOG	Youth Justice System Oversight Group
YJS	Youth Justice Services
YOI	Youth Offender Institution



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